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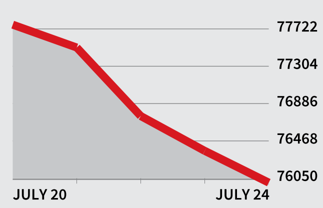



**SENSEX** 76059.77 (-331.62)

**IN FOCUS**

| | LATEST | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|
| Nifty 50 | 23767.45 | -102.15 |
| P/E Ratio (Sensex) | 20.48 | -0.05 |
| US Dollar (in ₹) | 96.56 | -0.01 |
| Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹) | 143205.00 | -821 |
| Silver 1 kg (in ₹) | 222721.00 | +241 |

**UNTAPPED POTENTIAL.** **Only 55 lakh of SBI's** 55 crore customers invest today, leaving vast growth headroom, says DP Singh, Deputy MD, SBI Funds Management **p8**

**AUTO FOCUS.** **Ducati Multistrada V4 Pikes Peak** blends performance, comfort and advanced tech **p4**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

RNI No. KARENG/2023/85271

## QUICKLY.

**CENTRE UNMOVED**

**Deadlock persists over Pradhan's resignation**

**New Delhi:** A standoff has emerged between the Centre and the protesters over the demand for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, with talks on Friday failing to bridge the divide despite the government persuading activist Sonam Wangchuk to end his 26-day fast. Sources said there is no decision on Pradhan's resignation and he still has the backing of the party and the government. **p9**

**AI VINDICATED**

**Delhi HC dismisses ANI's case against OpenAI**

**New Delhi:** The Delhi High Court on Friday denied an interim injunction to news agency *ANI*'s claim of copyright infringement by artificial intelligence firm OpenAI. Justice Amit Bansal observed, "OpenAI's act of storing *ANI*'s works does not amount to copyright infringement... since outputs were not similar to ANI's outputs." **p12**

# US levies lower 10% tariff on India; trade concerns remain

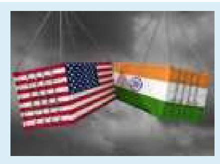
**PARTIAL WIN.** Forced-labour policy change positive but BTA must resolve pharma, oil issues

**Amiti Sen**
New Delhi

India has secured a lower 10 per cent US tariff under Washington's new Section 301 forced-labour regime, placing it on par with Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Indonesia, Malaysia and Pakistan after New Delhi tightened its import rules to prohibit goods made with forced labour. The tariffs India is facing are simultaneously below the 12.5 per cent rate that will apply to Vietnam, Thailand, China and Turkiye.

Trade experts cautioned that while the lower tariff band is a positive outcome, New Delhi must ensure that any bilateral trade agreement (BTA) with the US also addresses unresolved issues, such as the proposed tariffs on pharmaceuticals, threatened penalties linked to purchases of Russian oil and a separate ongoing Section 301 investigation into excess industrial capacity.

**KEY EXEMPTIONS**



- Relief for raw materials and inputs that the US cannot produce in sufficient quantities
- Goods subject to Section 232 tariffs, including certain steel, auto and auto parts, are exempted
- Goods loaded before July 24 and entering the US by July 28 are exempt under a transition provision
- Other nations such as China, Turkiye, Vietnam and Brazil get 12.5% tariff

**CAUTIOUS STANCE**

The MEA adopted a cautious stance on the US announcement made on Thursday (early Friday morning in India). "We have noted the announcement. This was a Section 301 enforcement action initiated after a US SC ruling on the tariff issue, which came in February. We have made our position clear on this subject. Our talks with the US on BTA continue with a view to concluding it at an early date," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

For most Indian exporters, the overall tariff burden will remain largely unchanged as the new Section 301 levy replaces the temporary 10 per cent global tariff imposed under Section 122, which expired on July 24. "Indian exporters largely retain their relative competitiveness, as competing suppliers will face a similar duty incidence in the US market. They could benefit from trade diversion where competing countries are subject to the higher 12.5 per cent tariff," said SC Ralhan, President, FIEO.

India had initially been placed in the 12.5 per cent tariff bracket when the US proposed the Section 301 tariffs on June 3. Washington revised its assessment after New Delhi amended its foreign trade policy on July 14 to ban imports of goods produced using forced labour.

**LINGERING ISSUES**

However, India may still face a disadvantage in textiles. Bangladesh, Indonesia, Cambodia and Malaysia will receive tariff-rate quota (TRQ) exemptions, to be introduced "when feasible", for specified textile and apparel shipments made from US-origin cotton and fibre. Industry hopes the proposed India-US BTA will offset this disadvantage.

Biswajit Dhar, former professor at JNU, said India should not lower its guard. "Washington is considering separate tariffs on pharmaceutical imports, while the bipartisan US Senate Bill proposing 100 per cent tariffs on countries importing large volumes of Russian oil also poses risks. The Section 301 investigation into excess industrial capacity is also yet to conclude. India must ensure these issues are resolved before signing a BTA," he said.

The US has also extended preferential treatment to some trading partners. Imports from the EU and Taiwan will face a combined MFN and Section 301 tariff of no more than 10 per cent, while those from Japan, South Korea and Switzerland will face 12.5 per cent.

# Cabinet clears anti-paper leak Bill with up to 10-year jail, ₹10 cr fine

**Shishir Sinha**
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet on Friday approved a Bill amending 'The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024' to prescribe jail terms of up to 10 years and penalties of up to ₹10 crore for individuals convicted in paper leak cases, official sources said.

The Bill will be introduced in Parliament on Monday.

The development came after Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced around Thursday midnight that a Bill containing provisions for strong action against paper leaks would be introduced in Parliament next week.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressed the nation through a video message on Thursday PTI

**TOUGHER PUNISHMENT**

According to sources, the Bill will provide for imprisonment of up to 10 years, with a minimum sentence of 5 years for individuals resorting to unfair means.

The present law includes "leakage of question papers or answer keys" of a public examination by any person or group of persons or institutions for monetary or wrongful gain.

Further, it prescribes that any person or persons resorting to unfair means and offences shall be punished with imprisonment for a term not less than 3 years, which may extend to 5 years and with a fine of up to ₹10 lakh.

In case of default in the payment of the fine, an additional punishment of imprisonment shall be imposed, as per the provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Sources also added that another provision would involve a fine of up to ₹1 crore for the guilty. As of now, it is unclear whether this limit applies to individuals or institutions.

Under the present law, the guilty service provider shall also be liable to a fine of up to ₹1 crore. Also, the proportionate cost of examination shall be recovered from him, and he shall be debarred from being assigned any responsibilities for the conduct of any public examination for four years.

**MODI's MESSAGE**

In his video message, Modi said, "On Monday, when the second week of the Monsoon Session of Parliament will begin, a Bill will be brought with provisions for strong action against paper leaks, and we will try to pass it as early as possible."

He emphasised that the government had ensured that the students did not lose a year by holding a retest in the shortest possible time and declaring the result on July 19.

The Prime Minister indicated that he does not count himself among those who would settle at this.

"That is why I have given directions to the authorities concerned to set up fast-track courts. These courts have already been established," he said.

The Bill will have a provision for a fixed timeline for faster prosecution of offenders by a dedicated mechanism, including fast-track courts.

# Gujarat charts ₹35,000-crore maritime push with 3 shipyards, 6 new ports and mega cluster

**Avinash Nair**
Ahmedabad

Gujarat has unveiled plans to build three greenfield shipyards, an integrated mega shipbuilding cluster and six ports along its coastline, setting the stage for one of the country's biggest maritime infrastructure expansion programmes as it seeks to strengthen its position as India's leading port and shipbuilding hub.

Per industry estimates, these projects are expected to attract an investment of over ₹35,000 crore.

> **All the projects will be developed under the BOOT model, with the** State government expected to showcase them at the Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2027

**BOOT MODEL**

The Gujarat Maritime Board (GMB) has floated two expressions of interest (EoIs) for projects covering more than 4,500 hectares. These projects include shipyards capable of building 3-3.9 million gross tonnes of vessels annually and six greenfield ports to be developed under the build, own, operate and transfer (BOOT) model. The proposed shipbuilding projects are spread across Gujarat's western and southern coastline, covering locations with industrial ecosystems and maritime access.

The three greenfield shipyards are planned at Mithapur in Devbhumi Dwarka, Ghogha in Bhavnagar and Vadhera in Amreli, while the integrated mega shipbuilding cluster is proposed at Kuchhadi in Porbandar. "The shipbuilding cluster will be set up with the help of the Government of India. We are expecting an estimated investment of ₹25,000 crore for these projects," Ajay Kumar, Vice-Chairman and CEO of GMB, told *businessline*.

**LARGER ECOSYSTEM**

The largest proposed facility, the Kuchhadi integrated mega shipbuilding cluster in Porbandar, will span around 823 hectares with a 2.7-km waterfront and is planned as a larger ecosystem for shipbuilding, ship repair and ancillary marine industries.

"We are also expecting significant investments from the other shipyard projects as there are many medium and small-sized shipyards that want to establish their operations in the State and take advantage of the incentives under our shipbuilding policy," Kumar added.

The maritime board has proposed six greenfield ports at Nana Layja (Kutch), Vadhera (Amreli), Vadodra Jhala (Gir Somnath), Damka (Surat), Lakhanka (Bhavnagar), and Bhogat (Devbhumi Dwarka). The proposed ports, spread across nearly 3,200 hectares, have been identified based on preliminary feasibility studies assessing marine conditions, industrial hinterland, cargo potential and connectivity.

The projects are expected to begin with a capacity of 5-10 mtpa, and according to sources, could attract an initial investment of ₹10,000 crore, which will be in addition to the estimated ₹25,000 crore from shipyard projects.

All the port projects will be developed through the BOOT model, with an indicative concession period of 30-50 years. The final tenure will be determined during the bidding process. The State government is expected to showcase these projects at the Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2027.

## GRANDEUR OF SPORTS

**GAME ON.** Artists perform during the opening ceremony of the 23rd Commonwealth Games at OVO Hydro in Glasgow. The games are being held from July 23 to August 2, with athletes competing for medals across 215 events in 10 sports PTI

# Amid Jantar Mantar protests, govt orders GitHub to block Bitchat repositories

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

The Centre has directed GitHub to disable access to repositories hosting Bitchat, the decentralised Bluetooth mesh-based messaging platform created by Twitter Co-founder Jack Dorsey, citing concerns that the application could be used to bypass internet shutdowns, evade lawful interception and facilitate unlawful activities during the ongoing protests in Delhi.

A notice issued by the Indian Cyber Crime Co-ordination Centre (I4C), under the Ministry of Home Affairs, on July 23, and shared by Dorsey on X, invokes Section 79(3)(b) of the Information Technology Act, 2000, and Rule 3(1)(d) of the IT Rules, 2021, directing GitHub to remove or disable access to the three Bitchat repositories within three hours.

The government said Bitchat's bluetooth mesh architecture enables offline communication, complicating interception

**SECURITY CONCERNS**

The government argued that Bitchat's peer-to-peer bluetooth mesh architecture allows users to communicate without mobile networks, internet connectivity or central servers, making it difficult for law enforcement agencies to intercept communications or identify the users.

The notice said such platforms could be misused to co-ordinate unlawful assemblies, violent protests, spread misinformation, aid radicalisation and facilitate criminal conspiracies, particularly during internet shutdowns.

The move comes days after authorities suspended mobile internet services in parts of central Delhi during the Cockroach Janta Party protests, where decentralised messaging applications were reportedly being used by demonstrators after conventional internet services were cut off.

The action is likely to reignite the debate over the balance between national security and digital rights.

**IFF's CONTENTION**

The Internet Freedom Foundation (IFF) has criticised the internet shutdown, noting that no suspension order had been made public despite the Supreme Court's directions.

It argued in a statement that unpublished shutdown orders undermine transparency and judicial review and sought disclosure of the legal authority, geographical scope and duration of the restrictions.

The IFF also questioned reports of network jammers being deployed, stating that the government should clarify the legal basis if such equipment is used.

# HCLTech and Sarvam to set up ₹14,257 crore AI technology centre in Odisha by 2028

**S Ronendra Singh**
New Delhi

Noida-based HCLTech announced on Friday that it has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Government of Odisha to establish a world-class global technology centre in Bhubaneswar. The centre will focus on innovating and delivering AI-led digital solutions to global enterprises, with an investment of ₹14,257 crore.

This will be the company's first AI data centre in the upcoming Odisha Sovereign AI Park, in partnership with Sarvam. The technology centre will accommodate 5,000 people and is expected to begin operations by 2028.


HCLTech's investment will not only create employment but also strengthen the local talent ecosystem, with a focus on next-generation skills. Towards this, HCLTech plans to engage with local educational institutions and the government through structured interventions, it said.

"HCLTech has been a flagbearer of India's technology industry. In line with Digital India, we strive to be an enabler of India's sovereign AI ecosystem with differentiated offerings across the value chain through focused investments and partnerships," Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Chairperson, HCLTech, said.

In India, HCLTech employs 1.70 lakh people across its technology campuses and centres in Noida, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune, Lucknow, Nagpur, Madurai, Vijayawada and GIFT City.

**KEY HUB**

"Through our New Vistas initiative, we are focused on expanding our presence across India to bring opportunities closer to where the talent is. Odisha offers a great mix of quality infrastructure and a vibrant talent pool, and we look forward to developing Bhubaneshwar as one of our key global innovation and delivery hubs," Rahul Singh, Chief Operating Officer – Corporate Functions, HCLTech, said.

**SARVAM STAKE**

In June, HCLTech announced that it would invest $150 million (₹1,427 crore) as the lead strategic investor by acquiring 41,421 equity shares for a 10.46 per cent stake in Sarvam AI.

"Our investment in Sarvam marks a significant step toward building India's trusted and globally competitive AI ecosystem. By bringing together Sarvam's research in AI models with HCLTech's global presence, we are creating a differentiated full-stack AI platform for enterprises and governments, strengthening our ability to deliver secure, scalable and responsible AI solutions," C Vijayakumar, CEO and MD, HCLTech, had said.

## QUICKLY.

**Laurus Labs Q1 net profit soars 126% to ₹368 crore**

**Hyderabad:** Laurus Labs net profit increased 126 per cent to ₹368 crore in the first quarter ended June 30, 2026, compared to ₹163 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year. The total revenue of the Hyderabad-based company increased 29 per cent to ₹2026 crore against ₹1,570 crore in the year-ago period. "Laurus has delivered record quarterly revenue with expanded profitability and continued its portfolio transformation. This was driven by growing commercial deliveries within CDMO and continued strength in the affordable medicines portfolio," said Satyanarayana Chava, founder & CEO. During the quarter, the company strengthened its integrated offerings, niche capabilities and also achieved key milestones. OUR BUREAU

# Govt easing FDI rules for e-comm to boost exports

**ON SAFE SIDE.** Experts caution it is important to ensure this provision is not misused

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**
New Delhi

**MORE SHINE.** MSMEs are likely to gain, particularly in sectors such as fashion, gems and jewellery and home furnishings

The government's decision to allow foreign-funded e-commerce companies to hold inventory for exports is expected to boost export volumes while reducing compliance burden for Indian sellers, said industry experts. At the same time, some cautioned it is important to ensure that enough safeguards are put in place so that this provision is not misused.

### MSMES TO GAIN

Anand Ramanathan, Partner & Consumer Industry Leader, Deloitte India, said MSMEs are likely to gain from this move, particularly in sectors such as fashion, gems and jewellery, home furnishings and handicrafts. "It will help improve access for Indian goods manufactured in the country. It will also help attract investments to manufacture and source products from India for the global market," he added.

Sohrab Bararia, Partner, Indirect Tax and Grant Thornton Bharat, noted that this is a natural progression of the export facilitation measures introduced by CBIC earlier this year. "Together, these reforms will create a more seamless eco-system for cross-border e-commerce, reducing operational and compliance barriers while improving market access for Indian businesses.

This also provides international e-commerce players greater flexibility in structuring their export operations, which could encourage additional investment in export-focused warehousing, logistics, technology and fulfilment infrastructure in India," he added.

A senior industry executive said this will enable foreign-funded e-commerce players to scale up export volumes out of India, lead to faster delivery timelines, more efficient order fulfilment, reduce compliance burden on sellers and enable brand building for Indian exports.

Striking a note of caution, Praveen Khandelwal, Secretary General, Confederation of All India Traders, said that while the objective of boosting exports deserves wholehearted support, it is equally important to ensure that this provision is implemented in both letter and spirit.

He said that the provision must not be misused as a backdoor route for undertaking domestic B2C e-commerce trade, which remains restricted under the existing FDI policy.

Khandelwal recommended that permission to foreign funded e-commerce players to hold inventory should not be done through the automatic route, but after a thorough examination of their business plans.

With inputs from Amiti Sen

# Hindustan Zinc net rises to ₹5,469 cr on better realisation

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Hindustan Zinc has reported that its net profit more than doubled in the June quarter of FY27 to ₹5,469 crore from ₹2,234 crore logged in the same period last year on better realisation and lower costs even as the production was almost flat.

Revenue increased 72 per cent to ₹13,033 crore (₹7,591 crore). Zinc sales revenue was up 48 per cent at ₹7,304 crore, while that of lead and silver jumped 25 per cent and 169 per cent at ₹1,086 crore and ₹3,839 crore. EBITDA more than doubled to ₹8,074 crore (₹3,860 crore). Mined metal production was was flat at 2.68 lakh tonnes (2.65 lt), while refined zinc output was up 6 per cent at 2.13 lt (2.02 lt) and lead output was down 2 per cent at 47,000 tonnes.

Silver production was flat at 1.49 lt y-on-y. Zinc sales were up 5 per cent at 2.11 lt, while for lead it was down 2 per cent at 47,000 tonnes and silver sales increased marginally 2 per cent to 1.49 lt.

### PRODUCTION COST

Cost of production was down 16 per cent at $851 ($1,010) a tonne. Zinc and silver prices on the LME zoomed 31 per cent and 117 per cent to $3,466 ($2,641) a tonne and $73.2 ($33.7) an ounce. Lead prices were flat at $1,954 ($1,947) a tonne.

**Scorecard** (₹ cr)

| | Q1FY26 | Q1FY27 |
|---|---|---|
| Net profit | 2,234 | 5,469 |
| Revenue | 7,591 | 13,033 |
| EPS (₹) (Diluted) | 5.29 | 12.94 |

The Board has approved the appointment of Amarendu Prakash as the Chief Executive Officer and Whole-time Director, effective August 1, replacing Arun Misra. Prakash previously served as the Chairman and Managing Director of Steel Authority of India between 2023 and 2026.

### APPOINTS NEW CFO

The company has also appointed Amit Gupta as the Chief Financial Officer with effect from June 1.

Misra said the debottlenecking initiatives continue to enhance refined metal production and reinforce the company's position as one of the world's lowest-cost zinc producers.

As demand for zinc continues to be driven by infrastructure and the energy transition, the company remains committed to deliver responsible growth and long-term value for our stakeholders, he added.

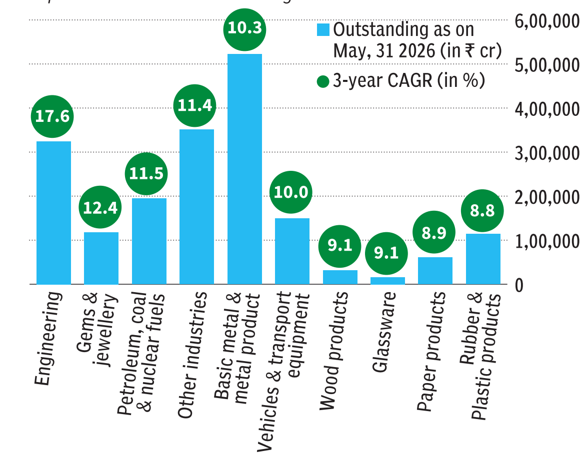
Gupta said the performance reflects the company's focus on operational excellence, cost competitiveness and disciplined financial management.

### BALANCE SHEET

Backed by a strong balance sheet and prudent capital allocation, the company remains well positioned to deliver consistent growth, while continuing to generate sustainable long-term value for stakeholders, he added.

# Engineering leads industry-wise bank credit growth at 17% CAGR

**Yashaswani Chauhan**
New Delhi




Engineering has recorded the fastest growth in industry-wise deployment of bank credit over the past three years, reflecting India's infrastructure push and rising capital expenditure, according to the latest RBI monthly bulletin.

Outstanding bank credit to the engineering sector stood at ₹3.24 lakh crore as of May 31, 2026, recording a 17.6 per cent compound annual growth rate (CAGR) over the past three years.

**DATA FOCUS.**

This was followed by gems and jewellery (12.4 per cent), petroleum, coal products and nuclear fuels (11.5 per cent) and other industries (11.4 per cent).

Although basic metals and metal products had the largest outstanding bank credit of ₹5.22 lakh crore, the sector recorded a comparatively lower growth rate of 10.3 per cent.

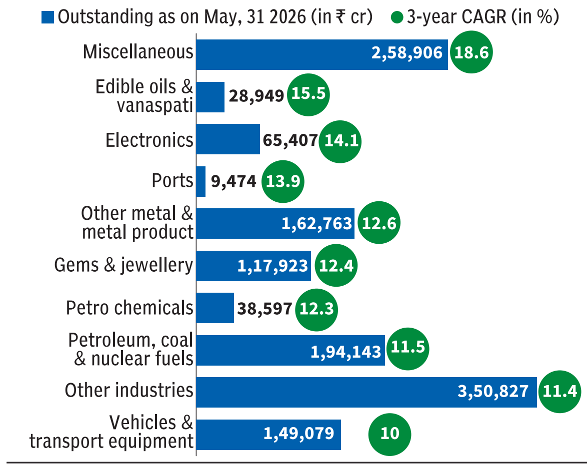
"The engineering sector growth is driven by the massive government push on infrastructure spending towards developing a Viksit Bharat. Bank credit is aligned to this theme," said Vivek Iyer, Partner and Financial Services Risk Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat.

### CREDIT DEMAND

According to Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, the trend reflects credit demand from industries, rather than banks actively directing lending.

"It is essentially a case of demand for credit. The capital goods and engineering sector has performed well, and that performance is driving the demand for bank credit," he said.

The momentum is also visible across sub-industries. The 'others' category recorded the highest three-year credit growth at 18.6 per cent, followed by edible oils




Source: RBI

and vanaspati (15.5 per cent), electronics (14.1 per cent) and ports (13.9 per cent). However, experts mentioned that the 'others' category is largely a balancing item comprising industries that cannot be classified under specific sectors, making it difficult to draw meaningful conclusions from its growth.

### PLI SCHEME

Sabnavis attributed the rise in electronics lending to higher investment under the government's Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme.

"Electronics production has gone up with the incentive, leading to expansion plans and higher demand for credit, particularly in mobile phone manufacturing," he said.

Iyer added that rising consumption beyond metropolitan centres is also supporting lending in sectors such as electronics and edible oils. "Growth in these industries is primarily driven by increasing per capita incomes in India's hinterlands," he said.

Looking ahead, both experts expect infrastructure-linked credit demand to remain resilient. While consumer-facing sectors could see uneven growth, domestic investment and stronger regional partnerships are likely to support continued lending momentum despite subdued global demand.

# Tata Consumer Q1 profit climbs 29% to ₹427 crore

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

Tata Consumer Products reported a 29 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated net profit at ₹427 crore for the June quarter, while revenue rose 12 per cent to ₹5,349 crore, supported by broad-based growth across its India businesses, premiumisation and contributions from recent acquisitions.

EBITDA increased 19 per cent to ₹730 crore, with the EBITDA margin expanding 70 basis points to 13.6 per cent. Its India-branded business delivered 13 per cent underlying volume growth, reflecting momentum across both core and emerging categories.

"Our business demonstrated resilience amid a challenging operating environment," said MD & CEO Sunil D'Souza. "We delivered broad-based growth across India and international businesses, while continuing to strengthen our portfolio through innovation and integration of the acquired brands." He added that the company remained focused on "driving profitable growth" as it scaled newer categories and integrated recent acquisitions.

The company's accompanying disclosures also highlight how the business mix is changing. Tata Consumer's growth businesses — Tata Sampann, ready-to-drink beverages (RTD), Soulfull, Vending, Capital Foods and Organic India — generated ₹1,314 crore during the quarter, overtaking the India tea and coffee business, which reported ₹1,234 crore in revenue.

# ACC net slips 60% on higher costs

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

ACC, an Adani Group company, reported that its net profit in the June quarter plunged 60 per cent to ₹147 crore against ₹375 crore logged in the same period last year, largely due to higher costs. Revenue was down 8 per cent at ₹5,790 crore (₹6,277 crore).

The company said the profitability reflected the impact of planned maintenance at larger integrated units and a higher master supply agreement (MSA) with the parent firm Ambuja Cements, apart from lower sales, revenue and margins.

### SALES VOLUME DOWN

ACC's sales volume, too, declined 7 per cent y-o-y at 10 million tonnes due to a higher MSA with Ambuja.

**Scorecard** (₹ cr)

| | Q1FY26 | Q1FY27 |
|---|---|---|
| Net profit | 375 | 147 |
| Revenue | 6,277 | 5,790 |
| EPS (₹) (Diluted) | 19.94 | 7.81 |

The company's EBITDA for the quarter was down 41 per cent at ₹457 crore. The company attributed the decline in sales volume and operating EBITDA to the higher MSA.

MSA allows ACC and Ambuja to supply cement to each other to meet customer demand. Under the arrangement, if one company faces a supply shortfall or secures an order beyond its available capacity, it is fulfilled by the other company.

During the quarter, a higher share of sales was routed through the MSA, while planned maintenance at ACC's larger integrated plants also weighed on the company's sales volumes and profitability, it said.

Vinod Bahety, Whole-Time Director and CEO, ACC, said the profitability reflects the impact of planned maintenance at larger integrated units and higher MSA with parent Ambuja Cements, even as the company continued to prioritise value-led growth and quality earnings.

### GROWTH OUTLOOK

Combined with strategic capacity expansions at Salai Banwa and Kalamboli, the company expects to improve performance in the coming quarters. The company said it continued to make progress towards the creation of the One Cement platform through the proposed amalgamation of ACC with Ambuja Cements.

# Welspun Corp takes 26% stake in GGBS manufacturing venture

**Our Bureau**
Ahmedabad

Welspun Corp Ltd is expanding into the green construction materials space by taking a 26 per cent stake in a newly incorporated company that will manufacture ground granulated blast furnace slag (GGBS), a move that will allow the steel pipe maker to tap a growing market for low-carbon building materials.

The company's board on Friday approved an investment of ₹26,000 for subscribing to a 26 per cent stake in Slagexcel Private Ltd, a proposed entity that will manufacture GGBS through the slag granulation process and undertake allied activities.

The move marks Welspun Corp's entry into a business closely linked to the steel and cement value chains. GGBS, produced by processing blast furnace slag generated during steel production, is increasingly being used as a substitute for clinker in cement and concrete applications due to its lower carbon footprint.

### ADDITIONAL VALUE

For Welspun Corp, the venture provides an opportunity to create additional value from industrial by-products while participating in the shift towards sustainable construction materials.

Welspun Corp stated it is also moving to consolidate its energy assets by acquiring an additional 51 per cent stake in Welspun Captive Power Generation Ltd (WCPGL) from promoter group company Welspun Living Ltd for ₹67.66 crore.

Welspun Corp's holding in WCPGL will rise from 23 per cent to 74 per cent, making the captive power generation company a subsidiary.

In the June quarter of FY27, Welspun Corp posted a 199 per cent y-o-y jump in consolidated net profit at ₹1,046 crore.

# JMI targets 20% revenue growth in FY27 on strong tractor demand

**T E Raja Simhan**
Chennai

Chennai-based auto component manufacturer JM Frictech India (JMI) is targeting a 20 per cent increase in revenue in FY27, driven primarily by sustained growth in the tractor industry, which accounts for a major share of its business.

The company, which supplies components to original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), including TAFE, John Deere, AGCO, Mahindra, Swaraj, CNH Industrial, Caterpillar, JCB, Escorts Kubota, Sonalika, VECV and Tata Motors, reported revenue of ₹520 crore in FY26, Managing Director E Madhavan told *businessline*.

Founded in 2008 as a joint venture between India's NTC Engineering and South Korea's Jinmyung Frictech Co Ltd (JMFT), JM Frictech

E Madhavan, MD, JM Frictech India

manufactures wet friction systems and hydraulic actuation components for off-highway vehicles. While the Korean company continues as a partner, most of the technology development is now carried out in India, said Madhavan.

The company has invested nearly ₹200 crore in three manufacturing facilities near Chennai, and is expanding its footprint with a ₹35 crore greenfield plant at Chandigarh. The new facility, expected to be inaugurated by March 2027, will manufacture braking systems for customers in north and western India.

JMI employs around 1,100 people, and the growth in the number will be in sync with the revenue growth, he said.

### TRACTOR SEGMENT

Agricultural machinery contributes around 75 per cent of the company's revenue, followed by construction, mining and transmission at 21 per cent, while direct exports account for the remaining 4 per cent. Brakes contribute nearly 80 per cent of revenue, clutches 17 per cent and hydraulic components 3 per cent.

"The tractor industry has been growing steadily and will be a key driver of our growth," said Madhavan, adding that the company manufactures around 80,000 brake assemblies every month for the tractor segment.

# Electric bus makers take steps to enter China-dominated market

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

Indian commercial vehicle makers, including EKA Mobility, Switch Mobility, JBM Auto and Tata Motors, are beginning to enter the global electric bus market worth $40 billion, where more than 1,00,000 e-buses are sold annually and Chinese manufacturers such as BYD, Yutong and King Long remain dominant.

EKA Mobility's export of 10 made-in-India electric buses to Zanzibar has taken India's confirmed overseas e-bus deployments to at least 110 this calendar year, as Indian OEMs build an initial presence across Africa, Mauritius and Europe.

The 10 buses exported by EKA Mobility are expected to serve routes connecting Zanzibar's airport, Malindi Port and key urban centres. The company is also targeting South Africa, and has announced plans to enter Ethiopia and other East African markets. Its partnership with Ethiopia's Kerchanshe Trading covers distribution, after-sales support and a proposed CKD assembly facility for electric buses, trucks and three-wheelers. "Ethiopia's growing industrial base and clean energy focus make it an ideal hub for our East African operations," said EKA's founder and Chairman Sudhir Mehta while announcing the partnership.

Switch Mobility, the electric-vehicle arm of Ashok Leyland and part of the Hinduja Group, has completed delivery of 100 EiV12 electric buses to Mauritius. Manufactured at its Chennai facility, the buses were supplied through a CESL tender under a government-to-government arrangement.

The fleet is operated by Mauritius' National Transport Corporation. Switch has described it as India's largest electric-bus export so far and its first export order.

**CRUCIAL FACTORS.** Manufacturers must meet safety rules, provide charging infra and guarantee long-term service support

The delivery gives Switch an operating reference outside South Asia as it seeks opportunities in Bhutan, Nepal, Seychelles, Africa, GCC and Europe.

### JBM EYES EUROPE

JBM Auto is pursuing a higher-value but more demanding market. It has launched its Ecolife electric city bus in Europe, established a headquarters in Frankfurt and partnered with German leasing company Kazenmaier. The company has announced plans to deploy more than 100 buses in Germany. These remain part of an execution pipeline, and should not be added to India's confirmed overseas fleet until deliveries and commercial operations are established.

Indian OEMs are targeting markets where their cost base, right-hand-drive capability and ability to customise buses for tropical and emerging-market conditions could offer an advantage. However, competitive pricing alone will not be enough. Manufacturers must meet local safety and homologation rules, provide charging infrastructure and guarantee long-term service support. China's advantage extends beyond vehicle volumes. Yutong, BYD, Higer, King Long, Golden Dragon and Zhongtong have built global footprints across Europe, Latin America, West Asia, Asia and Africa. They benefit from large production volumes, established battery supply chains and extensive overseas service networks.

# LPG under-recoveries of PSU oil marketing cos cross ₹51,000 crore

**COST BURDEN.** The implicit subsidy on 14.2 kg LPG exceeds ₹500/cylinder in July, says Oil Minister

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**
New Delhi

The cumulative under recovery on domestic LPG for the PSU oil marketing companies (OMCs), even after the government compensated them with ₹52,000 crore till FY27, has ballooned to more than ₹51,000 crore as of June 2026.

Retail price of LPG is being maintained at ₹942 per 14.2 kg cylinder, which carries an implicit subsidy (under-recovery) of more than ₹700 per cylinder in June 2026, said Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri in the Lok Sabha.

Even for July, the implicit subsidy on each 14.2 kg domestic LPG cylinder is more than ₹500 per cylinder, he added on Thursday responding to a starred question.

**GROWING CONCERN.** Under-recoveries of IOCL, HPCL and BPCL ballooned as LPG was sold below international prices

Puri informed the House that the government has already compensated the PSU OMCs for selling LPG below market prices.

"Even after the payment of this compensation, accumulated under-recoveries of the PSU OMCs on domestic LPG were more than ₹51,000 crore as of June 30, 2026 itself," the Minister said.

**WAR IMPACT**

Under recoveries of Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL), Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) and Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) ballooned due to selling LPG below international prices, which surged significantly after February 28, 2026 due to the West Asia conflict and closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH).

For comparison, Equirus Securities said that average Saudi propane prices stood at $682 per tonne during Q1 FY27, growing roughly 26 per cent q-o-q and 17 per cent y-o-y.

Puri pointed out that average Saudi CP (international benchmark) rose by up to $780 per tonne in April-May 2026. In June, it rose to $796 (excluding premium).

While HPCL's LPG under recovery stood at around ₹16,405.92 crore as of June 30, 2026, BPCL's under recovery was at ₹15,803.74 crore during the same period. Prior to the outbreak of conflict in West Asia in February, India used to import about 60 per cent of its LPG consumption, out of which about 90 per cent was transiting the SoH. With its closure supplies of imported LPG were severely constrained.

Government took a series of measures to ensure stability in LPG supplies including increasing production from 34,000 tonnes per day (TPD) to 54 TPD, prioritisation of household usage, diversification of import sources and dynamic stock management.

Puri said that during the peak of the West Asia crisis, more than 56 crore domestic LPG cylinders were delivered from March to June, including over 12 crore cylinders to Ujjwala families.

# Power demand surges 11% y-o-y during July 1-16 due to delayed South-West monsoon and high humidity

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**
New Delhi

Electricity demand rose by almost 11 per cent (10.7 per cent) y-o-y during July 1-16, as delayed monsoon rains, coupled with high humidity, pushed up demand for cooling.

The first 16 days of the current month experienced relatively high temperatures and surging humidity, coupled with subdued monsoons, which reflects in high peak power demand met levels.

For instance, India's peak power demand met during the day and night hit record levels on four consecutive days — July 13, July 14, July 15 and July 16.

During these days, the solar hours (day) demand stood in the range of 270.20 gigawatt (GW) to 256.96 GW. Similarly, peak demand met during non-solar hours (night) was in the range of 251.14 GW to 249.42 GW.

**PEAK DEMAND**

In fact, India achieved its second highest peak power demand met (daytime) on July 16 at 270.20 GW. The highest peak daytime demand met was at 270.82 GW recorded on May 21, 2026.

Ankit Jain, V-P and Co Group Head of Corporate Ratings at ICRA, said: "Data from Grid Controller of India indicate that India's electricity demand registered a y-o-y growth of 10.7 per cent during the first 16 days of July 2026 after an 11.6 per cent y-o-y growth in June."

The delayed onset of the South-West monsoon across several regions supported demand by prolonging elevated temperatures and increasing cooling-related power consumption, he explained.

Jain pointed out that coal stocks of around 13 days as on July 18, are slightly lower than 14.3 days recorded at the end of June 2026.

"Domestic coal production declined by 5.9 per cent y-o-y in 3M FY2027, largely due to lower output from Coal India. However, coal supply to the power sector increased marginally by 0.5 per cent y-o-y during the period as the plant load factor for thermal projects rebounded in May and June 2026," he added.

Sustained recovery in coal production and supply remains important to maintain adequate buffer stock levels. While stock levels continue to remain below the normative requirement of 20 days, they are significantly higher than the levels witnessed in the past and provide comfort for meeting peak demand, he noted.

Spot power tariffs on the Indian Energy Exchange averaged ₹7 per unit as on July 16, 2026, compared to ₹5.2 per unit in June 2026 and ₹4.2 per unit in July 2025.

"While tariffs are expected to remain modest amid rising supply, particularly during solar hours, the trend in FY27 will depend on the balance between capacity additions and demand growth," Jain said.





**Unaudited / Reviewed Financial Results (Standalone & Consolidated ) for the Quarter ended 30th June 2026**

₹ in Lakh

| Sr. No. | Particulars | Standalone | | | Consolidated | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Quarter ended | | Year ended | Quarter ended | | Year ended |
| | | 30.06.2026 (Reviewed) | 30.06.2025 (Reviewed) | 31.03.2026 (Audited) | 30.06.2026 (Reviewed) | 30.06.2025 (Reviewed) | 31.03.2026 (Audited) |
| 1 | Total Income from Operations (Net) | 22,52,847 | 20,51,829 | 85,03,554 | 22,71,228 | 20,67,762 | 85,64,956 |
| 2 | Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) | 4,08,748 | 2,91,330 | 13,94,566 | 4,33,099 | 3,02,341 | 14,28,854 |
| 3 | Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) | 4,08,748 | 2,91,330 | 13,94,566 | 4,33,099 | 2,50,461 | 13,76,974 |
| 4 | Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) | 3,06,790 | 2,25,212 | 10,52,715 | 3,30,258 | 1,82,956 | 10,30,630 |
| 5 | Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | Refer Note 3 | | | Refer Note 3 | | |
| 6 | Paid up Equity Share Capital | 4,55,341 | 4,55,341 | 4,55,341 | 4,55,341 | 4,55,341 | 4,55,341 |
| 7 | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year | | | 75,47,654 | | | 77,38,068 |
| 8 | Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) - | | | | | | |
| | 1. Basic (in ₹): | 6.74 | 4.95 | 23.12 | 7.25 | 4.02 | 22.64 |
| | 2. Diluted (in ₹) : | 6.74 | 4.95 | 23.12 | 7.25 | 4.02 | 22.64 |
| 9 | Net Worth | 76,94,034 | 66,86,230 | 75,27,811 | 78,90,859 | 68,36,318 | 77,05,575 |
| 10 | Paidup Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt * | 28.60% | 19.46% | 27.82% | | | |
| 11 | Debt Equity Ratio * | 0.71 | 0.57 | 0.78 | | | |

* Debt represents borrowings with residual maturity of more than one year. Outstanding Debt represents total borrowings of the Bank.

**Notes:**
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly / Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) websites **(BSE:https:// www. bseindia.com and NSE: https://www.nseindia.com)** and the website of the Bank **(https://www.bankofindia.bank.in).** The same can be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided here.
2. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchange(s) (National Stock Exchange and Bombay Stock Exchange) and can be accessed on the URL **(NSE: http://www .nseindia.com and BSE:http://www.bseindia.com).**
3. Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and Other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to banks.

Sd/- **(Pramod Dwibedi)** Executive Director | Sd/- **(Rajiv Mishra)** Executive Director | Sd/- **(Subrat Kumar)** Executive Director | Sd/- **(P. R. Rajagopal)** Executive Director | Sd/- **(Rajneesh Karnatak)** Managing Director & CEO | Sd/- **(M.R.Kumar)** Chairman

Scan for Results

**Place : Mumbai | Date : 24.07.2026**

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SATURDAY - JULY 25 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

### Mercedes launches AMG E 53 Hybrid

A performance derivative of the E-Class, the AMG E 53 Hybrid has been launched in India. Offered in two versions, Performance Edition (₹1.45 crore) and Racing Edition (₹1.48 crore, ex-showroom), the AMG E 53 is a plug-in hybrid that features a 3.0-litre inline-six turbo-petrol engine paired with Mercedes' 4Matic+ all-wheel drive tech. Standard features include 577 bhp (604 bhp in Race Start mode) and a claimed 0-100-kph time of just 3.8 seconds!

### Force Urbania spawns a Deluxe variant

Building on the Urbania's popularity, Force Motors has launched a Deluxe variant of its formidable people-mover. It hosts a refreshed interior, which includes leatherette seats, a wood-finish floor, 9-inch touchscreen infotainment, an 8-speaker sound package, a powered sliding footstep and 16-inch alloy wheels. The Urbania Deluxe is available in three wheelbase options and with eight seating layouts ranging from 9 to 16 (+ driver). The asking price? ₹28.7 lakh, ex-showroom.

### Royal Enfield updates the Classic 350

You can now have the Classic 350 with a slip-and-assist clutch, a feature that recently made its way to the Hunter, Meteor and Goan Classic as well. Available exclusively on dual-channel ABS versions, this feature should translate to a lighter clutch action and an improved gearshift experience. Also new is a faster USB Type-C charging port. Prices for this version start at ₹1.95 lakh, while the base version, not offered with the new features, continues to be priced ₹1.87 lakh, ex-showroom.

@TheMotorGram

# Peak Talk

**HILL SMITH.** Ducati's Multistrada V4 Pikes Peak is far from your everyday sport-tourer. Is it also a step too far, though?

PRASHANT SHETTY

Ruman Devmane

I didn't need to look up at the sky to tell it was the kind of day to stay home. But that wasn't going to stop me, of course. Unlike a privileged few, I don't often find myself armed with unrestricted access to a V4-engined motorcycle. So when the opportunity arises, I can't help but rise to the occasion. In any case, this wasn't an ordinary V4, if there can ever be such a thing in the first place.

Ducati's Multistrada — its version of a fast, tall touring motorcycle — has always impressed, but this, the V4 Pikes Peak, sits at the very top of the range. To set the context, this version of the Multistrada V4 bears the 'Pikes Peak' suffix because of its affiliation with the Colorado-based hill-climb race that nearly dates back to the origins of the motorcycle itself.

A fast 20-km uphill dash featuring 156 turns to the finish line at 14,115 feet, the Pikes Peak International Hill Climb, also referred to as 'the race to the clouds,' is among motor sport's most spectacular races. Ducati has won thrice (2012, 2013 and 2018), each time on a Multistrada, and the only reason it hasn't won in recent years is because motorcycles have been permanently banned from the race since 2021, citing safety concerns.

**EASY DOES IT**

The Multistrada you see here is built for that kind of stuff: Effortless speed, precision and agility. Did I need any of it on a day that was, effectively, a rainy washout? Absolutely not. Fortunately, the Multistrada had a surprise in store for me — it's an incredibly easy motorcycle to ride. Before I elaborate on this, allow me a moment to ponder over how it looks. I wish it looked heartachingly pretty, which would exempt me from viewing it from an objective lens, but it doesn't. It's modern, quite in line with contemporary Ducati styling and, amazingly, while it has a towering presence, it's also somewhat lithe in appearance. I don't like the stubby windscreen or some of the decals, but on the whole, it looks properly sporty. Special? Not quite, to my eyes, at least.

It sure is exquisite in its details, though. From the forged Marchesini 17-inch wheels to the Ohlins suspension, Brembo brakes, a single-sided swingarm and, of course, that meaty 1158 cc 167.6-bhp V4 'Granturismo' engine, it's all of a very tall order. It has an Akrapovic exhaust and some complex-looking winglets, too, but on the whole, there's nothing 'shouty' about any of its visual and functional elements. A few of those wouldn't have hurt, to be honest.

My eagerness to ride the Pikes Peak got in the way of my train of thought — probably a good thing — and thereafter, it was all a blur. To tell you the truth, I spent the first hour or so at more or less a crawl. I didn't mind it because it gave me a great taste of just how accessible the Multistrada is. The ergonomics are super comfortable and its girth (227 kg without fuel) is manageable to an incredible degree. You get a high-perched view of the road ahead and, once in the seat, don't really feel you're riding something particularly wide. In five minutes with it, I was already squeezing through gaps I had been on a much smaller motorcycle earlier in the day.

**ONE WITH IT ALL.** The TFT screen is densely packed with info and endless ride-configuration settings. The split seat is as comfy as it gets. The Brembo brakes inspire absolute confidence PRASHANT SHETTY

**ALL ABOUT SPEED**

Puttering around in Wet mode is not what the Pikes Peak exists for, though. Eager to switch to its more responsive modes, I hit the highway and, soon enough, wished I hadn't. The Pikes Peak is the kind of motorcycle that corrupts you with speed. Its Urban, Touring and Sport modes are calibrated appropriately, each mode progressively decreasing the level of electronic interventions, and Race mode is its magnum opus. It's also the mode in which the Pikes Peak feels too superbike-y. This may be the very point of the Pikes Peak, but it just wasn't the kind of day to find out. Touring mode worked just fine for me.

At this point, I have to tell you just how programmable the Pikes Peak is. Each ride mode lets you choose from four power settings, as many suspension settings (low grip, track, comfort and dynamic), three levels of engine braking, eight levels of wheelie and traction control, and three levels of ABS. You can turn the quickshifter off, too — I have no idea why — and it also features a forward collision warning system (pointless in India), adaptive cruise control and a blind-spot warning system integrated into the mirrors.

**BRAG RACE**

While the features aren't new to Ducati, what has evolved is the level of intuitiveness and equally how mindfully each of these programs have been calibrated. Want an on-the-fly mode change? It happens before you can say it. There are robust switches to do all of this, and the layout is brilliant in how easily you can develop muscle memory around it. None of the settings are wasteful either; each degree of change gets you a tangible result. Isn't all of this a bit excessive for a motorcycle that will, in most cases, be used for fast-paced touring? Yes. But who ever bought a Ducati to solve problems? Bragging rights matter.

Fortunately, your bragging won't just be limited to its feature set. In the real world, the Pikes Peak is probably the fastest motorcycle you can have for how powerful yet accessible its performance is, given wings by its fantastic suspension and stability. You can attack corners with it like in a video game and, although I was far from its limit, its agility and responsiveness to steering inputs became instantly addictive. It's also always unstressed, refined to a degree Ducatis from a decade ago couldn't dream of, and yet so very alive. Give it a hard launch in race mode and it'll leave you feeling heady. Even at 200 kph, you can tell it's still only cruising. It helps that the brakes and the Pirelli Diablo Rosso IV tyres are simply excellent.

Is the Pikes Peak the only kind of Multistrada you must aspire to, though? I really don't think so. You'd have to be a serious collector or a committed racetrack regular to shell out its asking price of ₹36.17 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi). I suspect an entry-level Multistrada V4 (₹25.05 lakh) will be almost as usable and exciting, though. What about something other than a Ducati, then? Good question. I could do with some more days of not being home.

@TheMotorGram

# Green Flag(ship)

**CIVIC SENSE.** The ZR-V arrives as a full import, with a strong hybrid, a Civic-derived platform, and a case to make about engineering in a segment that sells presence

**CLEAN CUT.** Honda's latest car features neat details matched with practical real-world solutions ANUBHAV SHARMA

Anubhav Sharma

Honda has been a quiet presence in the Indian market for some years now, selling steadily with the City and the Elevate but without a halo car. The ZR-V is the attempt to fix that, and it comes here as a completely built unit from Japan, with nothing removed and nothing engineered down to meet the local price. It also means paying a premium, which places the ZR-V in a bracket where buyers have been trained to expect size, a tonne of features and road presence above everything else.

The ZR-V leads with elegance more than presence, with proportions that are soft and rounded with no hard creases, and the whole thing reads closer to a crossover than a slab-sided chunky SUV. LED headlamps with integrated LED DRLs and sequential turn signals, 18-inch alloys, full LED tail-lamps and dual exhaust tips give it a finish that is expensive rather than loud. Buyers looking for the visual authority of an SUV will not find it here, and Honda has clearly decided not to chase it.

Inside is where the import shows its value. The cabin is largely black and classically Honda, with a mesh panel running across the dash that houses the air-conditioning vents, a dash-mounted touchscreen and an EV-style button-operated gear selector. Physical knobs handle the climate control, thankfully, and a 9-inch touchscreen, a 10.2-inch driver's display, a 12-speaker Bose system, eight airbags, a 360-degree camera and a powered tailgate cover the essentials. The front seats are firm and supportive but not ventilated, and before you complete the gasp let me tell you there is no sunroof and no spare tyre. The world clearly agrees with what a small bunch of us have been saying: Sunroofs are mostly useless. I am glad Honda is on our side, but the spare tyre is a miss.

**DOUBLE POWER**

The engine is a 2.0-litre strong-hybrid petrol working with twin electric motors, making a combined 181 bhp and 32.1 kg-m through an e-CVT. For most of the time, the petrol engine runs as a generator and the motors drive the wheels, so the car pulls away with the immediacy of an EV rather than the pause of a conventional automatic. Honda claims 7.9 seconds from 0 to 100 kph, and that felt believable on the Buddh International Circuit's straight. Ask for everything at once and the engine note runs slightly ahead of the speedometer, especially in Sport mode, which feels and sounds good. There are paddle shifters, and this may take some adjustment for loyal Honda users, but they adjust the regen and not change gears.

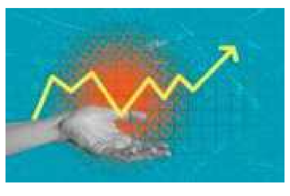
You sit in this car rather than on it, and that was quite apparent during the short slalom section where direction changes were sure footed. The steering is accurate and consistently weighted, brakes do what they are asked to. It is hard to say how firm and comfortable the ride will be in real-world conditions, based on our short spin on the track. I do wish we had the full track available to really push the car, and not a restricted one because the ZR-V seems eager and sporty.

Honda says that 8,00,000 ZR-Vs have been sold globally since 2022, and it feels engineered like something that has had the years and the volume to be properly sorted. Bringing in a strong hybrid, certified E20 compliant and self-charging, at a moment when what goes into the fuel tank in this country keeps changing, helps its case, too. Prices are expected to be announced shortly, but if one were to believe the ₹40-45 lakh (ex-showroom) rumours, it is not going to be a walk in the park for Honda. The ZR-V will not out-argue a bigger SUV on presence or on a feature list, and it does not try to. It is for someone who understands solid engineering is more important than a sunroof, who wants an SUV for practical reasons and not only size. That is a narrower audience than Honda would like, but for the people in it, the ZR-V will be a welcome green flag.

@TheMotorGram

## QUICKLY.

### SBI Life posts 22% PAT growth in Q1 FY27



**Mumbai:** SBI Life Insurance Company reported a 22 per cent y-o-y rise in profit after tax to ₹720 crore for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, as the private insurer's new business momentum accelerated sharply compared to the same period last year. The company's annualised premium equivalent (APE) jumped 36 per cent to ₹5,380 crore in Q1 FY27, driven by strong growth across protection and non-par savings segments. Gross written premium rose 20 per cent to ₹21,290 crore, with new business premium growing 23 per cent to ₹8,190 crore and renewal premium up 17 per cent to ₹12,380 crore. The sharpest growth came from the protection segment, where new business premium more than doubled to ₹1,960 crore, a 100 per cent y-o-y increase. Group protection drove this, rising 116 per cent to ₹1,760 crore. Total new business sum assured grew 211 per cent to ₹8,50,030 crore, reflecting the company's push toward higher-coverage products. OUR BUREAU

# BoB Q1 profit plunges 72% to ₹1,278 cr on NMC settlement

**MIXED BAG.** Net interest income up 9.5% at ₹12,524 crore, other income dips 26%

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Bank of Baroda (BoB) reported a 72 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) drop in first quarter (Q1FY27) standalone net profit at ₹1,278 crore against ₹4,541 crore in the same period last year.

The bottomline was impacted by a one-off exceptional payment of $600 million to settle obligations related to the collapsed UAE-based NMC Group.

Excluding the aforementioned impact of ₹5,680 crore, the public sector bank's net profit would have been ₹5,528 crore.

Elaborating on the reasons for entering into a settlement with the Administrators of entities within the NMC Group, MD & CEO Debadatta Chand said: "The (settlement) decision was taken after carefully evaluating the matter from a commercial perspective. The settlement has been concluded without any admission of liability or wrongdoing. The bank believed it had a strong basis for entering into the settlement. Since the matter remains *sub-judice* with respect to other defendants, the settlement terms are confidential."

**Scorecard**

| | Q1FY26 | Q1FY27 | % change |
|---|---|---|---|
| Net profit | 4,541 | 1,278 | -71.9 |
| Net int income | 11,435 | 12,524 | 9.5 |
| Other income | 4,675 | 3,470 | -25.8 |
| Operating profit | 8,236 | 8,127 | -1.3 |
| Total prov | 1,967 | 6,323 | 221.5 |
| Income tax | 1,728 | 526 | -69.6 |
| GNPA (%) | 2.28 | 1.99 | - |
| NNPA (%) | 0.6 | 0.5 | - |
| Global deposits | 14,35,634 | 16,33,559 | 13.8 |
| Global advances | 12,07,056 | 14,16,898 | 17.4 |
| Global NIM % | 2.91 | 2.77 | - |

#### RESOLVING LITIGATION

He emphasised that resolving this long-pending litigation removes a significant legacy overhang and strengthens the bank's balance sheet by eliminating a longstanding uncertainty.

The NMC Group was put under administration in 2020 after investigators uncovered billions of dollars in undisclosed debt and evidence of alleged fraud. The joint administrators of the collapsed NMC Health alleged that BoB's UAE operations had facilitated certain financing arrangements, enabling the company to conceal debt. The bank has denied any wrongdoing in this case.

On mobilising resources that can be swapped with the RBI under its special window, Chand expects to raise around $4-5 billion across the three instruments — Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)/ FCNR (B) deposits, Medium-Term Notes (MTNs) and Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)

#### HOPEFUL OF TARGET

"As of today, we have mobilised close to $700 million through FCNR(B) deposits and we expect this to exceed $1 billion by month-end. Based on the current traction, we remain confident of achieving our original target of raising around $4-5 billion before the window closes."

#### INCOME DOWN

In the reporting quarter, net interest income was up 9.5 per cent ₹12,524 crore ( ₹11.435 crore).

Other income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, declined 26 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,470 crore (₹4,675 crore). Within this, treasury income was sharply lower at about ₹800 crore (₹2,016 crore).

# Bank of India net profit up 36% at ₹3,068 crore

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Bank of India (BoI) reported a 36 per cent y-o-y increase in standalone net profit for the Q1FY27, at ₹3,068 crore against ₹2,252 crore in the year ago period on the back of a decent growth in net interest income and other income and decline in total provisions.

In the reporting quarter, net interest income (difference between interest earned and interest expended) was up about 13 per cent to ₹6,833 crore (₹6,068 crore in the year ago period).

Other income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, rose 19 per cent y-o-y to ₹2,579 crore (₹2,166 crore a year ago).

#### OTHER INCOME

Within other income, profit from exchange transactions jumped 113 per cent at ₹226 crore, recovery in written-off accounts increased 89 per cent at ₹609 crore and other non-interest income up 87 per cent at ₹867 crore more than made up for the decline of about 50 per cent in treasury income at ₹414 crore.

Provision for non-performing assets increased by 4 per cent to ₹1,144 crore (₹1,104 crore). However, the write-back in provisions towards standard assets and others was substantially higher at ₹181 crore (up from ₹8 crore). Net interest margin was a shade lower at 2.52 per cent against 2.55 per cent in the year ago period.

Rajneesh Karnatak, MD & CEO, Bank of India

Rajneesh Karnatak, MD & CEO, BoI, said the bank is eyeing inflows of about $1.2 billion via fresh FCNR (B) deposits under the RBI's limited period concessional swap window.

The bank has so far raised $200 million via these deposits since June 8th. Global deposits rose about 15 per cent y-o-y to ₹9,57,924 crore as at June-end 2025.

Global advances increased by about 19 per cent y-o-y to ₹7,97,775 crore.

# REC posts net profit of ₹4,193 cr in Q1

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

State-run REC on Friday reported a 6 per cent y-o-y decline in its consolidated net profit at around ₹4,193 crore in Q1 FY27.

On a sequential basis, the net profit of the power sector financier was higher by about 24 per cent. REC's consolidated total income during the June quarter stood at around ₹14,200 crore compared to ₹14,119 crore in Q4 FY26 and ₹14,591 crore in Q1 FY26.

#### TOTAL EXPENSES

Its consolidated total expenses were at ₹14,469 crore in Q1 FY27 as against ₹14,583 crore during Q4 FY26 and ₹14,824 crore in Q1 FY26. Despite a dynamic operating environment, REC sustained a healthy net interest margin (NIM) of 3.34 per cent, reflecting the strength of its lending portfolio and disciplined financial management, the state-controlled NBFC said.

Consequently, the company delivered an annualised EPS of ₹63.04 per share for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, underscoring its robust earnings performance, it added.

# Shriram Finance Q1 profit surges 60% to ₹3,445 cr on NII growth

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

Shriram Finance on Friday reported a 60 per cent rise in standalone net profit for the quarter ended June 2026 (Q1FY27) at ₹3,445 crore, compared to ₹2,156 crore in the same quarter last year. The profit growth came from growth in both core net interest income and in other income.

Net interest income for the quarter increased by around 34 per cent and stood at ₹8,056 crore against ₹6,026 crore in the same period of the previous year.

Besides brisk growth of 21 per cent and 19 per cent in passenger vehicle and commercial vehicle finance, the interest income was driven by robust growth of 45 per cent in gold loans. Other income also saw a significant 44 per cent growth and stood at ₹1,105 crore.

Commercial vehicle AUM made up the largest share at ₹1,47,034 crore with a 47 per cent share. Passenger vehicle AUM stood at ₹68,650 crore (22 per cent). Construction equipment AUM saw a 25 per cent decline in the quarter.

**Scorecard**

| | Q4FY26 | Q1FY26 | Growth % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Net profit (₹ crore) | 2,155 | 3,445 | 59.9 |
| Net interest income (₹ crore) | 6,026 | 8,056 | 33.7 |
| Gross stage 3 assets (%) | 4.53 | 4.64 | - |
| Net stage 3 assets (%) | 2.57 | 2.33 | - |

#### AUM RISES 15.3%

Total assets under management as of June 30 increased by 15.3 per cent and stood at ₹3,13,798 crore as compared to ₹2,72,249 crore as of June 30, 2025 and ₹3,02,274 crore as of March 31, 2026. The company had projected an AUM growth of 18 per cent for FY27 in its earnings call in April. Asset quality saw mild strain on a gross basis but was stable in net terms. Gross NPA (or Gross Stage 3 assets) came in at 4.64 per cent as of June compared to 4.58 per cent during the March quarter and 4.53 per cent in June 2025.

Net NPA remained unchanged at 2.33 per cent on a sequential basis but was down from 2.57 per cent in the same quarter last year. Detailed analysis shows that asset quality deterioration came largely from the construction equipment and MSME segments.

Loan losses and provisions during the quarter stood at ₹1,463 crore, compared to ₹1,286 crore in June 2025. During the quarter, MUFG Bank, the Japanese banking giant and subsidiary of Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group, completed its acquisition of a 20 per cent equity stake in Shriram Finance.

Umesh Revankar, Executive Vice-Chairman, Shriram Finance, told *businessline* that despite the macroeconomic disruptions including the West Asia war, net interest margins have grown with the cost of funds having come down after the MUFG deal. "The Indian economy is still growing so we are not yet changing our outlook for FY27, but El Nino is a factor we are going to have to watch for," he added.

# Smaller UPI players urge NPCI to rethink UPI Meta rollout

**Jyoti Banthia**
Bengaluru

Smaller UPI players have urged the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) to reconsider the proposed rollout of UPI Meta, arguing that the framework could unintentionally strengthen the dominance of larger apps such as PhonePe and Google Pay by altering how consumers choose their preferred payment application.

In a joint representation to NPCI, seen by *businessline*, the companies called for wider industry consultations before the framework is implemented, warning that the proposal fundamentally changes UPI's open architecture by shifting consumer choice from every transaction to a one-time onboarding decision.

UPI Meta is a tokenisation layer being developed by NPCI that would allow users to save their preferred UPI app on merchant platforms such as Amazon, Blinkit and Swiggy. Instead of being redirected to a UPI application for every payment, users would authenticate transactions directly on the merchant platform using their UPI PIN or biometric authentication.

#### ROLLOUT PLAN

NPCI is targeting a launch around the Global Fintech Fest later this year as it looks to make UPI payments as seamless as tokenised card transactions, particularly amid the expected entry of Apple Pay into India.

However, smaller UPI apps contend that the proposal addresses a problem that does not exist.

"Despite UPI processing billions of transactions every month and continuing to witness strong growth, no ecosystem-wide evidence has been presented to demonstrate that the current checkout journey is causing material customer drop-offs or transaction abandonment," the representation said.

UPI Meta would allow users to save their preferred UPI app on merchant platforms

The companies argued that unlike card tokenisation — which eliminates the need to repeatedly enter card details — UPI already offers a frictionless payment experience, making the proposed changes unnecessary.

At the core of the industry's concern is the possibility that users are unlikely to revisit the default UPI app selected during onboarding, giving incumbent players with the largest installed user base a lasting competitive advantage.

"Over time, this may create structural advantages for larger incumbent apps with significant existing customer bases, while making customer acquisition and transaction share growth increasingly challenging for smaller and emerging UPI apps," the representation noted.

#### TRANSACTION VOLUME

According to the latest industry data, PhonePe accounts for around 45 per cent of UPI transaction volume, while Google Pay has about 33 per cent. Smaller apps such as Navi, super.money and BHIM each account for around 1-2 per cent of transaction volume.

The representation also cautioned that while users may technically retain the ability to change their preferred UPI app, digital behaviour suggests that default settings rarely change.

"While customers may continue to retain the ability to modify or remove linked applications, based on observed customer behaviour across digital ecosystems, default preferences established during onboarding tend to persist unless customers have a specific reason to change them. Consequently, the third-party application provider (TPAP) selected during onboarding may become the default application for a substantial proportion of future transactions," the letter said.

Seeking a broader industry discussion before implementation, the companies said, "We request NPCI to undertake broader consultation with TPAPs and other ecosystem participants and comprehensively evaluate the concerns highlighted above before progressing with the proposed framework."



# Crypto exchanges hail govt's SRO proposal for virtual digital assets

**Vallari Sanzgiri**
Mumbai

Cryptocurrency industry leaders praised the government's call for self-regulatory bodies to regulate virtual digital assets (VDA), calling it a "practical" move to address current realities of the VDA ecosystem.

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance on Thursday released its report on the Securities Markets Code 2025, which suggested an interim regulatory mechanism for VDAs, such as cryptocurrency platforms, through a recognised Self-Regulatory Organisation (SRO). These regulatory bodies will operate under regulatory oversight until the government introduces a comprehensive framework.

Cryptocurrency exchanges such as CoinDCX and CoinSwitch praised the move as a pragmatic approach to India's current VDA ecosystem.

#### KEEN OBSERVATION

"The Committee made some very keen observations that validate the realities of our industry. While the proposed Code adopts a technology-neutral definition of securities, most VDAs do not fit neatly into traditional legal definitions of securities or derivatives.

Despite this, VDAs are increasingly traded as financial assets, exhibiting clear features of price discovery, tradability on organised platforms, and significant retail participation," said Sumit Gupta, Co-founder of CoinDCX.

Stating that the proposal correctly identifies the position of VDAs within the regulatory grey area of India's securities framework, Edul Patel, Founder and CEO of Mudrex, said, "The committee's observations echo the industry's long-standing concern that the lack of consumer protections and market conduct norms leaves investors with limited remedies against fraud, market manipulation, and other risks, while also stunting market development."

#### HIGHER PARTICIPATION

Recently, the crypto sector has witnessed growing retail participation in these assets, accelerated last year by market performance, according to Snigdhaneel Satpathy, Partner at Saraf and Partners.

"SROs seem convenient. However, SROs in India are always open to interpretation by Indian companies. They cannot levy penalties nor do they possess investigative powers. There are macro risks they cannot address, such as cross-border issues. So this is more of a stop-gap measure," he said.

Nonetheless, SROs act as an interim middle ground while the government prepares to regulate this emerging asset class.

Going forward, the lawyer advised companies to prioritise grievance redressal mechanisms when establishing their regulatory bodies, a move that the crypto industry association has been working on even before the committee report.

the hindu businessline.
SATURDAY - JULY 25, 2026

# Factory reset

*Smartphone production scheme improves upon PLI*

**India's mobile phone manufacturing story has been one of the most striking successes of the country's industrial policy over the past decade. From just two manufacturing units in 2014 to more than 300 today, and from production worth ₹18,000 crore to nearly ₹5.5 lakh crore, the sector has expanded at an extraordinary pace. Annual output now stands at around 325-330 million handsets, with almost the entire domestic demand being met through local assembly.**

Exports have surged from a negligible ₹1,566 crore to over ₹2.6 lakh crore, making smartphones one of India's fastest-growing export categories. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme deserves much of the credit for transforming India into a major global assembly hub. Yet, beneath these numbers lies an uncomfortable reality. India has excelled in assembling phones but captures only a fraction of the value they generate. Most high-value components — chipsets, displays, camera modules, printed circuit boards and other electronic parts — continue to be imported. Domestic value addition has remained stuck at around 20 per cent. As a result, the electronics import bill crossed $110 billion in FY26. It is this gap that the new ₹62,500-crore Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) seeks to address. The scheme marks an important shift in policy thinking. Unlike the earlier PLI, which largely rewarded incremental production, the MPMS explicitly incentivises deeper localisation.

Manufacturers will earn incentives of 2.25-5 per cent on eligible sales, with an additional incentive tied to domestic sourcing of components and sub-assemblies. Companies investing in product design and R&D will receive an extra incentive, signalling that the government wants India to participate in innovation, not merely production. The timing is opportune. The disruptions caused by the pandemic, geopolitical tensions and trade restrictions have prompted MNCs to diversify manufacturing beyond China through "China+1" and friend-shoring strategies. India has already emerged as a preferred destination for final assembly. The next challenge lies in ensuring that the supplier ecosystem follows.

This is where the MPMS, working alongside the proposed ₹1.25 lakh crore India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0, could prove transformative. Incentivising component manufacturing alongside handset production could reduce import dependence. However, incentives alone cannot build a globally competitive ecosystem. Component manufacturing demands reliable infrastructure, affordable logistics, skilled manpower and a predictable regulatory regime. India's automobile industry offers an instructive parallel. Its emergence as a global automotive manufacturing hub was driven not merely by vehicle assembly but by the development of dense supplier networks around manufacturing clusters. The mobile phone industry must now undergo a similar transition. Private industry has to respond with long-term investments rather than viewing incentives as short-term subsidies.

## POCKET

RAVIKANTH


# Delimitation impasse: A way out

**BALANCING ACT.** A formula that dilutes the population increase criterion can reduce the North-South seat imbalance

GOVIND BHATTACHARJEE

**COMPENSATION.** States with better fertility rates can be rewarded with fiscal incentives or Finance Commission transfers PTI

The debate on delimitation seems to have opened up old wounds in our federal democratic polity and is threatening to ignite the North-South debate once again, with the southern States fearing loss of their political influence and voice in national policymaking.

The northern States are clamouring for equal representation (frozen through the 42nd Amendment to the Constitution since 1976, based on the 1971-population).

By the next Lok Sabha election in 2029, the average population represented by one Lok Sabha member would increase 2.7 times from only a million in 1971; but this increase would become extremely unbalanced between the northern and southern States. Thus, an MP from Bihar, UP, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala would represent respectively 3.5, 3.1, 2.7, 2.0 and 1.8 million people.

If delimitation is done according to the present Lok Sabha strength and the respective populations of States, Bihar and UP will gain about 10-11 seats each, while Tamil Nadu would lose 10-11 and Kerala 7-8 seats.

Naturally, southern States are very concerned. The government's proposed solution of increasing the total Lok Sabha seats to 850 and retaining the proportion of each State as under the present Parliament (while also implementing women's reservation from the next Lok Sabha) has already been rejected by Parliament. Any proposal to increase the Lok Sabha strength while allocating the seats based on population is unlikely to allay the fears of the southern States about a possible redistribution of political influence towards the BJP-ruled Hindi-speaking belt.

### EQUALISATION MOVE

In a lucid article in the Economic & Political Weekly, Prof. Amitabh Kundu has provided an analytical framework, arguing that population-based representation would increase equality but would be politically fractious. But a redistribution by adding extra seats to the current state representation based on their proportional population growth since 1971 could make the process more acceptable. An example is given in the accompanying table.

Arriving at an alternative formula is important. The issue here is that after two or three future delimitations, existing distortions may become cumulative and inherited inequalities become entrenched. Then no amount of statistical analysis can rectify the underlying inequality, potentially destabilising our federation's future.

**Suggested formula**

| State | Existing seats based on 1971 population | Seats based on projected 2029 population | Existing Seats + Seats due to increase over 1971 population |
|---|---|---|---|
| Total Lok Sabha seats | 543 | 815 (50% increase) | |
| Tamil Nadu | 39 | 45 | 55 |
| UP | 80 | 144 | 132 |

The delimitation debate revolves around a few fundamental questions: (i) that the 1976 freeze on seats implies that federal accommodation has become an enduring Constitutional principle; (ii) delimitation must achieve a balance between electoral equality and federal accommodation; and (iii) States which have attained low fertility deserve continued Constitutional protection through enhanced Parliamentary representation.

But the 42nd-Amendment freeze was a political compromise designed to address an exceptional historical situation. It never supplanted the underlying Constitutional logic embodied in Articles 81 and 82 that the ratio between population and seats should be broadly the same for all States, needing adjustments after every census. Hence, a temporary Constitutional arrangement cannot become a permanent Constitutional norm.

**Unlike in many other federations where territorial equality is secured through the upper chamber, our Rajya Sabha lacks a true federal character**

Further, Constitutional debate is more complex than a mere balance between electoral equality and federal compromise; it deals with equality among States, but more importantly, equality among citizens. Lok Sabha being the House of the People, the Constitution places citizens at the centre of democratic representation. Any departure from this sacrosanct principle would undermine democracy itself. A citizen cannot possess greater Parliamentary influence merely because his or her State successfully implemented family planning.

### FISCAL REWARDS

Of course, attaining low fertility was a national objective and deserves recognition and rewards, but it does not follow that the rewards must come only through higher political representation and permanently enhanced voting power than the population warrants; they may rather come fiscally, through Finance Commission transfers or other mechanisms.

Democratic representation will then be dissociated from development policy, which will offer better incentives. Besides, it would be unfair to penalise non-performing States — their inability does not necessarily reflect their unwillingness or inefficiency. Fertility is a product of many historical and structural factors including economic development, female literacy, urbanisation, health infrastructure, infant mortality etc. which may not always be within a State's control.

As Kundu has pointed out, unlike in many other federations where territorial equality is secured through the upper chamber, our Rajya Sabha lacks a true federal character. But in all federations, the lower house representation is based on proportionality to population, and there is no reason India should be an exception for preserving what some may perceive as federal equity. If the Constitution must be amended, why should it not give equal representation to all States in the Rajya Sabha, instead of changing the Lok Sabha?

I would rather argue that proportionality in representation is an inviolable Constitutional principle, and all delimitations must restore this proportionality which has to be done gradually, over the next two or three delimitation cycles. At the same time, we must reform representation in the Rajya Sabha to give greater federal powers to smaller States, whether by equal representation or by weighted voting so that each State gets the same votes.

Delimitation should also be a statutory mechanism, like the Finance Commissions, and not dependent on political discretion.

*The writer is a former Director General, CAG of India and a Visiting Professor, IIM, Calcutta*

# UPI has turned into a major privacy breach

Payment providers should allow for showing only relevant information. A user name can be provided to an account holder

M Muneer

My niece recently discovered a fascinating new feature of India's digital payments ecosystem. When she at times paid an auto/taxi driver or small merchant using UPI, strangers began sending her WhatsApp messages. Some were merely curious. Others were conversational. A few displayed the confidence of people who believe a ₹143 payment for an auto ride constitutes the beginning of a meaningful relationship.

She had not joined a social networking platform. She had simply paid for transportation. Somewhere between scanning a QR code and receiving a payment confirmation, her mobile number had apparently become public property, along with her name. Welcome to one of India's most under-discussed privacy problems: The QR code that knows too much!

When consumers make payments through UPI applications such as G-Pay, PayTm or PAyU, details such as names and sometimes mobile numbers can become visible to merchants. In most cases this is intended to facilitate transactions. In some cases, however, it also facilitates unsolicited calls, WhatsApp messages and social media searches — soliciting dates, money and even selling other services.

India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, attempts to address precisely such situations. The Act is built around a radical concept that should not be controversial: personal data belongs to the individual. Not to merchants. Not to payment intermediaries. Not to random strangers who happened to receive money.

Private data so collected cannot be used beyond the purpose for which it is collected and a breach is violation of the law. Consent matters. Purpose limitation matters. Privacy matters. At least on paper.

In India, customer databases circulate like festival sweets. Many organisations continue treating personal data as a business asset rather than a customer trust. A transaction becomes surveillance.

### CAUTIONARY STEPS

What should payment providers do to end this menace? Celebrating record transaction volumes while quietly leaking customer privacy is rather like a bank boasting about its vault while leaving the front door open. A few sensible measures are overdue:

* Hide customer phone numbers from merchants wherever possible.

* Show only the information required to complete the transaction. Perhaps a user name can be provided to each account holder?

**UPI.** Privacy concerns ALLEN EGENUSE J

* Provide one-click reporting for harassment linked to payment transactions. Customers should not need a detective agency to report misuse.

* Create temporary communication channels when necessary, instead of handing out permanent access to personal numbers.

* Constitute audit trails whenever customer information is misused.

* Educate merchants about privacy obligations and the consequences of treating customer data as a complimentary gift.

Consumers also need defensive habits. Use privacy settings available within payment applications. Avoid showing unwanted information on public profiles. They may consider separate phone numbers for such payments. Report merchants who misuse personal information and block unsolicited contacts immediately. Most critically, refuse to accept such behaviour. The phrase "It happens all the time" is not a privacy policy.

UPI might be a great success, but trust is the real currency. Consumers will continue embracing digital payments only if they believe their personal information remains protected. The issue is not just about unwanted messages but about consent, dignity and about maintaining boundaries between commercial transactions and personal lives.

My niece only wanted to pay for a ride. She did not enrol in a social networking service. She did not consent to becoming discoverable by strangers. She certainly did not agree to participate in India's newest unofficial matchmaking platform.

In the digital economy, the most valuable asset is not data. It is trust. Money transferred through UPI should reach the merchant. The customer's phone number should not.

*The writer is a Fortune-500 advisor, start-up investor and co-founder of the non-profit Medici Institute for Innovation*

## LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

**Skyroot's success**

Apropos "Launching pad" (July 24). Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 launch marks a milestone for India's private space sector. It proves that Indian enterprise can build and fly an orbital-class rocket, but the real challenge now lies in turning technological success into commercial sustainability.
Space ventures thrive not only on innovation but on reliability, cost efficiency and global competitiveness. To succeed, Skyroot must adapt to reusable launch models, strengthen cybersecurity and explore dual-use applications such as defence payloads. India's private space industry needs policy support, investment and export flexibility to grow beyond symbolic achievements. The Vikram-1 mission shows the rocket can be built; the next step is building a business that keeps India's space ambitions soaring.

**K Chidanand Kumar**
Bengaluru

**Equipping engineers**

This refers to the article 'Producing engineers for a changing world' (July 24). Universities and colleges produce lakhs of engineers every year. Except a fraction, some switch over to jobs unrelated to their academic background to make a living and many become unemployed. Late 1990s saw a boom in engineering colleges offering Information Technology and Electrical and Electronics Communication. Electrical mobility is picking at unimaginable speed and there is a shortage of skilled professionals. The traditional four-year Electrical Engineering course needs to be strengthened with more focus on current day changes occurring in the electrical sector including electrical vehicles. Green energy is yet another field, the universities and colleges must think of offering specialised and exclusive courses to cater to the demands of the changing world. Precision farming and agricultural technology to mention a few. The curricula designed must focus on national priorities and strategies in mind. UGC has a greater role to play.

**RV Baskaran**
Pune

**The global oil storm**

Oil prices are rising quickly past $99 a barrel and could soon reach $125. This big price shock happens because the main sea route the Strait of Hormuz has stayed closed for 13 days. At the same time dangerous attacks in the Red Sea are making shipping even harder for everyone. Countries like India have used up much of their emergency oil reserves to keep prices low but this help will not last long. Russian oil refineries are also damaged so cheap oil imports are ending. To protect our economy the government must act now. We need to stop relying only on foreign oil and quickly move toward green energy before this crisis gets worse.

**Vijaykumar HK**
Raichur

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## QUICKLY.

**Coforge bags $230 million deal from European client**

**Bengaluru:** Coforge has announced a five-year contract valued at over $230 million for an AI-led transformation engagement with a major client in Europe. This strategic engagement represents one of the largest AI-led transformation programmes secured by the company in the region. The programme will combine modern low-code/no-code platforms with AI-powered automation and accelerated, AI-infused software development practices to transform business operations for the client. OUR BUREAU

**Forex reserves jump $1.08 b to $676 billion: RBI data**

**Mumbai:** The country's forex reserves jumped by $1.08 billion to $676.237 billion during the week ended July 17, according to RBI data released on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the overall forex kitty had jumped by $964 million to $675.157 billion. For the week ended July 17, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by $4.549 billion to $551.057 billion, the central bank's data showed. PTI

# FM asks CBDT to clear backlog of pending appeals

**CURBING LITIGATION.** Outlines framework featuring 5 priorities, 3 pillars, 7 core principles

**Shishir Sinha**
New Delhi

**REFORM BLUEPRINT.** Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman being welcomed by CBDT Chairman Ravi Agrawal

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman expressed concern on Friday over the massive backlog of pending income tax appeals, urging the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) to conduct a thorough review. To curb litigation and offer greater certainty to taxpayers, she outlined a comprehensive framework featuring five priorities, three pillars and seven core principles.

"The total pendency declined by over 34,000 cases, to 5.4 lakh appeals," she said while addressing taxmen on Income Tax Day.

However, she noted that the volume of pending appeals remains critically high, warning that if the backlog continues to grow at its current pace, it could take a century to clear. "I appeal to the board that you should have one more review to see how you are going to handle this."

She highlighted that following the revised monetary thresholds announced in the FY25 Budget, 6,000 departmental appeals had been withdrawn, freeing resources for cases with substantial questions of law. Therefore, "the implementation of the Income Tax Act, 2025 must be accompanied by consistent guidance and continuous engagement with taxpayers, professionals and industry," she said.

### FOCUS ON 5RS

The Minister asked the IT Department to focus on 5Rs for Responsive Tax Governance. First one is 'Recognise' every taxpayer's concern promptly, acknowledging that all grievances deserve timely attention. Second is 'Respond' with clarity, courtesy and empathy, ensuring taxpayers receive meaningful communication at each stage. Third is 'Redress' genuine grievances fairly and within timely defined timelines, delivering timely and reasoned resolutions. Fourth is 'Reflect' on the root causes of recurring grievances, using complaints as an opportunity for institutional learning. And fifth is 'Reform' the processes, systems and procedures continuously so that similar grievances become increasingly rare. "Our approach should ensure convenience for the honest taxpayer, an opportunity to correct bona fide errors, and firm consequences for deliberate evasion," she said.

She asked taxmen to ensure convenience for honest taxpayers and take firm action against evasion. "Tax certainty is an economic imperative," she said.

Emphasising the need to be empathetic, Sitharaman said the department should know how to draw a line between those deliberately evading taxes and those committing bona fide errors.

### 3 PILLARS

Sitharaman emphasised on shifting long-term objective must shift from 'litigation management' to 'litigation prevention'. It should rest on 3 pillars: Clarity in taxpayer obligations through timely circulars, Consistency of interpretation across jurisdictions; and Continuous Institutional Learning from appellate orders to inform future reform.

Talking about path for Viksit Bharat by 2047, she advocated seven broad principles for the Income Tax Department. These include deepen voluntary compliance, continue simplifying the taxpayer experience, further strengthen tax certainty at the implementation level, harness technology responsibly, build institutional excellence, strengthen public trust and embrace continuous improvement.

# AI productivity offsets wage hikes, supports IT margins in Q1

**Sanjana B**
Bengaluru

Top IT services companies saw operating margins come under pressure in the June quarter as annual wage hikes, investments in AI and large-deal execution weighed on profitability. However, executives said AI-led productivity gains, operational efficiencies and currency tailwinds helped cushion the impact, with companies expecting margins to improve over the rest of the fiscal year.

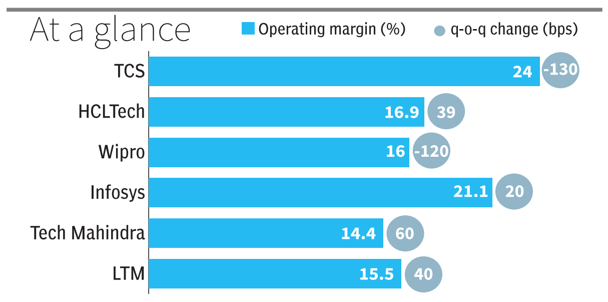
For TCS, operating margin for the June-ended quarter was 24 per cent, declining 130 bps sequentially. In the quarter, the company rolled out annual increments for its global workforce, which impacted margins by 170 bps.

"We strengthened our partnership ecosystem and made targeted investments, which we could partly offset with 40 bps of currency benefit and operational efficiencies. We saw a 170-bps impact due to salary increments. We want to exit at 25 per cent plus and strive to achieve it sooner rather than later," said Samir Seksaria, CFO, during the company's Q1FY27 earnings conference call.

Meanwhile, Wipro's operating margins for the quarter were 16 per cent, after a 1.2 per cent year-on-year decline because of the incremental impact of salary increase, ramp-up of large deals won earlier, and ongoing investments in AI. This, however, was partially offset by the rupee depreciation benefits and other operational efficiencies.

"The drop of 120 bps in margins is the impact of merit salary increases coming into this quarter. Second is the investments in AI and in deals, and third, some acquisitions are in execution mode. Our mission is to go back to the narrow band of 17- 17.5 per cent," said Srini Pallia, CEO & MD, Wipro.

Pallia said traditional large deals focused on cost optimisation and vendor consolidation tend to face margin pressure, as companies often invest upfront to build long-term client relationships. In contrast, net-new AI transformation projects under its Reimagine AI portfolio deliver much better margins.




Source: company reports

### AI DRIVE

Analysts said AI-driven productivity gains were the biggest support for margins in the June quarter, helping offset annual wage hikes, large-deal transition costs and continued AI investments. They added that productivity improvements, workforce optimisation, better utilisation and AI-enabled delivery models are increasingly shaping margin performance.

"Operational efficiencies, automation and stable utilisation also supported margins, while currency movements provided a modest tailwind for some providers. Operating margins should remain broadly stable through FY27; however, providers will face increasing pressure to share AI-led productivity benefits with clients through pricing negotiations and outcome-based commercial models. Margin sustainability will depend on the ability to monetise AI through differentiated services, platforms and business outcomes rather than traditional labour-based delivery," said Biswajit Maity, Senior Principal Analyst, Gartner.

# Jubilant Ingrevia plans ₹600 cr annual capex, weighs $500-m buys

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

Deepak Jain, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director

After investing nearly ₹2,000 crore in capex over the past three years, Jubilant Ingrevia plans to spend another ₹500-600 crore annually to expand production of Vitamin B3, or niacinamide, used in skin creams, fortified foods and dietary supplements; Vitamin B4, or choline chloride, used mainly in poultry and animal feed; personal care actives used in shampoos and skincare products; and vitamin-mineral premixes blended into infant food, health drinks, flour, edible oils and supplements.

The company will also keep open the option of acquisitions exceeding $500 million to build scale in personal care, nutrition, contract development and manufacturing (CDMO), and semiconductor chemicals, Deepak Jain, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, told *businessline*.

"We intend to invest at least ₹500-600 crore every year in new plants to support our organic growth under Pinnacle," Jain said. He added that Jubilant was targeting 20-25 per cent annual growth in both revenue and EBITDA in FY27, with specialty chemicals and nutrition expected to lead the expansion.

### CONSUMER DEMAND

Jubilant will use the investment to expand niacinamide and nutrition operations at Bharuch, commission a multi-purpose plant at Gajraula by this year-end, and develop cleanroom and pilot capabilities for semiconductor chemicals at its Greater Noida R&D centre.

The strong demand is reflected in the financial performance. Revenue increased from ₹4,178 crore in FY25 to ₹4,388 crore in FY26, while EBITDA rose from ₹557 crore to ₹607 crore.

In Q1 FY27, revenue jumped 25 per cent year-on-year to a 15-quarter high of ₹1,300 crore, with EBITDA up 36 per cent to ₹209 crore and net profit rising 41 per cent to ₹106 crore.

Nutrition and health solutions grew 36 per cent to ₹243 crore, specialty chemicals rose 11 per cent to ₹533 crore, and chemical intermediates increased 38 per cent to ₹524 crore.

### FY30 ROADMAP

With debt maintained at ₹700-800 crore and net debt-to-EBITDA below 1x, Jubilant remains open to acquisitions that fit its strategy.

Under its Pinnacle roadmap, the company aims to triple revenue and quadruple EBITDA by FY30. Jubilant currently employs over 2,300 people across six manufacturing facilities in India.

# Fractal Analytics Q1 profit grows 92% to ₹72 cr

**Vallari Sanzgiri**
Mumbai

Fractal Analytics reported a 92 per cent growth in net profit at ₹72.3 crore for the June-ended quarter led by good momentum in healthcare, BFSI, and retail segments. Sequentially, profit declined 37 per cent due to employee expenses, depreciation and amortisation.

Operating revenue grew to ₹912.5 crore, a growth of 20 per cent year-on-year and 3 per cent quarter-on-quarter. Gross margin in Q1 was at 46 per cent, while adjusted EBITDA margin expanded by 189 bps y-o-y to 17 per cent.

"Enterprises are putting real transformation budgets behind AI now and we're seeing it directly in the size of the deals coming to us. TMT was the drag on our headline growth this quarter. Excluding TMT, our business grew 35 per cent y-o-y, which is a better read on the underlying demand we're seeing.

"As data sovereignty becomes a bigger priority for governments and enterprises, and as open-weight models keep improving, clients need a partner who can work across models and infrastructure. We have invested heavily in our people, our research, and our own intellectual property to be that partner," said Srikanth Velamakanni, Group CEO and Executive Vice-Chairman.

The healthcare and life sciences business clocked 69 per cent growth y-o-y. Banking, financial services and insurance grew 36 per cent y-o-y while consumer packaged goods and retail grew 19 per cent. TMT declined 22 per cent.

# Swiggy bets on execution over discounts as q-comm rivalry intensifies: CEO

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Swiggy Group Chief Executive Officer Sriharsha Majety

Quick commerce will continue to draw fresh investments and new entrants, but the next phase of competition will be determined by execution rather than aggressive discounting, Swiggy Group Chief Executive Officer Sriharsha Majety said in the company's FY26 annual report.

As competition intensifies with Blinkit expanding its lead, Zepto preparing for an initial public offering, and Flipkart rapidly scaling Minutes while gearing up to launch its food delivery business, Majety said Swiggy's strategy is centred on building a differentiated and sustainable business.

"Our answer is to build a business that wins through a distinctive product offering, not only through price," Majety wrote. "Quick delivery is increasingly becoming table stakes. The right to win will come from reliable availability, breadth of assortment, differentiated categories, strong partner brands and the ability to make Instamart a destination for everyday upgrades, not just everyday essentials."

The comments come as India's quick commerce sector is witnessing heightened competition, with players aggressively expanding dark store networks, investing in logistics infrastructure and broadening product categories beyond grocery to drive higher wallet share.

Majety said Swiggy had consciously avoided chasing growth at any cost, instead focusing on improving the quality of its business.

"Our strategy was not to pursue volume at any cost. We focused on wallet share, basket quality, availability and operating leverage," he said

### DARK STORE FOOTPRINT

The company also indicated it is taking a more measured approach to expanding its dark store footprint after a phase of rapid capacity addition. Rather than aggressively adding new facilities, Swiggy is now focused on increasing utilisation of its existing network while selectively opening stores to improve coverage and remove bottlenecks.

At the end of FY26, Instamart operated 1,143 active dark stores, up from 1,021 a year earlier. Its total dark store area expanded to 4.8 million square feet.

Instamart continued to post strong growth during the year. Gross order value rose 94.1 per cent y-o-y to ₹28,496 crore, while net order value increased 69.9 per cent to ₹20,210 crore. Order volumes grew 44.4 per cent to 412 million during FY26, while average monthly transacting users rose 73.7 per cent to 12.3 million.

# Saraswat Co-op Bank aims to double its business to ₹2 lakh cr

**K Ram Kumar**
**Mahesh Ravidas Nayak**
Mumbai

Saraswat Co-operative Bank (SCB) has chartered out an ambitious growth plan to double its total business (deposits plus advances) to ₹2 lakh crore and become a pan-India bank within the next six years. The total business of the Mumbai-headquartered bank, which is India's largest urban co-operative bank (UCB), crossed the ₹1 lakh crore milestone to touch ₹1,06,625 crore as of March-end 2026.

Gautam E Thakur, Chairman of the 108-year old bank, said: "Crossing the ₹1 lakh crore total business milestone has been a long-cherished dream for us. Historically, urban cooperative banks have been viewed as relatively small institutions, but we wanted to demonstrate that a cooperative bank can also achieve scale. We not only reached the milestone but also exceeded it, ending the year (FY26) with total business of around ₹1.06 lakh crore. Today, our business has already grown to around ₹1.09 lakh crore."

Importantly, this growth has been accompanied by strong asset quality, with gross NPAs (non-performing assets) declining to around 1.8 per cent of gross advances (from 2.25 per cent as on March 31, 2025). Net NPAs have been at 'nil' level in the last four years.

Gautam E Thakur, Chairman, Saraswat Co-operative Bank

### BUSINESS GROWTH

Thakur said that about two decades ago, SCB, which began as a community credit society more than a century ago (1918), later became an urban co-operative bank (in 1933), had a business size of roughly ₹4,000 crore.

"Today, we operate in 11 States and one Union Territory with around 328 branches. Over the last 20 years, we have grown into a modern financial institution competing successfully with commercial banks. Our objective is to become a pan-India bank within the next six years.

"We plan to enter States such as Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, beginning with major cities like Chennai, Hyderabad and Visakhapatnam, before expanding deeper into those markets," he said.

Thakur emphasised that doubling of total business will be driven entirely through organic growth.

"Last year alone, our business grew by around 16 per cent. Even if we grow at 10-12 per cent annually, the ₹2 lakh crore milestone is comfortably achievable within six years. During this period, we will continue investing in technology, people, systems and processes," he said.

### RARE ACHIEVEMENT

Thakur highlighted that despite the bank's core equity capital being only around ₹325 crore, it has built a balance sheet exceeding ₹1 lakh crore, a rare achievement in Indian banking.

## QUICKLY.

### Juniper Green's ₹1,800-cr IPO to open on July 30

**New Delhi:** Renewable energy company Juniper Green Energy on Friday said it will open its ₹1,800-crore initial public offering (IPO) for public subscription on July 30, with the issue closing on August 3. The IPO is entirely a fresh issue of shares, according to the company's red herring prospectus filed on Thursday. The anchor investor bidding will open on July 29. At the time of filing its draft papers with SEBI, the company had proposed to raise up to ₹3,000 crore through the public issue. Of the IPO proceeds, the company will use ₹683.24 crore to repay or prepay some of its borrowings. PTI

### Advanced Sys-Tek files IPO papers with SEBI

**New Delhi:** Advanced Sys-Tek has filed preliminary papers with SEBI to raise funds through an initial public offering (IPO). The proposed IPO comprises a fresh issue of shares aggregating up to ₹98 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 26 lakh shares by existing shareholders, according to the draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) filed on Thursday. The Gujarat-based company proposes to utilise the net proceeds from the fresh issue primarily to fund its expansion plans and working capital requirements. Out of the total IPO proceeds, around ₹15.96 crore will be used for capital expenditure, including setting up a fabrication facility at its Vadodara plant and constructing a new building with related infrastructure, as per the DRHP. PTI

# Nifty, Sensex bleed for fifth day as surging oil price rattles D-Street

**BEAR ONSLAUGHT.** Rate-sensitive sectors such as private banks, realty indices plunge over 4% for the week

**Anupama Ghosh**
Mumbai

Brent crude crashing through the psychological $100-a-barrel mark sent Indian equities into a five-session tailspin, the longest losing streak in recent memory, as geopolitical flames from West Asia scorched investor confidence and put inflation fears back on the table.

The Nifty 50 closed at 23,767.45, down 0.43 per cent on Friday, its lowest closing level since June 12, 2026. For the week, the index shed 2.33 per cent, with all five sessions ending in the red.

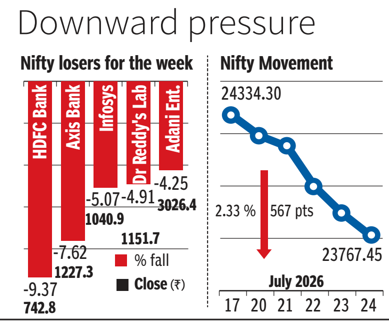
The Sensex mirrored the decline, falling 0.43 per cent for the day to close at 76,059, down 2,091 points (2.7 per cent) on a weekly basis.

The broader market wasn't spared either: the Nifty Midcap 100 fell 0.10 per cent to close at 61,622, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 slipped 0.32 per cent to 18,874. For the week, they fell 1.3 per cent and 2.2 per cent respectively.

"Inflationary fears intensified as the escalation of the West Asia conflict and the blockade at the Red Sea helped crude to cross the $100 per barrel mark," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd.

He added that the "...market expectations for a September rate hike have firmed up with both US and domestic yields edging higher during the week."

### Downward pressure




| FPIs Buy & Sell (₹ cr) | |
|---|---|
| July 17 | -214.96 |
| July 20 | -155.67 |
| July 21 | 3379.47 |
| July 22 | -7.14 |
| July 23 | -2777.12 |
| July 24 | -3892.77 |
| 2026 | |

Sectorally, the week's pain was concentrated in rate-sensitive pockets. Private banks and realty indices led the losses, each shedding over 4.5 per cent.

Auto, metals and energy also dragged. IT, media and PSU Banks closed with marginal gains on Friday. FMCG was the lone sectoral bright spot for the week, rising nearly 1 per cent, buoyed by strong quarterly earnings from sector leaders.

**BANDHAN BANK SLIDES**

Stock such as National Standard (22.56 per cent), Bandhan Bank (22 per cent), Solara Active Pharma (13.8 per cent) and Bajaj Healthcare (13.5 per cent) faced heavy selling pressure during the week.

On the institutional flows front, foreign institutional investors net sold equities worth ₹3,289.31 crore during the week, while domestic institutional investors provided a partial cushion with net inflows of ₹3,184.03 crore.

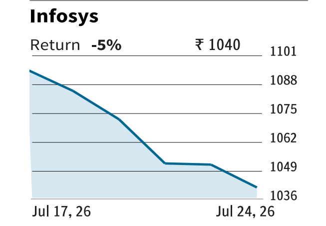
The week ahead is lined with critical macro triggers. "Investors will monitor the US Federal Reserve's policy decision, Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell's commentary and the Bank of Japan's policy meeting for further cues on the global interest rate outlook," said Siddhartha Khemka of Motilal Oswal.

# Post Q1 results, analysts trim target price for Infosys

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Infosys shares came under pressure on Friday following the company's Q1 results.

The tech major moderated its FY27 constant currency revenue growth guidance to 1.5–3 per cent and lowered the upper end of its earlier forecast. The stock closed flat at ₹1,040.90 on the NSE, hitting a low of ₹1,013.90 from the previous close of ₹1,047.40.




**BROKERAGES' VIEW**

Morgan Stanley maintained an 'Equal-weight' rating on Infosys and cut its target price to ₹1,075 from ₹1,112, calling the results worse than feared. Jefferies maintained a 'Hold' rating and cut its target price to ₹1,020 from ₹1,235. It said the worsening growth outlook is in the price and noted that the appointment of the CEO-designate may provide comfort on the CEO transition.

BofA maintained a 'Buy' rating but cut its target price to ₹1,300 from ₹1,570. It said Q1 demands a build-up in the rest of FY and highlighted good execution on the AI business and profitability.

Motilal Oswal reiterated its 'Buy' rating and set a target price of ₹1,170. Elara Capital revised Infosys to 'Accumulate' from 'Buy' and lowered its target price to ₹1,150 from ₹1,530. It said the steep cut in organic growth guidance was concerning, along with a contract termination by a client.

# Manipal Hospitals' IPO to open on July 29 at ₹560-590

**PT Jyothi Datta**
Mumbai

Healthcare's biggest IPO gets off the blocks with Manipal Health Enterprises Ltd (MHEL) looking to raise ₹9,275 crore. The price band of the IPO has been fixed at ₹560-₹590 a share. The issue will open on July 29 and close on July 31.

The funds would go towards pre-paying debt taken for its recent acquisition of the Pune-based Sahyadri Hospitals for over ₹6,000 crore, among other things, Dilip Jose, Manipal Health Enterprises MD and CEO, told *businessline*.

**EXPANSION PLANS**

Dilip Jose, MD & CEO, Manipal Health Enterprises

The Temasek and Ranjan-Pai backed hospital group is the country's biggest, with 13,000 beds and 49 hospitals. It has a pipeline of another 2,500 beds to be added in cities, including Mumbai.

With a presence in Bengaluru, Kolkata and Pune, he said Kerala, Hyderabad and the NCR are on the radar, besides plans to increase capital utilisation of hospitals upwards of 65 per cent.

The IPO is a fresh issue of up to ₹8,000 crore, and an offer-for-sale of up to 2.16 crore shares by promoters — Imperius Healthcare Investments Pte Ltd and Manipal Education and Medical Group India Pvt Ltd. Investors selling shareholders included TPG SG Magazine Pte Ltd, Seventy Second Investment Company LLC, Ammar Sdn Bhd, Novo Holdings Invest Asia A/S and Phoenix Bear Investments, LLC. The equity shares are proposed to be listed on the BSE and the NSE.

**TO BE DEBT FREE**

The OFS is about ₹1,200 crore, Jose said, adding that "investors are all staying on apart from that little dilution."

The company has a debt of ₹10,000 crore, and about ₹2,500 crore of cash — so the net debt is about ₹7,500 crore, he said, adding "with ₹8,000 crore coming in, we will be net debt free."

The largest stakeholder, Temasek (holding 51 per cent), would be the largest even after dilution. On the timing of the IPO, he said, "We believe good companies, good stories... would still attract investors. We started the exercise six, seven months ago and the war happened after that."

The hospital group's revenue from operations was ₹10,335.8 crore during FY26 and net profit stood at ₹916.5 crore.

# Axis MF front-running case: 21 entities fined ₹7.5 cr, face ban of up to 7 years

**Press Trust of India**
New Delhi

Capital market regulator SEBI on Friday levied fines totalling ₹7.5 crore on 21 entities, including Axis Mutual Fund's former fund manager Viresh Joshi, and barred them from the securities markets for up to seven years in a case related to front-running allegations.

Also, the ₹30.56 crore impounded in compliance with the directions of the interim order dated February 28, 2023, shall be treated as the disgorgement amount for all the entities, SEBI said in an 146-page final order.

The regulator also directed these entities to pay 12 per cent annual interest on the disgorgement amount.

SEBI said it had concluded that "Viresh Joshi, Sumit Desai, Pranav Vora, Vaibhav and along with the other noticees, namely, the Kurani Group apart from Prijesh, the Marfatia Group and the Jajoo Group colluded to execute a scheme to front run the orders of the Big Client".

"The *inter se* connections amongst the noticees (21 entities), the statements recorded, the consistent pattern of pre-positioning and squaring off, the continuous profits, mule accounts used, offshore structures and the coded identities used, collectively show that this scheme was well thought-out and executed to evade early detection," SEBI's Quasi-Judicial Authority Biju S said in the order.

The regulator noted that the illegal gains involved, along with the large investor base, reflect the scale of the market abuse. Accordingly, SEBI slapped a penalty of ₹3 crore on Viresh Joshi and ₹1 crore on Prijesh Kurani. Both were prohibited from the securities markets for up to seven years. It also penalised 19 other entities in the range of ₹5-65 lakh as well as restrained them from markets for up to seven years as well.

## BROKER'S CALL.

### IIFL Capital

**AYE FINANCE (BUY)**
Target: ₹220
CMP: ₹171.80

Aye Finance's Q1-FY27 PAT grew 144 per cent y-o-y and was in-line (adj. for ₹5.86 crore overlay), driven by NIM expansion and improving AQ. Excluding the overlay, CC would have been about 30 bps below reported levels.

After just 6 per cent PAT CAGR over FY24-26 despite around 25 per cent AUM CAGR, we believe Aye is at an inflection point and expect AUM/EPS CAGR of 28/41 per cent over FY26-28 on back of: 140 bps CC improvement over FY26-28, operating leverage as the branch network matures, and COF tailwinds from the recent rating upgrade and lower incremental COF.

Management indicated that the core micro-enterprise financing segment is showing positive signs, with business momentum remaining healthy despite the seasonally softer Q1 and no meaningful impact from the monsoon risks or from fuel price hike.

Management continues to evaluate new product opportunities such as gold loans (around 10-12 per cent of customers have gold loans) or Affordable HL over the medium term, although this remains a longer-term strategic initiative.

Aye Finance added 44,000 new borrowers (+38 per cent y-o-y) this Q, while maintaining underwriting discipline and AQ. Despite the improving earnings profile, Aye trades at FY28 PB/PE of 1.2/8.9x which is similar to MFI peers despite a more secured book and superior AQ outcomes vs MFIs (link) and comparable returns trajectory as Fivestar.

Retain Buy with TP of ₹220 (from ₹180) implying FY28 PB/PE of 1.6x/11.5x for ROA/ROE of 4.2/16.3 per cent.

### Choice Equity Broking

**UNITED SPIRITS (REDUCE)**
Target: ₹1,330
CMP: ₹1,468.20

Q1-FY27 volumes remained under pressure, declining 3.4 per cent y-o-y, primarily due to the continued impact of Maharashtra Made Liquor (MML) on the popular and lower prestige segments. Karnataka (6–7 per cent of P&A net revenue) is expected to show volume expansion in the next few quarters as prices were reduced by an average of 15 per cent. Although premiumisation remains intact with prestige and above (P&A) revenues growing 10.1 per cent YOY despite a 1.3 per cent volume decline, margin recovery is forecast to remain gradual driven by elevated glass and PET packaging cost offset benefits.

We now factor in a volume CAGR of 4.4 per cent (vs 5 per cent earlier) over FY26-FY29E, while improved realisation driven by premiumisation support a revenue CAGR of 11 per cent over the same period.

We expect EBITDA margin to remain broadly stable in FY27E before improving gradually as supply agility programme benefits accrue.

Although United Spirits' supply agility programme, India-UK FTA implementation and price reductions in Karnataka offer growth levers, we expect headwinds from increased competition intensity, elevated packaging cost and adverse MML policy to subdue growth in the medium-term. We have raised our TP to ₹1,330 (vs ₹1,230) using DCF, factoring in fresh drivers. We cut our FY28E net income estimate by about 3 per cent and maintain our Reduce rating on the stock.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

# 'We have the largest monthly SIP book of ₹4,000 cr'

**bl.interview**

**Suresh P Iyengar**
Mumbai

> SBI's distribution network is our biggest strength. SBI has around 55 crore customers, but only about 55 lakh currently invest with SBI Mutual Fund
>
> **DP SINGH**
> Deputy Managing Director, SBI Funds Management

Shares of SBI Funds Management, the country's largest fund house, got listed on the stock exchanges last week. It became the eighth fund house to be listed on the stock exchange.

DP Singh, Deputy Managing Director of SBI Funds Management, spoke on the outlook for the AMC business.

*Edited excerpts:*

**How do you see the volatility in SBI Funds share post listing?**

I do not want to comment on market movements. The IPO received an excellent response from the investors and is now up to them to take a call based on their investment strategy.

**How is the business performing so far this financial year?**

We closed March with an AUM of around ₹11.7 lakh crore.

As of now, the AUM has increased to about ₹13.1 lakh crore, an increase of ₹1.4 lakh crore. Of this, about ₹50,000 crore has come from net sales (net inflows) and about ₹90,000 crore has come from market appreciation. Our cost structure is largely stable, so changes in AUM can have a favourable impact on profitability. Since operating expenses do not vary significantly with higher AUM, a portion of the incremental fee income can contribute to profit growth.

**Do you see a slowdown in SIP flow?**

We currently have the largest SIP book in the country, collecting about ₹4,000 crore every month. Investors are increasingly understanding that mutual funds are the most efficient way to participate in equity markets. SIP investors continue investing through market cycles, and long-term participation remains very healthy.

Yes, short-term investors may have seen volatility, but investors who have been investing through SIPs over the past few years have generally earned positive returns. Long-term participation remains intact.

**How do you see growth ahead for the year?**

Our business trends indicate improving conditions. Last year, our AUM increased by ₹1 lakh crore.

This financial year, we have already added around ₹1.4 lakh crore. Net sales have increased. Corporate surplus cash and household savings continue to flow into MFs. In addition, upcoming initiatives like Universal KYC and SBI's YONO platform should make investing even easier, especially for SBI customers. The pension business is growing rapidly and now manages about ₹6 lakh crore AUM. Our stake in the pension business continues to create good long-term value.

**Has the reduction in distribution commission and levy of GST impacted inflows?**

No, not materially. The reduction was only about 5 basis points, and we shared most of the impact ourselves.

Since markets have appreciated, distributors' absolute earnings have actually increased. Therefore, there has been minimal impact on inflows or revenue.

**With many new AMCs entering the industry, do you expect market share pressure?**

Not significantly. Earlier, when there were only 15 AMCs, the top five controlled about 60 per cent market share.

Today, despite more than 50 AMCs, the top five still control around 55 per cent. The market opportunity remains enormous. SBI's distribution network is our biggest strength.

SBI has around 55 crore customers, but only about 55 lakhs currently invest with SBI Mutual Fund. Even modest increases in penetration provide a tremendous growth opportunity. As our AUM grows, profits should continue to grow because of operating leverage. Dividend income and retained earnings further strengthen the business model.

**What is your outlook for the SIF and MF industry?**

We were among the first to launch a SIF product and currently manage around ₹4,000 crore in this category.

We believe the industry could become close to ₹1 lakh crore opportunity in the next 18 months and we aim for a significant share of this opportunity.

Some consolidation is possible, but different players have different business objectives. We believe the overall industry opportunity remains large enough for sustained growth.

## Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 102.15 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Reliance Ind | 1278.00 | 8.56 | 19.62 | 7.93 |
| HCL Tech | 1271.00 | 6.06 | 19.78 | 1.23 |
| ITC | 283.45 | 4.53 | 16.90 | 2.51 |
| Axis Bank | 1227.30 | 2.70 | 13.66 | 3.24 |
| TCS | 2254.30 | 2.54 | 16.29 | 2.11 |
| Kotak Bank | 384.75 | 2.25 | 18.86 | 2.60 |
| State Bank | 1015.00 | 2.17 | 10.81 | 3.86 |
| Cipla | 1410.60 | 2.16 | 29.51 | 0.73 |
| Wipro | 177.12 | 1.44 | 14.00 | 0.47 |
| Trent Ltd. | 2890.50 | 1.14 | 89.54 | 0.88 |
| Jio Financial Services Ltd. | 234.71 | 1.11 | 75.00 | 0.71 |
| Maruti Suzuki | 13442.00 | 1.11 | 28.79 | 1.61 |
| Adani Enter | 3026.40 | 1.03 | 39.57 | 0.80 |
| HDFC Life | 555.05 | 0.96 | 60.64 | 0.55 |
| Tech Mahindra | 1559.50 | 0.51 | 29.60 | 0.91 |
| SBI Life | 1858.60 | 0.50 | 75.48 | 0.77 |
| Coal India | 427.40 | 0.18 | 8.48 | 0.94 |
| Tata Motors PV | 323.80 | -0.23 | 3975.00 | 0.62 |
| Bharat Elec | 405.00 | -0.27 | 48.83 | 1.33 |
| Max Healthcare | 1080.40 | -0.62 | 72.90 | 0.74 |
| NestleIndia | 1443.50 | -0.69 | 73.04 | 0.95 |
| JSW Steel | 1240.80 | -1.23 | 10.84 | 1.07 |
| Apollo Hosp | 8805.50 | -1.27 | 63.22 | 0.83 |
| NTPC | 347.20 | -1.45 | 12.22 | 1.51 |
| PowerGrid Corp | 288.20 | -1.58 | 16.83 | 1.20 |
| UltraTech Cement | 11846.00 | -1.60 | 40.73 | 1.29 |
| Bajaj Finserv | 1876.70 | -1.61 | 15.27 | 1.00 |
| Adani Ports | 1768.30 | -1.64 | 31.87 | 1.20 |
| L&T | 3785.60 | -1.74 | 27.48 | 4.07 |
| Titan | 4677.00 | -1.83 | 81.83 | 1.77 |
| IntGlobeAvi | 4985.00 | -1.90 | 0.00 | 1.04 |
| Dr Reddys Lab | 1151.70 | -1.94 | 30.20 | 0.65 |
| Grasim Ind | 3089.40 | -1.94 | 20.41 | 1.07 |
| ICICI Bank | 1432.90 | -2.66 | 17.20 | 9.43 |
| TataConsumerProduct | 1088.00 | -2.80 | 69.61 | 0.65 |
| Eicher Motors | 7628.00 | -2.81 | 37.97 | 0.97 |
| Tata Steel | 182.67 | -2.82 | 20.95 | 1.39 |
| Sun Pharma | 1941.10 | -2.98 | 40.47 | 1.89 |
| Asian Paints | 2637.90 | -3.05 | 57.58 | 1.10 |
| ONGC | 248.76 | -3.06 | 6.28 | 0.89 |
| Hind Unilever | 2145.00 | -3.26 | 47.63 | 1.75 |
| Bajaj Auto | 11130.00 | -3.71 | 26.93 | 1.13 |
| Hindalco | 942.80 | -4.06 | 15.82 | 1.25 |
| Infosys | 1040.90 | -4.98 | 14.33 | 3.35 |
| Shriram Finance Ltd. | 1005.10 | -6.33 | 23.59 | 1.29 |
| Eternal Ltd. | 280.00 | -11.21 | 624.04 | 1.86 |
| M&M | 3161.40 | -13.32 | 21.11 | 2.59 |
| HDFC Bank | 742.80 | -14.88 | 13.86 | 10.45 |
| Bajaj Finance | 1012.80 | -15.81 | 32.62 | 2.49 |
| Bharti Airtel | 1898.20 | -21.78 | 34.20 | 5.30 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

## Nifty Next 50 Movers ▼ 74.45 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| United Spirits . | 1467.20 | 42.24 | 63.26 | 1.76 |
| Ltimindtree | 4091.80 | 34.14 | 23.36 | 1.54 |
| Bank Of Baroda | 246.45 | 17.79 | 6.35 | 1.85 |
| Adani Energy Solutions . | 1702.20 | 17.56 | 66.17 | 2.26 |
| Adani Power . | 213.66 | 17.24 | 28.35 | 3.59 |
| Adanigreenenergy | 1395.10 | 14.81 | 107.08 | 1.89 |
| Union Bank | 170.50 | 11.79 | 6.30 | 1.33 |
| Rural Elec | 361.60 | 11.43 | 5.84 | 1.83 |
| Cholamandalamin&Fin | 1724.40 | 8.93 | 28.09 | 3.02 |
| Indian Hotels Co. . | 727.45 | 8.68 | 44.85 | 2.59 |
| Power Finance | 411.90 | 7.83 | 4.04 | 2.43 |
| Pidilitind | 1570.90 | 6.03 | 64.71 | 1.97 |
| Dlf | 645.20 | 5.59 | 36.18 | 1.68 |
| Bajaj Holdings | 10679.00 | 5.41 | 12.14 | 1.87 |
| Canara Bank | 125.65 | 4.20 | 6.37 | 1.71 |
| Indian Railway Finance Corp | 87.62 | 3.45 | 16.34 | 0.71 |
| Ambuja Cements | 425.15 | 2.90 | 19.22 | 1.07 |
| Punjab Natl Bank | 110.38 | 2.30 | 5.73 | 1.54 |
| Bpcl | 310.15 | 1.77 | 7.85 | 2.55 |
| Hindus Zinc | 531.95 | 1.12 | 16.25 | 1.04 |
| Godrej Consumer | 1059.50 | 1.05 | 58.24 | 1.72 |
| Siemens | 3689.80 | 0.90 | 85.73 | 1.32 |
| Tata Capital | 341.90 | 0.66 | 29.67 | 0.70 |
| Cummins Inida | 5600.50 | 0.59 | 65.73 | 3.06 |
| Vedanta | 264.65 | 0.25 | 6.53 | 1.82 |
| Samvardmothersoninternatl | 145.55 | -0.26 | 37.60 | 2.60 |
| Hyundai Motor India . | 1952.60 | -0.75 | 29.21 | 1.13 |
| Mazagoan Dock | 2293.80 | -1.13 | 33.58 | 0.71 |
| Hdfc Amc | 2505.70 | -1.78 | 36.44 | 2.07 |
| Macrotech Developers . | 1144.10 | -1.85 | 33.32 | 1.29 |
| Britannia Ind | 5379.50 | -2.91 | 51.07 | 2.57 |
| Shree Cement | 26740.00 | -3.30 | 55.17 | 1.45 |
| Zyduslifesciences | 1108.70 | -3.71 | 21.77 | 1.12 |
| Jindal Steel | 1035.80 | -6.57 | 31.44 | 1.55 |
| Varun Beverages . | 457.20 | -7.35 | 48.18 | 2.53 |
| Muthootfin | 2986.70 | -7.39 | 11.30 | 1.30 |
| Avenuesuper | 4018.80 | -7.59 | 85.73 | 2.62 |
| Tata Power | 374.40 | -8.48 | 23.38 | 2.53 |
| Solar Industries | 18494.00 | -8.99 | 96.37 | 1.82 |
| Hindustanaeronautics | 4573.40 | -10.53 | 33.55 | 3.51 |
| Tata Motors Cv | 406.15 | -10.62 | 49.39 | 3.43 |
| Bosch | 41755.00 | -12.23 | 44.41 | 1.47 |
| Gail (India) | 170.02 | -15.44 | 14.75 | 1.86 |
| Indian Oilcorp | 138.47 | -15.74 | 4.48 | 2.09 |
| Divis Lab | 7248.50 | -20.87 | 74.93 | 3.73 |
| Siemens Energy India . | 3240.20 | -22.26 | 88.10 | 1.16 |
| Abb India | 7375.50 | -23.26 | 98.91 | 1.57 |
| Cg Power & Ind Sol | 867.70 | -32.08 | 114.20 | 2.41 |
| Tvs Motor Cmp . | 3870.20 | -33.86 | 51.06 | 3.68 |
| Torrent Pharma | 4961.50 | -44.21 | 88.27 | 2.95 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

# Nityas Gems, Intellius Recode get SEBI nod to launch IPOs

**Press Trust of India**
New Delhi

Two companies — Nityas Gems and Jewellery Ltd and Intellius Recode Ltd — received SEBI's approval to raise funds through initial public offerings (IPOs), according to an update with the regulator on Friday.

**NITYAS GEMS**

Nityas Gems and Jewellery, which filed draft papers in March, received SEBI's observations during the week ended July 23. Its proposed IPO is entirely a fresh issue of 1.44 crore shares, according to the draft papers.

The company proposes to utilise the IPO proceeds towards meeting working capital requirements and for general corporate purposes.

**INTELLIUS RECODE**

Intellius Recode received SEBI's observations during the week ended July 24. The company filed its preliminary IPO papers in March. Its proposed public issue comprises a fresh issue aggregating up to ₹117 crore and an OFS of up to 12.9 lakh shares by existing shareholders.

Proceeds from the fresh issue will be used to fund the development of the company's digital workers, payment of sub-contracting fees related to their development, and for general corporate purposes.

Intellius Recode is a technology solutions provider focused on enabling digital transformation for enterprise clients.

# Caliber Mining and Logistics ends Day 1 with 23% gains at ₹528.20

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Caliber Mining and Logistics shares made a strong debut on the bourses on Thursday, listing at a premium of nearly 18 per cent at ₹500.25 on the NSE over the IPO price of ₹424. The stock closed with 23 per cent gains at ₹528.20 over the IPO price. On the BSE, the stock listed with an 18.8 per cent premium at ₹504 and settled at ₹528.20.

Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth, Swastika Investmart Ltd, said Caliber Mining & Logistics made a strong market debut, reflecting healthy investor confidence and positive response it received during the IPO.


**BUOYANT MOOD.** Nikhil Karwa (left), CFO and Mohit Chadda, CMD, Caliber Mining and Logistics, at the listing ceremony

Investors who received allotment could continue to hold the stock for the medium to long term, she said.

**ANCHOR INVESTORS**

The IPO was backed by marquee anchors, including Abakkus Fund (Sunil Singhania), Carnelian India Fund (Vikas Khemani), 3P India Equity (Prashant Jain), Helios Small Cap (Samir Arora), Quant Mutual Fund, Ashoka India Equity and Anchorage Capital Fund.

The Caliber Mining and Logistics IPO, which was subscribed 146.64 times, comprised a fresh issue of ₹400 crore and an OFS of ₹50 crore by the promoters.

# Talks fail to break deadlock over demand for Pradhan's resignation

**HARD TALK.** Govt sources rule out Minister's resignation, but CJP leaders say the demand is non-negotiable

**Dalip Singh**
New Delhi

A standoff has emerged between the Centre and protesters over the demand for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, with talks on Friday failing to bridge the divide despite the government succeeding a day earlier in persuading activist Sonam Wangchuk to end his 26-day fast.

Sources said there is no decision on Pradhan's resignation and he continues to have the backing of the party and the government.

Government interlocutors, Union Ministers JP Nadda and Jitendra Singh, held discussions with Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders, including spokespersons Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, at the Constitution Club in an attempt to end the month-long dharna at Jantar Mantar.

However, negotiations made no headway on one of the protesters' three key demands.

"We conveyed in very clear terms that nothing short of Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation or his removal from the Union Cabinet would be acceptable," Ranka told reporters after the meeting.

**WORDS OF COMFORT.** Social activist Sonam Wangchuk interacting with Union Health Minister JP Nadda and Union Minister of State Jitendra Singh in hospital PTI

**PROTEST TO INTENSIFY**

CJP leaders described the demand for Pradhan's resignation as "non-negotiable", and warned that the agitation would intensify if the government refused to act.

From the government's side, Union Health Minister Nadda said the Centre had "heard their points" and would respond in subsequent rounds of talks. Government sources, however, ruled out the possibility of Pradhan stepping down, saying that "resignation is the easiest decision to take."

Notably, the government's public messaging, including that of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has avoided addressing the demand for ministerial accountability.

In his outreach to agitating students and unemployed youth on Thursday, Modi announced the creation of fast-track courts for the swift trial of those involved in examination paper leaks and reiterated his government's commitment to protecting the future of young people.

However, he made no reference to calls for Pradhan's resignation.

The omission continued even after Wangchuk agreed to end his fast late Thursday following a meeting at Medanta Hospital in Gurugram with Nadda and Singh.

In a post on X, the Prime Minister wished Wangchuk a speedy recovery and urged him to regain his health but did not mention the demand for Pradhan's removal.

Wangchuk, announcing the end of his fast on X, said the decision followed "a long negotiation on various conditions and in view of possible violence in the country".

"Just now, in the presence of Union Ministers JP Nadda and Jitendra Singh and senior leaders of the Apex Body of Leh Ladakh, I finally broke my fast after 26 days. Earlier, 65 Members of Parliament from different political parties had visited or signed letters urging me to break my fast. This was done after a long negotiation on various conditions and in view of possible violence in the country," he posted.

**NO CASES FILED**

Reading out the government's assurances at the hospital in the presence of Wangchuk's wife, Gitanjali Angmo, and others, Nadda said the Centre was positively inclined not to register cases against those protesting peacefully at Jantar Mantar, or those who took part in the July 20 march to Parliament.

He also reiterated the government's assurance that Parliament would discuss paper leaks and examination reforms, and said the Centre was positively considering compensation for the families of students who died by suicide following the recent NEET paper leak controversy.

Even during these assurances, there was no public reference to the demand for Pradhan's resignation.

# SC to hear two petitions alleging police excesses on protesters

**Vijaita Singh**
**Aaratrika Bhaumik**
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has agreed to hear on Monday two freshly instituted petitions alleging police excesses during the July 20 crackdown on student protesters in the national capital. The development came hours after Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant clarified in open court on Friday that "no petition" had previously been filed on the issue and criticised "reckless" reports suggesting that the court had refused to list such a matter.

Earlier, the Delhi Police had denied using pellet guns against the protestors. The RAF, a specialised anti-riot force, had been deployed under the overall control of the Delhi Police during the July 20 operation. One of the injured protesters, 19-year-old Sahil Lochab, who risks losing vision in his right eye after a pellet pierced his pupil, met Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Friday.

Earlier in the day, during mentioning hours, when lawyers draw the court's attention to matters requiring urgent listing, the Chief Justice clarified that the apex court had received only a representation from a lawyer on Wednesday (July 22) and that no petition had been instituted. The observations came two days after the court declined to initiate *suo motu* proceedings on an oral request made by advocate Narendra Mishra to take cognisance of the alleged police brutality during the July 20 Parliament march organised by the CJP.

"Till morning 10 am, I tried to find out, no case had been filed... Not a single page has been filed in the Supreme Court. It was one representation... How can I treat the representation as a writ petition? And people start recklessly reporting this," the Chief Justice remarked while presiding over a Bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

Expressing concern over the reportage, the Chief Justice said sections of the media had engaged in "reckless" reporting.

"In the last two days, a completely false statement was made that a matter was filed, and the media is absolutely free from all responsibility, recklessly falsely reporting that the Chief Justice refused to list the matter," he said.

**'EXCESSIVE FORCE'**

Later in the afternoon, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan mentioned before the Bench that two petitions had since been formally instituted and assigned diary numbers. Seeking their urgent listing, he submitted that police personnel were continuing to use "excessive force" against student protesters.

Sankaranarayanan urged the court to intervene immediately, saying the alleged police violence was continuing on a daily basis. "This is happening on a daily basis... Some controls are necessary. The court stands between us and the police," he submitted.

Agreeing to hear the matter on Monday (July 27), the Chief Justice said: "Let it be listed. We will entertain it."

**LETTER PETITION**

During the hearing on July 22, Mishra had referred to a letter petition addressed to the CJI and urged the court to examine videos purportedly showing police personnel assaulting unarmed protesters.

He had also offered to place the videos before the court. However, the Chief Justice-led Bench declined the request, with the Chief Justice telling the lawyer not to "waste" the court's time. "We are not interested in videos. We don't have time to watch them," the CJI had said.

# Naresh Pal Gangwar named Higher Education Secy; Oppn criticises move

**Ankita Upadhyay**
New Delhi

In a major reshuffle in the Education Ministry, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved moving Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi to the Ministry of Panchayati Raj and appointing Animal Husbandry and Dairying Secretary Naresh Pal Gangwar as his successor.

According to the order issued on July 23, Joshi, a 1992-batch IAS officer of the Manipur cadre, will take over as Secretary, Ministry of Panchayati Raj, after the superannuation of Vivek Bhardwaj on July 31.

Following this, Sushil Kumar Lohani, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, has been named Officer on Special Duty in the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying and will assume charge as Secretary after Gangwar moves to the Higher Education Department.

**OPPOSITION REACTS**

Gangwar, of the Rajasthan cadre 1994 batch, recently came under public scrutiny following an investigation into horticulture subsidies received by members of his family under a Central government scheme. A news report said that Gangwar's mother, wife and son collectively received over ₹1.16 crore in subsidies over five years under the National Horticulture Board's scheme for commercial horticulture projects in Rajasthan. The projects were mainly for protected cucumber cultivation in Jaipur district.

The appointment of Gangwar as the Higher Education Secretary drew criticism from Opposition leaders, who questioned the government's decision in light of the recent controversy involving subsidies received by his family members.

CPI(M) Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas criticised the appointment in a post on X, saying, "The ultimate farce! While the nation demands accountability for exam scams & paper leaks, Govt appoints Naresh Pal Gangwar as the new Higher Education Secretary! This is the same IAS officer whose mother, wife & son collectively received over ₹1.16 crore in government subsidies under the National Horticulture Board scheme for "encouraging commercial crops" (cucumber cultivation). This the way PM ensuring accountability..."

Cockroach Janta Party founding president Abhijit Dipke also questioned the move and said that replacing one bureaucrat with another facing serious corruption allegations is a direct insult to young people across India.

**'INSULT TO YOUTH'**

"The government is rewarding corruption instead of ensuring accountability! Last night, the Education Secretary was transferred. He was replaced by an IAS officer from the Animal Husbandry Department who has severe multi-crore corruption charges against him," Dipke posted.

"The entire crisis around paper leaks and NEET was about systemic corruption. Replacing one bureaucrat with another facing serious corruption allegations is a direct INSULT to young people across India. Is this the compromise the government expects us to accept? This is not accountability. We will not stop until Dharmendra Pradhan resigns. Gangwar was serving as the Secretary in the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying," he wrote on X.

# SC seeks Centre's response to NEET reforms

**Aaratrika Bhaumik**
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday indicated that it would closely monitor the Centre's proposed overhaul of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) and directed the Centre to file a detailed response on whether it intends to shift the NEET-UG examination to a computer-based test (CBT) and the safeguards it proposes to put in place to protect examination data.

A Bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe observed that extraordinary measures, such as deploying the Indian Air Force to transport question papers during this year's re-NEET examination, could only serve as temporary fixes.

"We cannot let such a situation go on like this. We have to focus on institutionalisation... Here, because of what had happened, you deployed the Air Force, but that is only an ad hoc arrangement, not a permanent one," the Bench orally observed.

The hearing came a day after Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressed the alleged NEET paper leak controversy for the first time, announcing the creation of fast-track courts to ensure the expeditious trial of the cases amid the ongoing protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

People gathered at Jantar Mantar in support of the Cockroach Janta Party's protest in New Delhi on Friday ANI

The observations were made while the court was hearing a batch of petitions filed by the Federation of All India Medical Association (FAIMA), the United Doctors Front (UDF) and others seeking to replace the National Testing Agency (NTA) with an independent statutory body to conduct the examination.

At the outset, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Union government, submitted that the issue was receiving attention at the highest levels of the executive and that the Centre was making every possible effort to address students' concerns.

"The government is going 10 extra miles as children's problems have to be addressed... I can assure you from my personal knowledge, it is being monitored, supervised, and everything is being done at the highest executive level," Mehta said.

**PANEL SUGGESTIONS**

The Bench then turned to the reforms proposed by the seven-member High Level Committee of Experts (HLCE), constituted by the Ministry of Education in 2024 under former ISRO Chairman K Radhakrishnan to review the functioning of the NEET examination system.

The committee, which submitted its report in October 2024, recommended a series of structural reforms, including a transition to a computer-based examination. The court referred to the NTA's affidavit outlining the progress made in implementing those recommendations.

Questioning the proposed transition, Justice Narasimha expressed concern over the security of data to prevent further incidents of paper leaks. "Please reflect on that also and tell us... How is data transferred? How does data protection occur? That's very important because when you shift to this, leaks could occur, making data unsafe. And the entire thing breaks down," he said.

**BETTER CYBER NORMS**

The judge directed the Centre to file a further affidavit setting out its roadmap for implementing the reforms, including the proposed cybersecurity framework, the agency responsible for implementing it, and the safeguards that would be put in place, and the safeguards proposed to prevent data breaches.

Mehta informed the court that there had been developments since the earlier proceedings and that he would apprise the court of the new measures proposed on the next date of hearing.





# LMW eyes foray into EVs, renewables and robotics

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

LMW Ltd (formerly Lakshmi Machine Works Ltd), the Coimbatore-based textile machinery, CNC machine tools, precision castings and aerospace component manufacturer, has proposed amending the objects clause of its memorandum of association (MoA) to widen the scope of its business. The amendment will enable the company to enter into several emerging sectors, including electric vehicles, renewable energy and robotics.

In a stock exchange filing, the company said that, considering the evolving business environment, technological advancements and the emergence of new-age industries and technology-oriented businesses, its Board considered it appropriate to expand the scope of the objects to be pursued by the company.

The proposed amendment would allow LMW to undertake business in a range of sectors, including pharmaceuticals and life sciences, electric vehicles and mobility, renewable energy, electronics manufacturing, and robotics and automation, among others.

**SHAREHOLDER NOD**

According to the filing, the amendment is intended to facilitate future business growth and ensure that the Memorandum of Association appropriately reflects the company's evolving business objectives.

The Board has approved the proposal to amend Clause III(a) (Objects Clause) of the Memorandum of Association, subject to the necessary statutory and shareholder approvals.

Separately, LMW reported a five-fold increase in consolidated net profit for the first quarter ended June 30, 2026.

# First cohort of RDI Fund managers to be unveiled within a week, says official

**Sindhu Hariharan**
Chennai

The Union government's Research Development and Innovation Fund is set to announce and disburse money to the first cohort of around 20 Second Level Fund Managers (SLFMs) as early as in a week, a senior official said here on Friday.

"The first cohort we are almost near to conclusion; within a week's time, we shall be announcing the fund managers whom we are going to support in the first phase," said SP Singh, Nodal Officer In-charge, RDIF. The next phase is also set to favour emerging fund managers, he said.

He was speaking virtually at the IVCA (Indian Venture Capital Association) Chennai Circles 2026, an exclusive gathering of investors, fund managers, family offices, and other private market stakeholders to discuss India's investment landscape, organised by IVCA along with TVS Capital Funds and Anicut Capital.

Gopal Srinivasan, CMD, TVS Capital Funds, at IVCA Chennai Circles 2026 BIJOY GHOSH

Singh said that the government expects around ₹20,000 crore to be deployed every year, while briefly wondering if the innovation ecosystem was currently mature enough to absorb this.

"The recent geopolitical situation has made everyone realise that in times of crisis, any external dependence may be risky; the technological sovereignty is a must," he said. After working initially with government-supported institutions, the RDIF also plans to extend eligibility to private technology universities, research parks and academic institutions with research capabilities, in due course, in future cohorts, he added. He also urged Indian fund managers to think beyond ₹1,000-2,000 crore funds, and instead build ₹5,000-6,000 crore funds capable of providing domestic capital to start-ups through later stages.

Speaking at the event, Gopal Srinivasan, Chairman and MD, TVS Capital Funds, said that innovation and capital support are converging in India with the RDIF.

Speaking as a member of the investment committee of the TDB, a second-level RDI fund manager, he said the fund is expected to deploy about ₹4,400 crore this year by matching government support with third-party capital. Decisions are being made by private-sector professionals serving voluntarily, he said, calling it a new model of public capital with private expertise.

The IVCA Chennai Circles held on Friday was the first time that IVCA brought such an event to the city, indicating its growing private equity and venture capital ecosystem.

## QUICKLY.

### Crude oil retreats, but set for weekly rise


**London:** Crude oil futures prices fell over three per cent on Friday but are still set for hefty weekly gains because of concerns about disrupted energy flows in the Red Sea and fears of further escalation in the US-Iran war. Brent futures fell nearly $4 to $96.70 a barrel at 0946 GMT. US WTI futures were down $3.15 at $89.04. REUTERS

### Copper edges higher, heads for weekly gain

**London:** Copper prices ticked higher, on course for a small weekly gain as stocks outside the US tightened, offsetting macro concerns. Benchmark three month copper on the London Metal Exchange was up 0.2 per cent at $13,615 a tonne. Aluminium fell 0.9 per cent to $3,160. Zinc inched up 0.2 per cent to $3,591. REUTERS

### Gold holds steady ahead of Fed rate decision

Gold held steady as investors assessed developments in West Asia and their implications for inflation ahead of the US interest rate decision next week. Spot gold was unchanged at $4,046.10 per ounce by 1317 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery gained 0.3 per cent to $4,063.60. REUTERS

# Urad acreage up in North India as sowing picks up after recent rains

**REMUNERATIVE PRICES.** Coverage tops last year's levels by 8% as farmers in U.P. and M.P. plant more

**Vishwanath Kulkarni**
Bengaluru

For the first time this kharif season, urad (black matpe) acreage is higher than last year's levels by eight per cent as farmers in the northern States, such as Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, have expanded coverage. This is in view of the recent rains spurring sowing activity.

Per the latest data released by the Agriculture Ministry on Friday, the area under urad was 18.67 lakh hectares (lh) as of July 24, an increase of 8 per cent over 17.27 lh a year ago.

A week ago, the urad acreage was 13.51 lh (14.36 lh in corresponding last year). This week has seen an increase of over 5 lh, as farmers increased the area.

**PRICE FACTOR**

"There's a good recovery in the acreage in the past two weeks due to a pick-up in rains in some States. Farmers are preferring to plant urad as the prices are attractive. There's is a good demand for seeds and in some areas of Gujarat and Rajasthan, we feel farmers could take up resowing of urad," said Satish Upadhyaya, Secretary of the India Pulses and Grains Association (IPGA), the apex trade body.

While the overall area has increased, the output of urad will all depend on the rain during the September-October period, he said. In Madhya Pradesh, the largest urad-producing State, the area has increased by 13 per cent at 6.17 lh (5.48 lh).

Similarly, Uttar Pradesh has seen the acreage increase by a bigger margin.

Urad area has increased in the northern State by 75 per cent to 4.99 lh (2.84 lh).

Also, in Rajasthan, the area has increased by over 16 per cent to 3.25 lh (2.79 lh). In Gujarat, the area has increased by around 25 per cent to 0.49 lh (0.39 lh).

The delayed onset and slower progress of the monsoon in States such as Maharashtra and Karnataka impacted the urad area.

In Maharashtra, the urad acreage is down by 53 per cent at 1.6 lh (3.43 lh), while in Karnataka, the decline in area has been around 24 per cent at 0.71 lh (0.94 lh).

**Expanding coverage**

| | 2026 | 2025 |
|---|---|---|
| Madhya Pradesh | 6.17 | 5.46 |
| Uttar Pradesh | 4.99 | 2.84 |
| Rajasthan | 3.25 | 2.79 |
| Maharashtra | 1.6 | 3.43 |
| Karnataka | 0.71 | 0.94 |
| Chhattisgarh | 0.42 | 0.4 |
| **All India*** | **18.67** | **17.27** |

(Kharif urad progressive area sown in lakh hectares as on July 24) * Includes other States

**FAVOURING FACTORS**

Rahul Chauhan of IGrain India said the prevailing high prices could have attracted farmers' interest in the northern States.

Also, factors such as being a shorter-duration crop of 60-80 days and the requirement of less water compared to other crops are other reasons for it finding favour among farmers.

Trade sources in the South said they were pinning their hopes on the urad crop in the North to offset the decline in Maharashtra and Karnataka. "We are expecting only about a fourth of the crop to come in Maharashtra and Karnataka this year due to the less rain. We are hoping that the higher output in Madhya Pradesh will offset the decline in these States," said B KrishnaMurthy of Four P International in Chennai.

**WILTING FORTUNES.** A farmer from Aroor village of Sangareddy district in Telangana said his urad dal and tur dal crop, planted on eight acres, would have grown to four feet by mid-July had the district received adequate rainfall NAGARA GOPAL

## 'Monsoon deficiency above 10% affects kharif output'

**Our Bureau**
Mangaluru

The Union government has said that kharif output takes a hit whenever there is over 10 per cent monsoon deficiency.

In a written reply to a question on the impact of climate change and monsoon variability on food security in the Rajya Sabha on Friday, Ramnath Thakur, Union Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, said severe South-West monsoon rainfall deficiency is generally associated with a decline in kharif foodgrain production, particularly when the all-India rainfall deficiency exceeds about 10 per cent.

Major drought/El Nino years such as 1982, 1987, 2002, 2004, 2009, 2014 and 2015 witnessed rainfall deficits ranging from 12 to 22 per cent with varying impacts on kharif production, he said.

However, the adverse impact on production had moderated during the recent years due to increased irrigation coverage, adoption of improved and drought-tolerant crop varieties, better weather forecasting and propagation of advisories, improved input availability and crop management practices, contingency planning by the States and enhanced government interventions, he said.

Sowing operations are still underway for kharif 2026-27, and the first advance estimates for all major kharif crops in the 2026-27 agricultural year (July-June) have not yet been released, he said.

**CROP SWITCH**

The government said the decline in cotton production is due to a switch by some farmers to other remunerative crops.

Pabitra Margherita, Union Minister of State for Textiles, said the cotton production during the recent cotton seasons ranged from 352.48 lakh bales in 2020-21 to 290.91 lakh bales (provisional) in 2025-26. However, productivity remained broadly stable in the range of 428-451 kg/hectare during this period, he said.

During the recent period, global cotton prices increased by about 19 per cent, while domestic cotton prices increased by about 18 per cent, he said. To augment domestic availability, imports of raw cotton and cotton yarn are undertaken whenever required.

## Widespread rain likely over North, Central, West India

**Vinson Kurian**
Thiruvananthapuram

The swathe of extremely heavy rain that battered south Gujarat through Wednesday and Thursday shifted north overnight, soaking east and north Gujarat, with Ahmedabad, Kheda and Navsari districts bearing the brunt.

The exceptional heavy showers over east Gujarat until Friday morning followed a similar pattern that unfolded over south Gujarat the previous day.

Influx of moisture remained heavy from the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal as a freshly minted low-pressure area in the neighbourhood anchored them to explosive effect.

**RAIN OUTLOOK**

The IMD expects fairly widespread to widespread rainfall across large parts of North-West, Central and Western India over the coming week.

In North-West India, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir-Ladakh and Uttarakhand are likely to receive widespread rainfall into next week, while Rajasthan is expected to remain wet for two more days. Rain is forecast to spread to east Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi and Punjab from Monday, and to west Uttar Pradesh from Tuesday.

**TO THE BRIM.** A view of the overflowing Jhelum river as the water level rose after heavy rain in Srinagar on Friday ANI

Across Central India, widespread rainfall is expected over west Madhya Pradesh for the next two days, east Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh for seven days, and Vidarbha on Saturday before reviving again from Tuesday. Heavy rainfall is likely at isolated places over both east and west Madhya Pradesh on Saturday.

In West India, widespread rainfall is forecast over the Konkan and Goa for seven days, Madhya Maharashtra on Saturday, Marathwada on Friday, east Gujarat for five days, and Saurashtra and Kutch for the next three days. Heavy to very heavy rainfall is likely over the Konkan and Goa from Saturday, Madhya Maharashtra over the next three days, and Saurashtra and Kutch from Saturday.

Isolated very heavy rainfall is likely over east Gujarat on Saturday.

## Value-added coffee exports jump 46% in past three years

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

India's exports of value-added coffees increased by 46 per cent over the past three years to $686 million during 2025-26, according to the government.

In a written reply in the Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Commerce and Industry, Jitin Prasada, said the export of value-added coffee increased from $468 million to $686 million during the period 2023-24 to 2025-26, showing a growth of 46.58 per cent.

Overall, India's coffee exports touched $2,083 million during 2025-26, an increase of 15 per cent over t $1,803 tonnes the previous year.

Karnataka is the largest exporter of coffee, and the value of shipments was $1,398 million during 2025-26, followed by Andhra Pradesh at $339.33 million and Tamil Nadu at $93.08 million. India's coffee production during 2025-26 was 3.73 lakh tonnes (lt), an increase over 3.63 lt the previous year. Karnataka tops the list of coffee-producing States with an output of 2.56 lt, followed by Kerala with 80,350 tonnes and Tamil Nadu with 19,975 tonnes.

Andhra Pradesh is the fourth largest producer with an output of 15,290 tonnes.

**SUPPORT VIA ICDP**

The Minister said the Coffee Board helps to promote value-added coffees including freeze-dried instant coffees sold in retail packs, with the 'Coffees of India' logo in retail packs and also depicts the words indicating 'Made in India', he said.

The Board, through its Integrated Coffee Development Project (ICDP), provides support to the coffee curing units for upgrading the machinery through introduction of improved technologies in coffee processing at the curing state.

Besides, the Board also provides support to roast and ground units for establishment of coffee roasting, grinding and packaging machinery, he said.

Though the Coffee Board does not maintain the domestic coffee consumption data separately, it had assessed through a study done in 2023-24 that the domestic consumption was around 91,000 tonnes, out of total coffee production of 360,500 tonnes in 2023-24.

## Global steel output up 1.7% in June, India logs 4.5% rise

**Gayathri G**
Chennai

Global crude steel production rose 1.7 per cent year-on-year to 155.7 million tonnes (mt) in June 2026, driven by higher output in major producing regions, even as first-half production remained marginally lower than a year ago, according to the World Steel Association (worldsteel).

The 70 countries reporting to worldsteel, which account for about 98 per cent of global crude steel production, produced 155.7 mt during the month compared with June 2025.

However, cumulative output for January-June stood at 931.5 mt, down 0.7 per cent from the corresponding period last year.

Asia and Oceania, the world's largest steel-producing region, recorded output of 115.2 mt in June, up 1.5 per cent year-on-year.

Production in the European Union increased 4.6 per cent to 10.8 mt, while North America posted a 5 per cent rise to 9.5 mt. Africa reported the sharpest regional growth at 20 per cent to 2.2 mt.

In contrast, production declined in the Middle East by 13.4 per cent to 4 mt, Russia and other CIS countries plus Ukraine by 2.2 per cent to 6.8 mt, and South America by 0.3 per cent to 3.5 mt.

**CHINA'S OUTPUT UP**

China, the world's largest steel producer, increased output by 0.4 per cent to 83.7 mt in June, though its first-half production was down 3 per cent at 500 mt.

India retained its position as the second-largest producer, with crude steel output rising 4.5 per cent year-on-year to 14.1 mt in June.

India's production during the January-June period climbed 7.1 per cent to 87 mt — the fastest growth among the top five steel-producing nations.

## CMFRI launches app for digital documentation of deep-sea fish

**Our Bureau**
Kochi

Aimed at digitally documenting deep-sea marine biodiversity, the ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI) has launched DeepDATA, a mobile application that enables users to explore scientifically verified information on deep-sea fish species and contribute field observations to build a national digital repository.

Students, researchers, fishermen and anyone interested in India's deep-sea resources can browse photographs and access information on deep-sea fish species, including their taxonomy, distinguishing characteristics, distribution and conservation status.

The app was developed under the Deep Ocean Mission project with funding from the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

## Blenders, exporters lift prices of quality teas at Kochi auctions

**V Sajeev Kumar**
Kochi

Quality teas at the Kochi auctions fetched better prices across both dust and leaf categories, supported by blenders' and exporters' buying.

At sale 30, blenders remained active in CTC dust grades, while orthodox leaf teas attracted steady demand from CIS buyers, traders said.

**MARKET UPBEAT**

According to Anil George Joseph of the Tea Trade Association of Cochin, the CTC market is expected to remain firm in the coming weeks on festival demand, while the orthodox segment is likely to sustain its positive momentum, backed by healthy export orders.

The CTC dust market gained ₹2 per kg to an average of ₹153.88. Of the 6,61,231 kg offered, 73 per cent was sold, with blenders accounting for 72 per cent of the total CTC dust purchases. However, export and upcountry demand remained subdued, auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said. The orthodox dust market ruled firm to dearer, with exporters and upcountry buyers covering limited quantities. Of the 6,765 kg offered, 89 per cent was sold.

Demand from West Asia for orthodox leaf teas remained subdued, while CIS buyers were active. Of the 2,69,549 kg offered, 92 per cent was sold. Prices for whole-leaf and broken grades firmed up, while the remaining varieties traded irregularly at lower levels.

In the CTC leaf segment, broken and fannings grades were largely steady but showed an easing tendency. The sale recorded an 84 per cent clearance of the 34,775 kg offered.

## 'Current geopolitical crises reinforce need to strengthen India's farm resilience'

**Subramani Ra Mancombu**
Chennai

The current geopolitical environment, particularly due to the US-Iran conflict, highlights the need to strengthen India's agricultural resilience, said Komal Shah Bhukhanwala, Executive Director of SML Ltd (formerly Sulphur Mills Ltd).

"Escalating geopolitical tensions and energy volatility are exposing the risks of India's dependence on imported fertilizer raw materials and global supply chains," she told *businessline* in an online interaction.

**GOVT SUPPORT**

The government can support the sector by promoting high-nutrient-use-efficiency (NUE) fertilizers and advanced nutrient technologies that can reduce dependence on bulk fertilizers by 25-50 per cent, improve nutrient delivery and conserve resources, she said. Continued policy support for innovation, faster regulatory approvals, uniform GST for all grades of nutrients, export promotion and investment in advanced agricultural technologies will help strengthen India's food security while enhancing the global competitiveness of the domestic agrochemical industry, said the ED of SML, established in 1960.

Mumbai-based SML Ltd is one of the global leaders in innovative agricultural solutions, with operations in over 80 countries.

Komal Shah Bhukhanwala, ED of SML Ltd

**MARKET VOLATILITY**

Stating that tensions in West Asia had reinforced the need for greater resilience in the agricultural input sector, she said the direct impact on SML, however, has been manageable.

The conflict had increased logistics costs and market volatility, though.

"In the midst of such disruptions, we are providing solutions to farmers with steady supplies which help them improve yields and, despite bulk fertilizer disruptions, secure a stronger return on investment," said Bhukhanwala.

The situation underscores the importance of investing in innovative agricultural technologies and manufacturing, all made in India, that improve efficiency while reducing dependence on imported inputs, she said.

## IISR in pact with Spices Board to boost spice sector start-ups, export initiatives

**Our Bureau**
Kochi

The ICAR-Indian Institute of Spices Research (ICAR-IISR), Kozhikode, has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Spices Board to strengthen enterprise development and promote export-oriented start-ups in the spices sector.

Under the agreement, ICAR-IISR's Agventure Technology Business Incubator (TBI) will serve as the official incubation centre for the Spices Board's ASPIRE (Assistance to Spice Incubation Centres for Raising Entrepreneurship) scheme.

The partnership seeks to create an integrated ecosystem for nurturing technology-driven agricultural and spice-based enterprises.

The MoU was exchanged between MS Manivannan, Secretary, Spices Board, and Sajesh VK, Senior Scientist and Secretary, Agventure TBI, ICAR-IISR.

**VALUE-ADDITION**

The collaboration will provide start-ups, MSMEs, spice exporters and farmer producer organisations (FPOs) with end-to-end institutional support, including joint research, technology transfer, product development, incubation, business mentoring and guidance on accessing funding and export markets.

**The partnership seeks to create** an integrated ecosystem for nurturing technology-driven agricultural and spice-based enterprises

Officials said the proposed Spices Incubation Centre will focus on developing value-added spice products and promoting innovative processing technologies tailored for international markets.

ICAR-IISR's Agventure Technology Business Incubator serves as a nodal centre for scaling technology-driven ventures in agriculture and allied sectors by bridging academic research and commercial application.

The incubator supports research commercialisation, startup incubation, industry-academia collaboration and capacity building, backed by pilot plant facilities for product development and processing.

## QUICKLY.

**TN reviews progress of projects, seeks feedback**

**Chennai:** Tamil Nadu Minister for Industries and Investment Promotion S Keerthana on Friday held a series of interactions with representatives from leading companies and industry associations, including Agnikul, Shree Cements, RGE, Sify and the American Chamber of Commerce in India. The discussions focused on the progress of their ongoing projects, investment plans and opportunities to strengthen the State's industrial ecosystem, said a release. OUR BUREAU

**'Karnataka Cabinet expansion soon'**

**Bengaluru:** AICC General Secretary KC Venugopal on Friday said the expansion of Chief Minister DK Shivakumar-led cabinet in Karnataka is on the cards and it will happen any time. Shivakumar, former CM Siddaramaiah and Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president BK Hariprasad were in New Delhi on Tuesday to discuss the expansion. With the sanctioned strength of Karnataka's ministry being 34, including the Chief Minister, 20 berths are still vacant, and pressure is mounting on Shivakumar to expand the Cabinet. PTI

# No posting of proceedings on social media, says SC

**CLAMP DOWN.** Live streaming being exploited, 'justice is being trivialised', it says

**Aaratrika Bhaumik**
New Delhi

**MEDIA IS EXEMPT.** The Bench directed the Supreme Court and all High Courts to upload the order on their official websites

Observing that the misuse of video clips from live-streamed court proceedings was "trivialising" the administration of justice, the Supreme Court on Friday barred the extraction, editing, dissemination, reposting, uploading and monetisation of audio and video recordings of judicial proceedings on social media and other digital platforms without prior permission from the concerned court registrars.

A Bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, passed the interim order while issuing notice on a public interest litigation filed by journalist Harshita Grover, contending that "isolated excerpts" of judicial proceedings were being clipped, circulated and monetised in a manner that undermined the sanctity and dignity of the judicial process.

"As an interim measure, it is directed that there shall be no extraction, modification, dissemination, monetisation, posting, reposting or uploading of audio-video recordings of judicial proceedings on social media or other digital platforms without permission of the Secretary General of the Supreme Court or the Registrar General of the jurisdictional High Courts," it directed.

**'NOT A GAG ORDER'**

The Bench, however, clarified that the embargo would not extend to news reporting of court proceedings.

It also directed the Supreme Court and all High Courts to upload the order on their official websites. "This order shall have no bearing on news reporting," the Bench said.

**'COLLATERAL THREAT'**

Justice Mohana also remarked that the court was not attempting to pass a "gag order" on the press, but was merely giving effect to the Supreme Court's 2022 'Model Rules for Live Streaming and Recording of Court Proceedings', which prohibit the recording, sharing or dissemination of live-streamed court proceedings by unauthorised persons.

Agreeing that live-streaming of judicial proceedings was being exploited, Justice Bagchi observed that regulatory safeguards had become necessary.

"We should ensure limited access and therefore restrict live streaming itself. Parties must expressly make a prayer that they want to see. It can't be a 24/7 entertainment channel for courts. The access and availability of electronic records and data of court proceedings is becoming a collateral threat to the very administration of justice. This is trivialising justice," he said.

# Government introduces Vande Mataram Bill in RS

**Dalip Singh**
New Delhi

The government introduced National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026, in the Rajya Sabha on Friday, making "prevention" or "causing disturbance" in singing of national song *Vande Mataram* a criminal offence, carrying punishment of up to three year jail term or with fine, or both.

The proposed amendment to the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, places the national song on a par with the national anthem regarding offences related to preventing or disturbing their singing.

The Bill was tabled in the Rajya Sabha by Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai on behalf of his senior colleague, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, amid slogan shouting by opposition MPs over the NEET paper leak controversy.

Opposition parliamentarians, including CPI MPs P Sandosh Kumar and John Brittas, objected to the Bill being introduced in the Upper House. They called it an attempt to "manufacture patriotism" and divert attention from the controversy surrounding the NEET paper leak and student's demand seeking resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai ANI

Kumar stated that he respected the national song *Vande Mataram* but opposed the proposed legislation on the grounds that it sought to create a division between authors of the two songs: Rabindranath Tagore, who penned the National Anthem, and Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, who composed *Vande Mataram*.

**DIVERTING ATTENTION**

In the 'statement of objects and reasons' for bringing in the legislation, Union Home Minister Amit Shah wrote: "At the meeting of the Constituent Assembly held on the 24th January, 1950, its President, Dr Rajendra Prasad, stated that the song *Vande Mataram* composed by, Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, which played a historic role in the Indian freedom struggle, shall be honoured equally with *Jana Gana Mana* and shall have equal status with it."

**Amendment to the Prevention of Insults to National** Honour Act, 1971, puts national song on a par with the national anthem

The amendment has been introduced in Section 3 of the Act, which treated such obstacles only to recitation of the national anthem as an insult to national honour. Now, the national song has been added to the legislation.

"Whoever, intentionally — (a) prevents the singing of the national anthem or the national song; or (b) causes disturbance to any assembly engaged in such singing, shall be punishable with imprisonment for a term which may extend to three years, or with fine, or with both," the bill tabled in the Upper House stated. On July 9, the Ministry directed the States that all six stanzas of *Vande Mataram* must be sung ahead of the national anthem.

# Shivakumar unveils infra plans beyond Bengaluru, invites CEOs

**Press Trust of India**
Bengaluru

Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar on Friday announced that within the next 100 days, the government will introduce a policy to encourage industries to establish operations beyond Bengaluru by offering world-class office infrastructure at highly affordable costs, including office space in other cities for as little as $0.50 per square foot.

These were among the plans he announced to expand world-class infrastructure beyond Bengaluru, establish an AI University with industry participation, and launch new policies to strengthen the technology ecosystem.

He also called upon industry leaders to partner with the government in shaping the State's next phase of growth.

**TAP OPPORTUNITIES**

Addressing CEOs at a breakfast meeting, the CM said Bengaluru's greatest strength lies in its talent pool and innovation ecosystem. He also credited the city's success to the people and companies that have made it India's technology capital.

"You are the ambassadors of Bengaluru. You are the ambassadors of Karnataka," he told industry leaders, noting that while many had come to the city decades ago, they chose to stay because of the opportunities and talent the city offers.

**OFFERING SOLUTIONS**

Minister for IT/BT and Home Priyank Kharge, MLA and Karnataka State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (KEONICS) Chairman Sharath Bache Gowda, Biocon founder Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw, Infosys co-founder Kris Gopalakrishnan, and senior bureaucrats were among those present at the breakfast meeting.

Highlighting Karnataka's economic performance, Shivakumar said software exports had crossed ₹4.36 lakh crore and are expected to exceed ₹5.5 lakh crore this year. "Behind every number is a young engineer getting a first job, a developer solving problems, and a family moving closer to its dreams," he was quoted as saying in a release.

Shivakumar said companies continue to prefer Bengaluru for its talent, ecosystem, and cost advantages. "Many States are competing, but companies tell us that if it costs them $3.50 elsewhere, they can achieve the same here at nearly $1 because of Bengaluru's talent, ecosystem and human capital," he added.

Shivakumar also said that Karnataka is building an AI University in partnership with industry.

He also announced the Bengaluru Robotics and Innovation Zone and the Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026-31, aimed at creating environmentally sustainable digital infrastructure supported by land, power, water, connectivity and renewable energy.The Chief Minister urged companies to adopt one government school each under their Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) programmes to improve infrastructure, classrooms, teacher training and learning outcomes.

"We spend over ₹1 lakh per child in government education. Yet we still have teacher vacancies. Government alone cannot do everything.

"We need your partnership," he said, adding that strengthening education would be followed by a greater focus on healthcare.

## CM announces BTS 2026, unveils Innoverse Foundation for deep-tech start-ups

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Chief Minister D K Shivakumar with global CEOs, industry leaders, innovators and investors at the Annual CEO Breakfast Meet ANI

Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar on Friday announced that the 29th edition of the Bengaluru Tech Summit (BTS) 2026 will be held on November 17-19 on the theme "AI & Beyond."

A key addition this year will be the inaugural edition of embedded world India, organised in association with NuernbergMesse India, with a dedicated conference and exhibition focused on electronics and semiconductors.

The government said the initiative aims to strengthen collaboration between global technology companies and India's growing semiconductor ecosystem.

The annual technology summit is expected to bring together over 1,800 exhibitors, 25,000 delegates, 1,000 start-ups and more than 60,000 business visitors from over 75 countries and 30 States and Union Territories. The announcement was made during the State's annual CEO Breakfast Meet, attended by more than 200 technology industry leaders, entrepreneurs, investors and policymakers.

During the event, the government also released the Karnataka IT & DeepTech Landscape Progress Report 2025-26, outlining the State's achievements and the sector's roadmap. The government also launched the Innoverse Foundation, an initiative to mentor revenue-generating deep-tech start-ups and help them scale globally.

# RE corridors in Gujarat, Rajasthan to boost Adani Energy's transmission revenue

**Avinash Nair**
Ahmedabad

Transmission links connecting Gujarat's Khavda renewable energy park with South Gujarat and Rajasthan's Bhadla renewable energy zone with Uttar Pradesh — both slated for commissioning around FY29 — will account for nearly 63 per cent of the future billing potential from Adani Energy Solutions Ltd's (AESL) under-construction transmission portfolio.

AESL is executing 13 transmission projects spanning 7,926 circuit kilometres (ckm) and 73,775 MVA of transformation capacity, with a combined annual billing potential of ₹9,510 crore. Of this, two high-voltage direct current (HVDC) projects — the Bhadla-Fatehpur HVDC project and the Khavda South-Olpad HVDC project — together account for ₹5,949 crore, 63 per cent of under construction transmission portfolio.

Talking about the commissioning pipeline, Kandarp Patel, CEO of the company, told investors on Wednesday that both the HVDC projects are expected to be commissioned around FY29. The Bhadla-Fatehpur HVDC project, part of the HVDC Rajasthan Phase-II transmission system, is designed to evacuate renewable power from Rajasthan's Bhadla renewable energy zone and strengthen transmission connectivity towards the northern grid.


The project involves 2,400 ckm of transmission lines and 21,900 MVA of transformation capacity, with an annual billing potential of ₹3,557 crore.

**MAJOR FOCUS AREA**

The Khavda South-Olpad HVDC project, being developed through KPS III HVDC Transmission Ltd, involves 1,200 ckm of transmission lines, 5,400 MVA of transformation capacity and has an annual billing potential of ₹2,392 crore. Other Khavda-linked projects include Khavda Phase-III Part-A (Halvad), Khavda Phase-IV-A and Khavda Phase-IV Part-D, which together strengthen evacuation capacity from one of India's largest renewable energy hubs.

AESL is also executing transmission assets including Jamnagar Transmission, Navinal (Mundra), Mahan Transmission and South Kalamb transmission projects. The portfolio includes 18 line and substation augmentation projects under the regulated asset framework, with an annual billing potential of ₹2,751 crore.

Of the ₹3,498 crore capital expenditure incurred during the first quarter of FY27, transmission accounted for ₹2,199 crore, more than double the ₹1,025 crore spent in the April-June quarter of FY26.

"We expect that every year we will have an opportunity of about ₹1 lakh crore bidding combining various central and state projects," Patel said, adding Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh had begun stepping up transmission investments after significant expansion of the inter-State network over the past few years.

# Govt panel mulls parallel distribution licensing plan to enhance service efficiency

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**
New Delhi

The Consultative Committee of the Power Ministry on Thursday deliberated on a proposal to allow new distribution licensees to supply electricity using existing networks paying regulated wheeling charges.

The panel, chaired by Power Minister Manohar Lal, deliberated on the proposed framework for parallel distribution licensing to promote consumer choice, improve service quality and ensure efficient utilisation of the electricity distribution infrastructure.

Currently, more than one distribution licensee can operate in the same area. However, each licensee has to establish its own distribution network.

**ELECTRICITY ACT**

According to the Ministry this results in duplication of poles, lines and substations, thereby increasing capital expenditure and discouraging fresh investment, which ultimately leads to inefficient utilisation of resources. "Under the proposal, existing distribution licensees will continue to own, operate and maintain their networks. New distribution licensees will be able to use the existing network by paying regulated wheeling charges while retaining the option to develop their own network wherever permitted by the concerned State Electricity Regulatory Commission," the Ministry said.

The issue of many distribution licensees operating in a single service area is a contentious one with States, power sector employees and central trade unions strongly opposing it and several other amendments proposed by the government in the draft Electricity Act, 2025.

**MAIN GROUSE**

Their main contention is that the Bill will enable private firms to cherry-pick high-paying consumers while public discoms serve low-revenue rural and domestic consumers.

In October 2025, the Electricity Employees' Federation of India claimed that Section 43 (4) empowers regulatory commissions to allow consumers with a demand of more than 1 MW to shift to private suppliers, thereby reducing the revenue of public discoms and further narrowing the scope of cross-subsidy. At the same time, the State utilities need to maintain the contract demand of those high-end consumers as back-up, putting a further financial burden on public discoms.

The Ministry also assured that a detailed implementation framework would be developed by the State Electricity Regulatory Commissions to ensure fairness, transparency and non-discriminatory access to the network.

# Fusion CX expects to cut 90% of debt after IPO

**Vallari Sanzgiri**
Mumbai

Kolkata-based IT services company Fusion CX has submitted an addendum to its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP), stating it expects to resolve nearly 90 per cent of debt following its proposed initial public offering (IPO).

In a recent interaction with *businessline*, Fusion CX said it is confident of addressing around 90 per cent of its ₹166.8 crore debt as of FY26 after the IPO.

The firm received approval from SEBI last year for its proposed ₹1,000 crore public issue. "Our parent company was an Indian company. We saw the opportunity, the capital market is good out here. For the Indian market, our size of ₹2,000-2,500 crore is good," said Pankaj Dhanuka, Co-Founder, CEO and Managing Director of Fusion CX.

Beyond its customer experience and IT business, Fusion CX plans to double down on its recently launched AI data infrastructure business.

# CMI seeks closer industry partnerships in AI, mathematical sciences

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

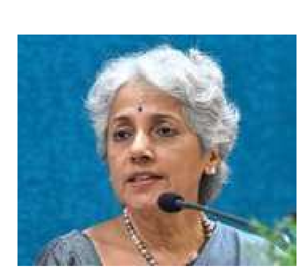
The Chennai Mathematical Institute (CMI) plans to deepen industry collaboration to add more dimensions to the student experience at the institute.

Addressing CMI's 23rd Annual Convocation here one Friday, Madhavan Mukund, Director, CMI, said that in recent years, many CMI graduates had taken up challenging industry positions across diverse domains, from investment to finance to manufacturing to technology.

"Although CMI is largely a theoretical academic institute, we have ambitions to contribute to the world around us. To this effect, we have been making active efforts to engage with industry and government," he said.

The institute will engage with the industry in areas related to the mathematical sciences, especially around AI and machine learning, he said.

"We have also been trying to work with the State government including the Tamil Nadu E-Governance Agency, which has been charged with bringing in data-related governance to the government activities," he said.



Soumya Swaminathan, Chairperson of the MS Swaminathan Research Foundation

**REAL CHALLENGES**

Soumya Swaminathan, Chairperson, MS Swaminathan Research Foundation, urged graduates to use their scientific training to address real-world challenges and ensure that the benefits of science reach those with fewer opportunities.

Scientists should inspire the next generation, particularly children from disadvantaged backgrounds, while emphasising that science is most impactful when knowledge is shared. "We cannot underestimate the importance of sharing knowledge and of inspiring the next generation," she added.

Degrees were awarded to 20 undergraduate and 61 post graduate students alongside 8 PhD scholars.

On CMI's new Dr FC Kohli Centre of Excellence located close to its main campus Siruseri, Mukund said that the campus is almost ready and should be open in the next few months.

"The centre will expand CMI's activities by specialising in research programmes on focused topics, ranging from a few days to months long. We will host visiting faculty and scientists at different levels from across the world and will have seminars, instruction schools, and workshops," he said.

Meanwhile, Mukund said that there had been alarming stories about admissions to colleges dropping to unsustainable numbers and departments having to shut down programmes in Mathematics.

# AESL wins ₹8,500 crore project in Vizag

**Our Bureau**
Ahmedabad

Adani Energy Solutions Ltd (AESL) has bagged a ₹8,500-crore interstate transmission project in Andhra Pradesh to supply power to upcoming green hydrogen and green ammonia projects in the Visakhapatnam region.

The line will support an estimated power demand of around 4,500 MW, while also strengthening the grid capacity in the Pendurthi–Visakhapatnam corridor, where largescale data centre and digital infrastructure investments are being planned, said a company press release.

BENGALURU
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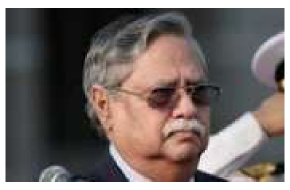
## QUICKLY.

**Bangladesh President resigns citing health**



**Dhaka:** Bangladesh President Mohammed Shahabuddin has resigned citing serious health issues, his office said on Friday. "Recent medical examinations have diagnosed me with autonomic neuropathy. Due to this condition, I occasionally experience momentary loss of consciousness," Shahabuddin said. REUTERS

**Merck licenses experimental HIV pill**

Merck said on Friday it signed seven voluntary licensing agreements with generic drug manufacturers to make and sell lower-cost versions of its experimental once-monthly oral HIV pill in 129 low- and lower-middle-income countries. The drug, alimatravir, is currently in late-stage development. Merck said it is investing early in its product manufacturing capacity as trials continue. REUTERS

# Delhi High Court dismisses ANI's copyright case against OpenAI

**DOUBLE TROUBLE.** Interim injunction would cause irreparable harm to both OpenAI and the public, says court

**S Ronendra Singh**
New Delhi

In a major development, the Delhi High Court has denied interim injunction to news agency *ANI*'s claim of copyright infringement by artificial intelligence (AI) firm OpenAI.

Justice Amit Bansal, while pronouncing the judgment, observed, "OpenAI's act of storing *ANI*'s works does not amount to copyright infringement... since outputs were not similar to *ANI*'s outputs."

The HC observed that *ANI* had also failed to make out a *prima facie* case for the grant of interim injunction.

It said that outputs generated by ChatGPT using retrieval-augmented generation technique does not amount to copyright infringement since the answers generated by the AI-tool were not substantially similar to the original content published by *ANI*.

"Any injunction granted will have cascading effects for several LLM (large language model) platforms as it would curtail access to information for LLM developers and the public. It would also require an LLM to take multiple licences with each news agency, individual newspaper, magazine, etc. Hence, when *ANI* has chosen not to engage paywalls or crawler blockers, no injunction can be granted to access information that is freely available on the web," the court observed.

**JUDICIAL CONCERN**

- ChatGPT outputs not substantially similar to ANI
- No prima facie case made out by ANI
- ANI activities differ from AI tool functions
- Training deemed fair for research purposes


### FACT GATHERING

Further, it said that *ANI* is a news agency, which is mainly focused on creating, verifying and distributing news which involved a process of fact gathering, investigative journalism and contextualisation of stories.

On the other hand, LLMs serve as tools such as content creation, researching, brainstorming and idea generation, language translation, learning and education, creative writing, summarising or paraphrasing.

"Therefore, the activities of Open AI cannot substitute the activities carried out by *ANI*. No evidence has been provided by *ANI* that OpenAI's use of AI generative use had led to a decrease in their market share," it said.

### COMPUTATIONAL TOOL

In the 135-page order, the court explained that training LLMs underlying ChatGPT advanced scientific knowledge, developed innovative computational tools, disseminated information, promoted education, etc, and while the rights of copyright owners were important, the societal benefits arising from such scientific and technological research was a relevant factor.

### TRAINING LLMS

"Therefore, on a *prima facie* view, from the above analysis, this court is of the view that the process of training LLMs underlying ChatGPT undertaken by OpenAI using stored literary work of *ANI* falls under 'private or personal use, including research' as provided in Section 52(1)(a) of the Copyright Act and fulfils the 'purpose' test," it stated.

In a rare case, ANI Media Pvt Ltd in November 2024 moved the Delhi HC against OpenAI Inc and Open AI OpCo, raising issues of infringement of its copyrighted material for LLM training by OpenAI.

### OBJECTIONS RAISED

Later, some other organisations, including media and publishing houses, and associations such as the Federation of Indian Publishers, the Digital News Publishers Association and the Indian Music Industry, who had raised similar objections to OpenAI's training model, also were made parties in the suit.

Justice Amit Bansal of the High Court appointed advocate Adarsh Ramanujan and Arul George Scaria, professor of Law at the National Law School of India University, to assist the court in the adjudication of the suit.

# Gameskraft assets worth ₹1,906 crore seized by ED over betting charges

**Dalip Singh**
New Delhi

Online gaming company Gameskraft's assets worth ₹1,906 crore have been provisionally attached by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) as the agency said on Friday that the platform created an "addictive" gaming environment, encouraging "repeated wagering" so that the players continually bet, stake or place money on games multiple times.

With the latest punitive action, the total attachment of assets of Gameskraft stood at ₹2,401 crore. Online money gaming was banned by the Union government in August 2025.

The attached assets include bank and fixed deposits, mutual funds, convertible notes, equity shares, a farmhouse and multiple residential and commercial immovable properties held in the names of the shareholders of Gameskraft's Technologies Pvt Ltd, their family members, private family trusts and associated entities, the ED said.

**These companies earned by charging 10-15% platform commission on the staking/wagering amounts deposited by the users**

### PMLA INVOKED

The agency made these attachments under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) on July 22 in a case related to the RummyCulture, RummyPrime, Playship and RummyTime apps, ED stated.

The ED said Gameskraft and RummyTime Technologies were engaged in operating online real money games (RMGs) through these apps and they had a user base of around three crore players primarily in the states of Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

According to the ED, these companies earned by charging a platform commission ranging from 10-15 per cent on the staking/wagering amounts deposited by the users. The agency added that the firms deployed BOTs (automated programmers and algorithms) which played against the players who were unaware of the hidden manipulations.

The users were "lured" through bonuses, referral incentives, free tournament entries and promotional rewards to encourage continuous gameplay and increased deposits.

"These unscrupulous practices of the companies have created an addictive gaming environment that encouraged repeated wagering, thereby enabling the companies to generate huge proceeds of crime in the form of platform commission," the ED claimed.

The proceeds of crime generated through these activities were subsequently layered and integrated through the payment of dividends and buy-back of shares to shareholders, according to the agency.

# Viasat calls for PPP to drive India's satcom future

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

Viasat, one of the leading global satellite communications (satcom) firms, has called for public-private collaboration to drive India's satcom future, saying that with the right regulation, the right guidelines and the right guardrails from governments, companies can address all challenges.

The company on Friday said it had convened a meeting with senior policymakers, regulators and industry leaders for a high-level discussion on "Satcom: Opportunities and Challenges in India", highlighting the importance of continued public-private collaboration in unlocking the full potential of India's satcom ecosystem.

### NEW TECHNOLOGY

"The trade-off between risk and opportunity is one that every regulator faces, and the best outcomes come when governments and industry work together. Regulatory sandbox approaches, where innovation can be tested in a time-bound and risk-managed environment under close regulatory oversight, offer one way to explore new technologies while protecting consumers, national security and the wider economy," Michael Howells, Global Head of Strategic Relationships and Market Development, Viasat, said.

The discussion focused on India's evolving policy and regulatory landscape for satellite communications, emerging opportunities, as well as the need to address challenges relating to spectrum management, infrastructure, affordability, investment and market adoption, the company said.

"You've got really high demand for skills because the sector is doing so well and growing so well... I'm sure the education system and the private sector will solve it. Smart people will want to work in this sector, and people from around the world will want to come and work here," Howells noted.

He said India is leveraging with its tremendous human capital strengths and that has been the result of strong public-private partnership, a supportive regulatory environment and sustained investment into the sector by ISRO and others.

"You can see not just our company, but many companies like ours wanting to come here because we see the opportunity to partner and grow together. I have a great sense of optimism and excitement about what we can achieve together. It is a golden age for the sector, and we should seize this opportunity," Howells said.

The roundtable was attended by Prabhat Dikshit, Deputy Director General (Satellite), Department of Telecommunications, Vinod Kumar, Director, Directorate of Promotion, IN-SPACe, AK Bhatt, Director General, Indian Space Association, and Anil Prakash, Director General, SIA-India.

# Air India Express cancels Bahrain, Kuwait flights, IndiGo assessing W. Asia situation

**Aneesh Phadnis**
Mumbai

IndiGo is assessing the situation in West Asia even as Air India Express cancelled its flights to Bahrain and Kuwait till July-end amid a flare-up of tensions in the region.

IndiGo operated around 160 flights daily to West Asia prior to March, and that dropped to 20-30 flights a day during the peak of the crisis.

Since then, IndiGo has restored around 90 per cent of its capacity to the region by the end of June.

Air India Express, too, restored its entire network in the region with flights to Salalah (Oman) and Kuwait resuming earlier in the month. But the restart of hostilities has led the airlines to review their operations.

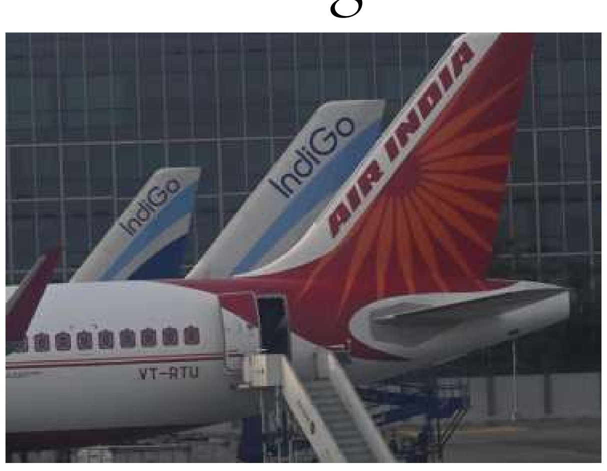
"We are assessing the situation because the crisis has flared up again. Our intention is to continue operations to West Asia till the point it is safe for us to operate," IndiGo's Chief Financial Officer Gaurav Negi told analysts in a post results conference call on Thursday.

IndiGo, however, did not respond to a query.

An Air India Express executive said the airline is closely monitoring the situation in the region. Affected passengers were being offered refunds or rebooking options.

Overall, 600 flights were scheduled between India and West Asia in July, and this is 7.2 per cent lower compared to last year, data from aviation analytics firm Cirium showed.

The caution on the part of some airlines comes following rising tensions between Iran and the US.




**WAR IMPACT.** The restart of hostilities has led airlines to review their operations

### CANCELLED FLIGHTS

Among international airlines while Sri Lankan airlines has cancelled flights to Kuwait, Qatar Airways has temporarily suspended flights to Bahrain, Kuwait and Erbil (Iraq).

The US, the UK, Canada and Australia have renewed their travel advisories for the region.

On Thursday, the US State Department issued a worldwide caution asking its citizens in West Asia to remain vigilant and be prepared for flight cancellations, periodic airspace closures and potential travel disruptions.

# There's no proposal to make insurers follow treating doctors' opinion on claims: Centre

**Ankita Upadhyay**
New Delhi

The Centre has said there is no proposal under consideration to require health insurers to give overriding precedence to the clinical opinion of the treating doctor while deciding health insurance claims.

Responding to a question in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare Prataprao Jadhav on Friday said the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) had informed the government that insurers assess claims based on the terms and conditions of the policy and the merits of each individual case.

According to the reply, insurers consider clinical records, the assessment of the treating medical practitioner, applicable medical standards, standard treatment protocols, wherever available, and the policy conditions while determining their contractual liability under a health insurance policy.

**MERIT-BASED.** Insurers assess claims based on the terms and conditions of the policy and the merits of each individual case

### CLAIMS REJECTED

The response came after the government was asked whether it was aware of instances where private health insurance companies had rejected claims for hospital admissions recommended by specialist doctors on grounds such as "non-medical necessity" or "exclusion", allegedly affecting patients' treatment.

The government said that while the treating doctor's assessment is one of the factors considered during claim evaluation, there is no proposal before the IRDAI to give the doctor's clinical opinion overriding authority in deciding insurance claim liability.

The questions were posed by Lok Sabha MP from Samajwadi Party Devesh Shakya, who also asked whether the government planned to introduce national standard guidelines or a medical audit mechanism to prevent insurers from interfering with doctors' clinical discretion.

However, there was no response to the question. Instead, the government reiterated that insurers follow existing policy conditions, medical records, treatment protocols and clinical assessments while processing claims. The government also said the IRDAI collects data only on the overall repudiation of health insurance claims by insurers. It does not maintain claim rejection data classified under specific reasons such as "non-medical necessity" or "exclusion". As a result, insurance-wise data on claims rejected on these grounds during the last three years is not available, the government said.

# US hits Iran targets after Trump threats over Red Sea shipping

**Reuters**
Dubai

US President Donald Trump REUTERS

US missiles struck targets across Iran, reaching as far as its Caspian coast, on Friday after President Donald Trump vowed "major military punishment" for Tehran and its Houthi allies in Yemen for extending the West Asia war to a second major shipping choke-point, the mouth of the Red Sea.

Two weeks after the collapse of an interim truce meant to end the war, the Iranian armed forces responded by firing at US bases in neighbouring Arab countries and warning people there that they may strike non-military buildings used by US personnel. The Iranian army said Trump's threats only strengthened its resolve.

The Houthis, who control northern and western Yemen, said this week they were imposing a naval blockade on Saudi Arabia, which has diverted millions of barrels of oil each day by pipeline to the Red Sea to skirt Iran's near-total blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

The strait is the focus of a war that has killed thousands in almost five months, stoked global inflation and fanned fears of an economic downturn.

# Weight-loss drug market gains muscle, touches ₹2,000 crore in 1 year

**Ankita Upadhyay**
New Delhi

The weight-loss drug market in India has grown into a ₹2,000-crore business within a year, powered by the launch of affordable generic versions of blockbuster medicines and rising acceptance of obesity treatment, according to a series of monthly industry reports by market research firm Pharmarack.

The reports suggested that India's weight-loss drug market is moving beyond the initial excitement surrounding new launches.

While growth has begun to moderate, the combination of rising awareness, wider availability of affordable generics and a growing burden of obesity and related diseases has established GLP-1 medicines as one of the fastest-growing segments of the country's pharmaceutical industry.

Experts said the market's long-term success will depend not only on affordability and access but also on ensuring that these medicines are prescribed appropriately and used under medical supervision.

According to the report, the GLP-1 market, the class of medicines that includes semaglutide and tirzepatide, expanded from ₹565 crore in May 2025 to ₹1,906 crore by May 2026, before crossing ₹2,000 crore in June 2026.

The market recorded a year-on-year growth of 237 per cent and a five-year compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 97 per cent.

### NEWER THERAPIES

Satish Chander Wasoori, Senior Consultant, Paras Hospital, Gurugram, said India had a growing need for effective obesity management, and newer therapies are expanding the options available to both patients and healthcare professionals.


**BOOM YEAR.** The market recorded a year-on-year growth of 237 per cent

"We are likely to see continued innovation with newer therapies, more personalised treatment strategies, and stronger integration of obesity management into routine healthcare. Ultimately, the goal is to improve overall metabolic health and quality of life, not just achieve weight loss," he said.

While the launch of tirzepatide and semaglutide injections sparked the initial surge, Pharmarack said the turning point came with the entry of semaglutide generics in early 2026. "The GLP-1 agonist market has more than tripled in turnover in the last year," said the April 2026 report.

It added that generic medicines expanded the market by making treatment more affordable.

Besides lower prices, the report attributes the growth to increasing awareness about obesity, wider acceptance of injectable medicines, partnerships by innovator companies to improve market reach and multiple generic launches at economical price points.

### INNOVATOR PRESENCE

The reports suggested that generics did not merely take market share away from innovator brands but brought in new patients. By April 2026, the injectable GLP-1 market had become 10 times larger than it was a year ago. Innovator brands continued to retain a significant presence despite competition from lower-priced products.

The rapid expansion of the market also underscores the need for appropriate use, according to endocrinologists.

"These medicines are not a quick solution. While they have been available for a few years and their commonly recognised side effects are known, more long-term data and clinical experience will help build a better understanding of their long-term safety and use," said SK Wangnoo, Senior Consultant, Endocrinology, Apollo Indraprastha Hospital.

He added that the medicines should be prescribed only to patients who meet appropriate medical criteria and used as part of a comprehensive, medically supervised approach to obesity management rather than for short-term cosmetic weight loss.

Pharmarack's February 2026 report found that chronic and sub-chronic therapies now account for 56 per cent of the Indian pharmaceutical market, reflecting the growing burden of obesity, diabetes and cardiovascular disorders.

The report projects these diseases to account for nearly 70 per cent of India's disease burden, indicating sustained demand for long-term therapies.

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ATUL. | 6130.00 | 6407.50 | 6136.00 | 6524.50 | 6077.00 | 403.65 | 7198.20 | 5563.00 | 32 | 6394.95 |
| AU SFB | 978.70 | 1004.00 | 969.00 | 1015.90 | 967.40 | 1826.52 | 1090.40 | 682.50 | 28 | 1002.25 |
| Aurionpro So | 808.45 | 825.45 | 803.05 | 829.00 | 800.00 | 86.00 | 1505.00 | 720.10 | 41 | 825.45 |
| Aurob Pha [1] | 1523.40 | 1532.00 | 1512.00 | 1541.00 | 1512.00 | 446.83 | 1636.00 | 1017.00 | 37 | 1531.50 |
| Aurum Prop | 226.19 | 221.25 | 225.01 | 227.00 | 220.00 | 114.51 | 264.64 | 151.90 | - | - |
| Authum Inv | 540.65 | 531.10 | 539.90 | 540.35 | 525.00 | 164.86 | 3318.70 | 400.00 | - | - |
| AUTOMOTIVE S | 546.55 | 508.75 | 546.65 | 555.00 | 494.85 | 139.56 | 656.50 | 377.10 | 28 | 509.00 |
| Avalon Tech | 1740.80 | 1741.50 | 1735.00 | 1765.00 | 1717.80 | 173.06 | 1853.00 | 777.30 | - | - |
| Avantel | 164.47 | 163.49 | 163.87 | 164.39 | 160.40 | 1029.36 | 215.00 | 117.05 | - | - |
| Avanti Feeds [1] | 959.20 | 977.05 | 958.90 | 984.40 | 952.00 | 261.70 | 1592.30 | 614.05 | 24 | 978.15 |
| AvenueSai | 16.15 | 16.34 | 16.17 | 16.57 | 15.85 | 10658.54 | 20.50 | 12.92 | - | - |
| Awfis Space | 278.30 | 271.85 | 273.30 | 276.95 | 270.05 | 245.30 | 656.00 | 229.05 | - | - |
| Axis Bank [2] | 1223.00 | 1227.30 | 1216.80 | 1233.90 | 1210.60 | 8088.83 | 1418.30 | 1041.30 | 15 | 1228.10 |
| AXISCADES [5] | 1562.40 | 1608.00 | 1546.00 | 1618.60 | 1535.10 | 149.24 | 2210.00 | 1061.00 | 473 | 1608.50 |
| Aye Finance [2] | 170.78 | 172.03 | 169.00 | 175.44 | 164.71 | 1074.08 | 197.95 | 164.95 | 22 | 171.90 |
| AYM Syntex | 236.98 | 234.49 | 234.01 | 239.00 | 226.65 | 49.27 | 280.00 | 144.35 | 209 | 234.00 |
| Azad Engg | 2347.80 | 2439.00 | 2349.00 | 2444.00 | 2333.00 | 688.10 | 2530.00 | 1360.00 | - | - |
| **B** | | | | | | | | | | |
| BAJAJ AUTO | 11283.50 | 11130.00 | 11229.00 | 11320.00 | 11100.00 | 442.44 | 11333.00 | 7879.45 | 28 | 11128.05 |
| Bajaj Cons [1] | 555.90 | 549.80 | 550.00 | 559.20 | 540.25 | 446.29 | 691.15 | 220.05 | 32 | 551.10 |
| Bajaj Elect [2] | 326.20 | 328.90 | 322.75 | 331.90 | 321.10 | 55.40 | 667.00 | 300.70 | - | 328.75 |
| Bajaj Fin [1] | 1039.80 | 1012.80 | 1027.30 | 1030.20 | 1001.30 | 18416.96 | 1102.45 | 788.40 | 39 | 1012.65 |
| Bajaj Finser [1] | 1889.40 | 1876.70 | 1878.90 | 1892.90 | 1866.50 | 1412.44 | 2194.65 | 1598.15 | 210 | 1876.95 |
| Bajaj HCare | 317.70 | 323.35 | 316.00 | 326.00 | 313.35 | 301.70 | 537.95 | 272.35 | - | - |
| Bajaj Hindus [1] | 16.82 | 17.29 | 16.73 | 17.40 | 16.58 | 5751.69 | 26.33 | 14.89 | - | 17.26 |
| Bajaj Holdng | 10636.00 | 10679.00 | 10625.00 | 10750.00 | 10555.00 | 73.47 | 14753.50 | 8597.50 | 46 | 10677.30 |
| Bajaj HsgFin | 84.81 | 84.19 | 84.00 | 84.52 | 83.55 | 3387.12 | 123.12 | 72.65 | - | - |
| Bajaj Steel | 388.20 | 395.70 | 388.00 | 410.50 | 375.70 | 42.51 | 507.80 | 350.05 | - | - |
| Bajel Proj. | 179.18 | 178.90 | 180.75 | 180.75 | 175.95 | 89.47 | 261.50 | 135.10 | - | - |
| Balaji Amine [2] | 2349.20 | 2174.50 | 2314.20 | 2332.70 | 2123.50 | 290.91 | 2443.15 | 905.15 | 43 | 2181.10 |
| Balkrish Ind [2] | 2011.40 | 2013.50 | 2002.00 | 2030.00 | 1982.10 | 64.24 | 2775.00 | 1971.50 | 39 | 2014.00 |
| BalmerLawrie | 175.74 | 174.60 | 173.70 | 175.68 | 173.70 | 66.41 | 238.00 | 148.35 | 12 | 174.45 |
| BalramChini [1] | 612.80 | 610.15 | 612.00 | 620.50 | 607.25 | 237.04 | 642.00 | 393.40 | 37 | 610.15 |
| Balu Forge | 431.80 | 433.60 | 431.80 | 435.00 | 425.00 | 237.56 | 697.00 | 341.05 | - | - |
| Banco Prod [2] | 608.05 | 608.45 | 600.00 | 615.50 | 588.00 | 241.40 | 879.60 | 503.00 | 21 | 608.25 |
| Bandhan Bk | 165.84 | 165.93 | 165.50 | 167.71 | 161.95 | 29585.43 | 220.70 | 134.30 | 20 | 166.00 |
| Bank of Maha | 78.48 | 81.03 | 78.10 | 81.49 | 78.02 | 18251.46 | 94.50 | 51.71 | 8 | 81.14 |
| Bansal Wire | 307.25 | 324.00 | 308.00 | 325.00 | 307.20 | 264.85 | 434.30 | 222.50 | - | - |
| BASF India | 3698.00 | 3670.20 | 3690.00 | 3698.00 | 3626.00 | 11.45 | 5200.00 | 2906.90 | 39 | 3670.35 |
| Bata India [5] | 676.25 | 689.95 | 676.00 | 694.45 | 667.00 | 170.17 | 1281.60 | 605.55 | 53 | 688.85 |
| Bayer Crop | 4275.60 | 4217.50 | 4251.00 | 4272.00 | 4210.00 | 20.52 | 6539.95 | 4030.00 | 28 | 4218.45 |
| BCL Ind. | 34.97 | 35.74 | 34.90 | 35.95 | 34.45 | 595.94 | 49.30 | 25.53 | - | - |
| BDL [5] | 1239.80 | 1243.00 | 1230.00 | 1251.20 | 1221.00 | 550.24 | 1719.00 | 1090.00 | 108 | 1242.40 |
| BellaCasaFa | 244.75 | 239.50 | 240.00 | 253.40 | 236.60 | 77.59 | 497.35 | 220.25 | - | - |
| Belrise Inds | 229.31 | 228.26 | 227.00 | 230.32 | 224.00 | 2981.14 | 252.00 | 122.92 | - | - |
| BEML [5] | 1730.70 | 1713.20 | 1716.00 | 1730.00 | 1697.00 | 106.03 | 2276.75 | 1361.10 | 97 | 1713.10 |
| BergerPaints [1] | 493.60 | 497.95 | 489.70 | 499.90 | 488.90 | 99.05 | 594.20 | 391.50 | 53 | 497.90 |
| Beta Drugs | 2277.20 | 2315.60 | 2258.00 | 2340.00 | 2242.20 | 19.16 | 2674.00 | 990.10 | - | - |
| BF INVEST [5] | 451.10 | 460.05 | 450.00 | 464.40 | 438.50 | 101.14 | 586.95 | 316.00 | 12 | 458.45 |
| BF UTILI [5] | 580.50 | 580.40 | 577.25 | 582.60 | 564.30 | 44.87 | 899.00 | 369.00 | - | 580.70 |
| BFLYGANDHI | 756.70 | 761.90 | 750.00 | 763.40 | 731.70 | 17.40 | 844.00 | 566.95 | 33 | 760.60 |
| Bhagira.Chm | 258.85 | 263.45 | 258.85 | 266.95 | 255.10 | 44.51 | 325.00 | 170.60 | - | - |
| BHANSALI E [1] | 117.23 | 121.81 | 116.70 | 122.84 | 116.25 | 8891.16 | 138.50 | 75.52 | 15 | 121.83 |
| BHARAT BI [5] | 2509.00 | 2519.40 | 2510.80 | 2546.60 | 2449.00 | 26.88 | 3403.40 | 2009.45 | 24 | 2514.35 |
| Bharat Elect [1] | 405.35 | 405.00 | 404.20 | 406.10 | 401.00 | 6176.66 | 473.25 | 361.05 | 49 | 405.05 |
| Bharat Forge [2] | 2175.30 | 2151.60 | 2162.00 | 2169.00 | 2128.10 | 634.48 | 2236.95 | 1100.50 | 92 | 2151.85 |
| Bharat Ra [5] | 1266.60 | 1261.10 | 1260.00 | 1272.70 | 1250.00 | 10.33 | 3030.25 | 1202.05 | 13 | 1262.00 |
| Bharat Wire | 194.27 | 193.31 | 193.95 | 194.86 | 188.86 | 141.72 | 262.20 | 149.15 | 18 | 193.65 |
| BharatCoking | 34.84 | 34.99 | 34.47 | 35.29 | 34.04 | 8061.22 | 45.09 | 29.74 | - | - |
| BharatSeats | 215.44 | 218.14 | 211.26 | 220.95 | 208.44 | 232.00 | 263.18 | 103.17 | - | - |
| Bharti Airte [5] | 1931.00 | 1898.20 | 1900.20 | 1905.00 | 1878.00 | 4483.60 | 2174.70 | 1745.00 | 74 | 1899.10 |
| Bharti Hexa | 1608.00 | 1607.60 | 1598.00 | 1612.50 | 1571.20 | 61.95 | 1955.60 | 1430.00 | - | - |
| BHEL [2] | 409.60 | 417.30 | 405.00 | 418.00 | 402.15 | 8874.81 | 446.75 | 205.20 | 60 | 417.20 |
| Bikaji Fds | 630.80 | 630.70 | 628.00 | 639.65 | 624.55 | 54.52 | 818.70 | 592.55 | - | - |
| Billionbrain | 202.50 | 202.15 | 202.50 | 204.98 | 200.25 | 17472.64 | 227.20 | 112.00 | - | - |
| Biocon [5] | 435.20 | 433.65 | 431.20 | 435.00 | 426.70 | 2748.08 | 447.00 | 331.00 | 402 | 433.70 |
| BIRLA CORPN. | 974.05 | 956.60 | 966.00 | 979.00 | 939.00 | 199.14 | 1537.15 | 773.90 | 25 | 956.10 |
| Birlasoft | 278.95 | 282.40 | 277.45 | 286.00 | 277.25 | 1171.84 | 474.00 | 270.20 | - | - |
| Bk of baroda [2] | 243.15 | 246.45 | 242.00 | 247.10 | 239.25 | 8475.75 | 325.55 | 231.00 | 6 | 246.60 |
| Bk of India | 142.20 | 142.62 | 142.00 | 143.20 | 139.82 | 7635.25 | 178.45 | 109.00 | 6 | 142.65 |
| BL kashyap [1] | 54.83 | 54.56 | 54.10 | 55.34 | 53.65 | 310.89 | 80.07 | 40.79 | 27 | 54.56 |
| Black Box | 786.60 | 778.45 | 778.70 | 786.85 | 769.35 | 213.91 | 1103.00 | 435.05 | - | - |
| BLS [1] | 230.30 | 233.60 | 227.60 | 234.95 | 226.55 | 814.65 | 415.00 | 218.45 | 94 | 233.65 |
| BLS e-Svc | 263.47 | 282.32 | 263.00 | 287.70 | 260.01 | 4956.43 | 287.70 | 124.30 | - | - |
| Blue Jet Hlt | 576.50 | 566.90 | 573.20 | 595.75 | 563.70 | 1101.31 | 1027.80 | 325.00 | - | - |
| Blue Star [2] | 1633.90 | 1637.20 | 1630.00 | 1654.40 | 1601.30 | 253.19 | 2049.95 | 1450.00 | 81 | 1637.00 |
| BlueDart Exp | 4765.40 | 4911.50 | 4756.00 | 4975.00 | 4716.10 | 35.69 | 7030.15 | 4630.50 | 43 | 4896.75 |
| BluestoneJew | 747.00 | 772.40 | 760.30 | 792.30 | 712.00 | 26038.84 | 869.50 | 399.80 | - | - |
| BluspringEnt | 104.31 | 108.42 | 104.00 | 109.00 | 100.90 | 319.35 | 131.82 | 43.98 | - | - |
| BODHI TREE M | 6.08 | 6.96 | 6.08 | 7.29 | 5.25 | 3313.63 | 10.50 | 5.06 | - | - |
| Bom Dyeing [2] | 120.40 | 121.71 | 119.10 | 121.90 | 117.90 | 339.89 | 196.50 | 92.10 | - | 121.70 |
| BombayBu [2] | 1469.50 | 1458.20 | 1465.00 | 1469.00 | 1434.40 | 21.33 | 2135.00 | 1301.00 | 140 | 1458.25 |
| Borosil | 233.45 | 232.34 | 231.45 | 237.49 | 226.37 | 72.31 | 397.95 | 213.73 | - | - |
| Borosil.Ren. | 577.90 | 580.65 | 575.00 | 582.40 | 570.45 | 367.65 | 721.00 | 374.40 | - | - |
| BOSCH | 42240.00 | 41755.00 | 42200.00 | 42200.00 | 41500.00 | 20.54 | 42950.00 | 28650.05 | 59 | 41766.35 |
| BPCL | 309.85 | 310.15 | 306.90 | 311.80 | 305.50 | 5796.31 | 391.85 | 266.55 | 9 | 310.20 |
| BrainbeesSol | 209.34 | 208.30 | 209.00 | 209.49 | 205.02 | 348.14 | 438.70 | 202.56 | - | - |
| Brigade | 526.80 | 525.45 | 521.00 | 528.55 | 515.60 | 221.97 | 802.05 | 461.25 | 61 | 525.40 |
| BrigadeHotel | 61.41 | 60.16 | 60.30 | 61.72 | 59.98 | 109.43 | 91.77 | 54.36 | - | - |
| BrightcomGr [2] | 9.36 | 9.40 | 9.35 | 9.49 | 9.22 | 2252.87 | 17.70 | 7.71 | - | 9.41 |
| Britannia [1] | 5388.00 | 5379.50 | 5383.00 | 5450.00 | 5316.50 | 208.05 | 6336.95 | 5038.00 | 51 | 5383.75 |
| BSE Ltd | 3579.00 | 3549.70 | 3563.00 | 3571.60 | 3526.00 | 1386.68 | 4446.80 | 2021.50 | - | - |
| **C** | | | | | | | | | | |
| CALIBER MINING | 424.00 | 528.20 | 500.25 | 538.75 | 463.35 | 23156.17 | 538.75 | 463.35 | - | - |
| Camlin Fine [1] | 120.61 | 124.47 | 119.70 | 125.00 | 118.75 | 470.52 | 292.80 | 96.30 | - | 124.70 |
| Campus Act. | 219.16 | 216.55 | 218.70 | 220.48 | 215.55 | 647.46 | 303.70 | 215.20 | - | - |
| CAMS | 758.15 | 761.45 | 760.00 | 766.75 | 747.35 | 966.90 | 4263.90 | 611.40 | - | - |
| Canara Bank [2] | 125.22 | 125.65 | 124.22 | 126.83 | 123.00 | 36714.62 | 162.90 | 103.50 | 6 | 125.70 |
| Canara HSBCL | 152.91 | 147.31 | 150.49 | 151.70 | 147.00 | 551.46 | 166.69 | 106.00 | - | - |
| Canara RobAM | 266.02 | 259.95 | 264.89 | 264.89 | 256.55 | 963.00 | 353.40 | 214.20 | - | - |
| Canfin Hom [2] | 818.55 | 813.90 | 819.00 | 819.50 | 799.00 | 317.70 | 970.00 | 709.05 | 10 | 814.20 |
| Cantabil [2] | 241.15 | 239.83 | 237.30 | 244.80 | 233.28 | 138.86 | 321.50 | 208.05 | 21 | 240.25 |
| CAPACITE | 214.35 | 212.75 | 214.00 | 214.45 | 211.00 | 297.75 | 333.95 | 178.90 | 10 | 212.75 |
| Capital SFB | 299.55 | 292.00 | 298.15 | 298.15 | 287.00 | 92.25 | 330.65 | 206.55 | - | - |
| CAPLIN PO [2] | 2486.60 | 2467.10 | 2470.30 | 2515.10 | 2451.40 | 70.84 | 2700.00 | 1502.45 | 47 | 2464.65 |
| Carborun [1] | 1056.10 | 1064.30 | 1050.00 | 1072.00 | 1035.50 | 110.30 | 1306.40 | 734.65 | 49 | 1064.15 |
| Care Rating | 1729.20 | 1680.00 | 1737.30 | 1749.90 | 1651.00 | 44.29 | 1836.00 | 1393.95 | 29 | 1680.10 |
| Carraro Ind | 537.05 | 534.00 | 535.10 | 541.80 | 526.00 | 93.65 | 667.55 | 405.00 | - | - |
| Cartrade Tch | 2692.20 | 2656.40 | 2689.80 | 2741.60 | 2635.60 | 376.78 | 3290.50 | 1600.00 | - | - |
| Carysil | 1116.50 | 1125.70 | 1111.00 | 1144.70 | 1094.20 | 99.64 | 1280.90 | 732.10 | - | - |
| CASTROL [5] | 185.29 | 184.79 | 186.00 | 186.35 | 184.00 | 1334.97 | 231.00 | 170.20 | 19 | 184.85 |
| CCL PRODU [2] | 1185.30 | 1183.60 | 1180.00 | 1199.50 | 1165.50 | 55.39 | 1241.85 | 809.35 | 55 | 1182.55 |
| CDSL | 1323.40 | 1333.10 | 1310.00 | 1340.00 | 1305.00 | 969.22 | 1753.90 | 1116.30 | - | - |
| CE Info Sys | 1081.85 | 1117.10 | 1078.00 | 1135.00 | 1073.00 | 399.16 | 1998.00 | 795.00 | - | - |
| CEAT | 3344.50 | 3328.60 | 3321.00 | 3357.00 | 3310.30 | 116.67 | 4431.60 | 3006.50 | 16 | 3325.45 |
| Ceigall Ind. | 336.05 | 337.10 | 332.00 | 338.65 | 329.10 | 263.19 | 405.70 | 222.61 | - | - |
| Ceinsys Tech | 870.35 | 870.05 | 875.00 | 885.00 | 855.10 | 28.69 | 1249.90 | 855.00 | - | - |
| Cello World | 340.25 | 344.30 | 340.30 | 346.00 | 336.60 | 160.53 | 673.80 | 336.60 | - | - |
| CemIndia Pro | 1516.80 | 1441.00 | 1441.00 | 1467.60 | 1441.00 | 222.38 | 1649.20 | 503.30 | - | - |
| Central Bank | 30.95 | 31.03 | 30.72 | 31.17 | 30.52 | 7107.74 | 40.91 | 29.35 | 6 | 31.03 |
| Central Mine | 253.57 | 248.43 | 251.50 | 254.90 | 245.80 | 2726.23 | 283.69 | 150.16 | - | - |
| Century Enka | 565.25 | 574.20 | 555.35 | 583.50 | 555.35 | 61.70 | 622.00 | 371.30 | 12 | 573.30 |
| Centuryply [1] | 773.65 | 792.20 | 777.45 | 800.00 | 761.95 | 33.97 | 856.65 | 618.65 | 62 | 792.75 |
| CERA SANIT [5] | 6021.00 | 6017.00 | 6021.00 | 6065.00 | 5952.00 | 3.27 | 6793.80 | 4463.00 | 37 | 6017.95 |
| CESE [1] | 162.68 | 163.18 | 161.88 | 163.69 | 161.52 | 551.92 | 204.40 | 138.05 | 25 | 163.10 |
| CG Power& [2] | 883.80 | 867.70 | 860.00 | 894.00 | 838.80 | 9684.76 | 981.15 | 525.50 | 103 | 866.35 |
| CGCL [1] | 243.71 | 238.23 | 240.99 | 241.61 | 237.01 | 1109.60 | 264.60 | 151.15 | 28 | 238.15 |
| CHALET | 819.95 | 814.40 | 817.30 | 824.30 | 808.35 | 36.01 | 1080.00 | 690.00 | 27 | 815.05 |
| Chambal Fert | 431.85 | 431.00 | 431.00 | 434.00 | 425.10 | 431.60 | 580.55 | 400.00 | 9 | 431.50 |
| Chempl.San | 209.90 | 202.29 | 206.00 | 207.79 | 198.61 | 400.59 | 477.75 | 193.11 | - | - |
| Choice Intl | 805.25 | 797.15 | 802.00 | 805.00 | 788.40 | 471.32 | 860.50 | 568.70 | - | - |
| CholaFinH [1] | 1516.00 | 1516.70 | 1503.30 | 1528.80 | 1491.20 | 68.57 | 2089.00 | 1305.00 | 404 | 1518.20 |
| CholaIn&Fin [2] | 1717.30 | 1724.40 | 1702.00 | 1741.30 | 1660.40 | 1912.11 | 1874.65 | 1299.80 | 28 | 1725.70 |
| CIE Auto.Ind | 419.00 | 413.75 | 412.00 | 416.80 | 401.90 | 1114.77 | 526.00 | 381.10 | - | - |
| CINELINE [5] | 80.32 | 86.71 | 80.32 | 87.50 | 78.02 | 93.60 | 104.00 | 73.00 | 25 | 87.10 |
| Cipla [2] | 1393.00 | 1410.60 | 1390.10 | 1444.80 | 1390.10 | 2917.79 | 1672.20 | 1165.55 | 35 | 1410.90 |
| CityUnion [1] | 219.89 | 219.75 | 219.40 | 220.99 | 217.01 | 1635.18 | 239.96 | 144.75 | 16 | 219.75 |
| Clean Max En | 1425.00 | 1456.90 | 1410.00 | 1472.00 | 1390.00 | 162.55 | 1536.00 | 727.10 | - | - |
| Clean S Tech | 728.85 | 721.00 | 728.80 | 729.50 | 716.10 | 135.58 | 1315.00 | 652.00 | - | - |
| CMR Green Te | 217.35 | 218.05 | 216.00 | 218.80 | 213.05 | 784.00 | 268.96 | 213.05 | - | - |
| CMS Info Sys | 271.70 | 273.90 | 268.50 | 278.00 | 268.05 | 380.67 | 537.00 | 255.15 | - | - |
| COAL INDIA | 427.05 | 427.40 | 427.00 | 428.90 | 424.75 | 5403.13 | 490.90 | 368.55 | 14 | 427.25 |
| CochinShip [5] | 1395.70 | 1392.40 | 1381.90 | 1399.50 | 1375.30 | 543.77 | 1979.60 | 1186.55 | 57 | 1391.95 |
| Coforge | 1439.90 | 1484.70 | 1430.00 | 1489.00 | 1430.00 | 3441.35 | 1989.70 | 1008.10 | - | - |
| CohanceLifeS | 422.10 | 417.10 | 420.00 | 425.00 | 411.00 | 224.35 | 1081.10 | 266.70 | - | - |
| COLGATE P [1] | 2085.80 | 2086.10 | 2065.00 | 2103.80 | 2065.00 | 197.45 | 2505.00 | 1781.60 | 42 | 2088.25 |
| Comm.Syn Bag | 180.02 | 178.52 | 178.90 | 181.77 | 177.02 | 56.29 | 224.60 | 126.18 | - | - |
| Concord Bio | 1268.50 | 1248.50 | 1268.50 | 1272.20 | 1238.00 | 50.66 | 1980.00 | 987.00 | - | - |
| Concord Env | 297.50 | 298.35 | 294.00 | 301.00 | 290.35 | 49.40 | 656.00 | 235.00 | - | - |
| CONFI PE [1] | 74.45 | 78.30 | 74.40 | 79.50 | 73.50 | 3047.29 | 80.40 | 27.00 | 30 | 78.15 |
| Container [5] | 480.50 | 477.55 | 478.90 | 484.20 | 474.40 | 579.58 | 612.00 | 421.80 | 30 | 477.80 |
| Control Pri | 573.70 | 590.55 | 568.00 | 595.90 | 561.00 | 99.85 | 893.65 | 517.50 | 13 | 590.80 |
| Coromandl [1] | 2022.90 | 1980.80 | 1980.10 | 1998.70 | 1955.00 | 182.30 | 2720.00 | 1709.50 | 30 | 1981.15 |
| Corona Remed | 2029.70 | 2113.00 | 2032.00 | 2120.90 | 2032.00 | 61.60 | 2128.40 | 1336.60 | - | - |
| Cosmo First | 877.55 | 881.00 | 877.55 | 886.30 | 862.00 | 98.77 | 1147.60 | 560.80 | - | - |
| CPCL | 1269.60 | 1214.80 | 1265.00 | 1281.90 | 1209.00 | 1544.06 | 1354.00 | 621.00 | 4 | 1214.00 |
| Craftsm.Auto | 9311.50 | 9284.00 | 9226.00 | 9312.00 | 9113.50 | 25.05 | 9938.00 | 5954.00 | - | - |
| CreativeNewt | 879.05 | 987.00 | 881.10 | 1049.00 | 870.00 | 5646.07 | 1049.00 | 525.00 | - | - |
| CREDITACC | 1503.50 | 1517.60 | 1503.50 | 1522.00 | 1456.50 | 335.46 | 1609.00 | 1112.90 | 31 | 1516.90 |
| Credo Brand | 83.37 | 82.92 | 83.00 | 84.50 | 81.38 | 80.75 | 177.02 | 63.06 | - | - |
| CRISIL [1] | 4399.60 | 4347.20 | 4401.80 | 4420.80 | 4261.10 | 84.13 | 5896.10 | 3689.00 | 56 | 4350.30 |
| Crizac Ltd [2] | 186.86 | 184.44 | 186.86 | 187.65 | 183.12 | 218.55 | 387.50 | 174.00 | 19 | 185.55 |
| Crompton [2] | 252.45 | 250.15 | 249.55 | 251.45 | 240.20 | 4490.95 | 339.65 | 217.50 | 46 | 249.95 |
| CSB Bank | 338.15 | 340.90 | 335.30 | 342.20 | 331.45 | 366.14 | 574.70 | 317.65 | 9 | 340.65 |
| CSM TECHN | 96.99 | 99.62 | 97.22 | 102.00 | 95.10 | 490.23 | 113.00 | 95.10 | - | - |
| Cubex Tubing | 77.61 | 76.99 | 77.99 | 79.16 | 76.22 | 50.37 | 143.82 | 73.00 | 15 | 77.19 |
| Cummins [2] | 5599.00 | 5600.50 | 5571.00 | 5652.50 | 5533.00 | 290.71 | 6142.80 | 3484.00 | 66 | 5601.85 |
| Cupid Ltd [1] | 208.52 | 213.43 | 208.72 | 213.99 | 206.09 | 25099.82 | 225.90 | 29.11 | - | 213.55 |
| CYIENT [5] | 830.65 | 840.05 | 834.95 | 873.00 | 814.45 | 2956.68 | 1302.45 | 751.00 | 32 | 840.00 |
| Cyient DLM | 665.10 | 670.45 | 655.15 | 680.85 | 654.05 | 740.67 | 734.95 | 265.20 | - | - |
| **D** | | | | | | | | | | |
| D B CORP | 208.27 | 208.75 | 204.10 | 210.90 | 203.99 | 153.20 | 289.90 | 185.05 | 11 | 208.35 |
| Dabur [1] | 423.15 | 423.20 | 420.75 | 424.80 | 419.40 | 641.62 | 576.80 | 401.05 | 50 | 423.40 |
| Dalmia Sug [2] | 363.10 | 361.95 | 360.50 | 364.00 | 356.30 | 46.69 | 429.00 | 262.75 | 13 | 363.15 |
| DAM Cap Adv | 157.60 | 157.88 | 155.51 | 159.98 | 153.61 | 324.72 | 286.00 | 119.22 | - | - |
| Data Pattern | 4597.50 | 4584.50 | 4540.00 | 4668.30 | 4421.20 | 1344.40 | 4955.90 | 2131.00 | - | - |
| DATAM G [5] | 833.90 | 821.50 | 830.00 | 830.05 | 814.35 | 79.52 | 1119.95 | 632.15 | 49 | 820.85 |
| Davang.Sugar | 3.29 | 3.42 | 3.29 | 3.49 | 3.24 | 9880.42 | 5.50 | 3.03 | - | - |
| DB Abhushan | 1350.15 | 1328.05 | 1349.00 | 1361.65 | 1307.15 | 43.37 | 1729.60 | 866.10 | - | - |
| DBL | 386.80 | 420.25 | 386.00 | 433.75 | 381.55 | 17567.77 | 587.90 | 381.75 | 29 | 420.05 |
| DCAL [2] | 179.24 | 183.58 | 178.19 | 184.60 | 176.10 | 136.61 | 321.15 | 129.00 | - | 184.05 |
| DCB Bank | 189.72 | 186.24 | 189.60 | 189.60 | 184.75 | 1034.47 | 205.75 | 119.40 | 8 | 186.10 |
| DCMSHRI [2] | 1008.80 | 1005.80 | 1011.20 | 1018.90 | 992.60 | 29.67 | 1501.70 | 946.15 | 19 | 1005.45 |
| DCW [2] | 45.66 | 46.23 | 45.66 | 46.45 | 44.70 | 633.36 | 81.98 | 37.15 | 28 | 46.34 |
| DCX Systems | 179.81 | 180.68 | 178.00 | 181.90 | 175.65 | 429.79 | 286.00 | 153.30 | - | - |
| DDev Plastik | 272.25 | 275.65 | 270.60 | 278.00 | 267.40 | 60.17 | 360.00 | 185.15 | - | - |
| Deccan GoldM | 193.93 | 194.52 | 191.51 | 195.49 | 187.30 | 940.81 | 235.00 | 114.80 | - | - |
| Deep Ind | 459.50 | 479.60 | 460.00 | 484.40 | 453.60 | 339.27 | 578.00 | 330.00 | - | - |
| Deepak Fert. | 1580.30 | 1573.20 | 1578.00 | 1589.50 | 1559.20 | 119.92 | 1677.85 | 865.45 | 74 | 1571.55 |
| DEEPAK NI [2] | 1653.80 | 1649.60 | 1647.00 | 1663.50 | 1634.50 | 91.73 | 1946.15 | 1280.40 | 116 | 1649.50 |
| Delhivery | 465.45 | 462.55 | 463.00 | 466.80 | 458.15 | 2176.83 | 524.00 | 374.45 | - | - |
| DELTA CORP [1] | 62.53 | 62.99 | 62.20 | 63.43 | 61.53 | 621.32 | 98.86 | 48.67 | 14 | 63.00 |
| DEN NETWORK | 26.97 | 27.16 | 26.80 | 27.35 | 26.62 | 296.79 | 41.24 | 22.75 | 12 | 27.03 |
| Denta Water | 330.70 | 336.65 | 329.90 | 340.00 | 323.30 | 209.62 | 479.60 | 222.00 | - | - |
| Devyani.Eng | 109.87 | 112.30 | 108.80 | 113.28 | 107.00 | 3027.08 | 191.00 | 91.55 | - | - |
| Dhampur Sug | 142.18 | 142.12 | 142.00 | 142.99 | 139.50 | 109.65 | 167.00 | 110.20 | 14 | 142.10 |
| Dhanalak Bnk | 34.36 | 34.29 | 34.00 | 34.62 | 33.26 | 1076.13 | 36.80 | 19.50 | 13 | 34.30 |
| Dhanuka [2] | 1010.90 | 1013.30 | 1010.90 | 1019.00 | 999.00 | 15.75 | 1960.00 | 889.95 | 16 | 1013.10 |
| Diamond Pwr | 273.93 | 295.15 | 266.00 | 299.00 | 263.50 | 15515.90 | 299.00 | 115.57 | - | - |
| Diffusion En | 385.10 | 395.35 | 385.15 | 398.80 | 377.30 | 72.76 | 436.20 | 216.80 | - | - |
| DigitideSol | 101.42 | 101.22 | 100.00 | 101.80 | 98.00 | 180.49 | 279.69 | 69.90 | - | - |
| Divgi Torq. | 931.65 | 945.60 | 931.65 | 960.00 | 905.55 | 20.68 | 1065.00 | 573.70 | - | - |
| Divi's Lab [2] | 7305.00 | 7248.50 | 7230.00 | 7280.00 | 7177.00 | 328.95 | 7437.65 | 5637.50 | 72 | 7246.65 |
| DIXON [2] | 13829.00 | 13846.00 | 13750.00 | 13898.00 | 13586.00 | 278.71 | 18471.50 | 9605.05 | 112 | 13845.25 |
| DJ Mediaprin | 109.39 | 114.39 | 110.90 | 116.00 | 108.66 | 389.56 | 124.80 | 52.00 | - | - |
| DK Enterpri | 262.85 | 272.75 | 263.00 | 280.00 | 258.30 | 56.29 | 350.00 | 191.35 | - | - |
| DLF [2] | 642.20 | 645.20 | 639.15 | 648.65 | 630.60 | 2002.25 | 844.15 | 489.30 | 46 | 645.50 |
| DLINK IND [2] | 440.80 | 452.20 | 435.05 | 454.90 | 433.30 | 173.01 | 548.95 | 365.70 | 18 | 452.40 |
| DMART | 4035.00 | 4018.80 | 4010.00 | 4074.80 | 3990.00 | 332.48 | 4916.30 | 3528.65 | 79 | 4017.80 |
| Dodla Dairy | 1037.30 | 1061.20 | 1030.00 | 1070.00 | 1024.60 | 19.10 | 1500.00 | 964.10 | - | - |
| Dolat Algo | 68.29 | 68.76 | 68.20 | 70.00 | 67.22 | 114.29 | 97.27 | 65.00 | - | - |
| DOLLAR [2] | 252.35 | 258.00 | 251.00 | 258.65 | 248.05 | 290.80 | 395.15 | 220.60 | 14 | 258.40 |
| Dolphin Off. | 397.00 | 376.95 | 408.00 | 408.00 | 369.25 | 45.49 | 501.95 | 322.00 | - | - |
| DOMS Ind | 2230.10 | 2221.00 | 2201.50 | 2241.10 | 2201.50 | 49.97 | 2770.00 | 2023.90 | - | - |
| Dr AgarwalHe | 478.10 | 478.90 | 480.70 | 482.90 | 476.00 | 56.10 | 568.00 | 401.00 | - | - |
| Dredging Cor | 984.60 | 1003.30 | 981.50 | 1010.90 | 961.50 | 133.98 | 1285.00 | 561.70 | 590 | 1004.10 |
| DrReddy'sLa [1] | 1166.30 | 1151.70 | 1147.00 | 1166.30 | 1131.40 | 4750.51 | 1414.40 | 1080.05 | 145 | 1152.60 |
| Dwar Sugar [1] | 42.43 | 43.31 | 42.43 | 43.65 | 41.36 | 510.31 | 53.10 | 32.14 | 26 | 43.31 |
| DYNACONS SYS | 1181.60 | 1240.60 | 1170.00 | 1240.60 | 1160.00 | 34.01 | 1925.65 | 781.50 | 19 | 1241.20 |
| DYNAMAT.TECH | 10181.00 | 10458.00 | 10100.00 | 10497.00 | 10100.00 | 8.62 | 12870.00 | 6335.00 | 136 | 10442.40 |
| Dynamic Cab. | 406.00 | 402.40 | 400.85 | 425.00 | 397.00 | 1153.62 | 520.00 | 236.80 | - | - |
| **E** | | | | | | | | | | |
| E2E Netwrk | 492.10 | 516.70 | 509.00 | 516.70 | 492.10 | 7140.04 | 4538.00 | 361.20 | - | - |
| Easy Trip Pl | 6.84 | 6.83 | 6.80 | 6.85 | 6.73 | 8679.18 | 10.69 | 5.77 | - | - |
| Eclerx Ser | 1889.40 | 1861.50 | 1880.50 | 1898.60 | 1811.00 | 205.76 | 2492.98 | 1319.05 | 38 | 1861.50 |
| EDELWEISS [1] | 116.09 | 117.02 | 115.50 | 117.70 | 114.00 | 1777.04 | 133.90 | 91.85 | 25 | 117.10 |
| EFC (I) Ltd | 196.19 | 195.30 | 193.50 | 196.97 | 190.00 | 171.31 | 357.00 | 171.55 | - | - |
| Eicher Motor [1] | 7721.50 | 7628.00 | 7710.00 | 7710.00 | 7575.00 | 409.58 | 8232.80 | 5355.70 | 41 | 7628.40 |
| EID Parry [1] | 759.15 | 758.00 | 752.00 | 766.15 | 750.25 | 128.55 | 1246.45 | 698.40 | - | 757.80 |
| EIH [2] | 321.35 | 326.40 | 319.00 | 328.95 | 317.00 | 156.88 | 434.35 | 271.35 | 32 | 325.35 |
| EIH ASSO.HOT | 308.75 | 310.90 | 311.80 | 313.70 | 302.65 | 16.64 | 435.35 | 265.80 | 21 | 311.20 |
| Eimco Elecon | 1792.20 | 1789.20 | 1792.30 | 1800.90 | 1746.00 | 14.97 | 2548.00 | 1413.70 | 26 | 1785.90 |
| Elec.Mart In | 127.86 | 129.64 | 127.85 | 130.13 | 125.60 | 490.98 | 168.50 | 84.90 | - | - |
| Elecon Eng [1] | 433.00 | 421.65 | 427.00 | 431.70 | 419.20 | 859.46 | 634.95 | 352.00 | 32 | 421.50 |
| Electro Cast [1] | 70.43 | 72.10 | 70.39 | 72.50 | 69.52 | 1439.55 | 119.85 | 60.13 | 28 | 72.15 |
| ELECTROTHERM | 997.40 | 1008.20 | 1029.00 | 1097.10 | 990.10 | 55.83 | 1278.35 | 550.45 | - | 1009.55 |
| Elgi Equipm [1] | 586.05 | 577.30 | 578.00 | 581.95 | 568.10 | 173.42 | 634.00 | 408.95 | 52 | 577.85 |
| Elin Elec. | 100.49 | 101.13 | 100.06 | 101.88 | 98.10 | 163.78 | 234.00 | 93.65 | - | - |
| Elitecon Int | 16.07 | 15.51 | 16.32 | 16.66 | 15.30 | 4787.32 | 46.40 | 15.30 | - | - |
| EllenBarrInd | 277.90 | 281.20 | 277.90 | 284.90 | 273.00 | 193.00 | 603.25 | 175.00 | - | - |
| Emami Ltd [1] | 416.25 | 407.90 | 412.65 | 414.85 | 406.30 | 694.32 | 634.65 | 376.05 | 21 | 408.30 |
| EMAMI PA [2] | 122.88 | 118.18 | 120.00 | 122.47 | 117.10 | 280.29 | 133.58 | 55.95 | 8 | 117.69 |
| Emcure Phr | 1869.50 | 1881.00 | 1864.20 | 1892.00 | 1855.40 | 58.59 | 1944.00 | 1260.00 | - | - |
| Emkay Glo | 235.65 | 239.50 | 232.00 | 244.90 | 231.05 | 32.29 | 409.90 | 185.30 | 54 | 238.40 |
| Emmvee Photo | 319.75 | 331.00 | 317.75 | 332.25 | 314.15 | 2762.32 | 371.55 | 171.51 | - | - |
| EMS | 406.35 | 403.30 | 401.10 | 406.70 | 391.55 | 314.33 | 655.00 | 256.05 | - | - |
| Emudhra | 457.70 | 455.75 | 455.40 | 465.90 | 448.45 | 137.00 | 836.55 | 364.55 | - | - |
| Endurance | 2720.30 | 2634.00 | 2688.00 | 2688.00 | 2548.60 | 369.87 | 3078.95 | 2144.10 | 49 | 2637.35 |

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BENGALURU
businessline.
SATURDAY - JULY 25 - 2026

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phoenix Mill [2] | 2035.60 | 2010.70 | 2014.00 | 2035.40 | 1978.30 | 1100.44 | 2168.65 | 1403.00 | 244 | 2012.25 |
| PhysicsWall | 133.25 | 128.05 | 132.60 | 132.60 | 124.81 | 12191.14 | 161.99 | 77.72 | - | - |
| PI INDUS. [1] | 2742.60 | 2731.20 | 2706.00 | 2773.30 | 2703.30 | 239.37 | 4329.00 | 2527.30 | 27 | 2731.25 |
| PiccadilyAgr | 736.75 | 737.20 | 736.75 | 739.90 | 721.00 | 138.36 | 805.50 | 515.00 | - | - |
| Pidilite [1] | 1564.20 | 1570.90 | 1562.00 | 1585.00 | 1537.10 | 2199.98 | 1625.50 | 1259.45 | 67 | 1570.90 |
| Pine Labs | 147.48 | 145.67 | 146.23 | 147.40 | 142.80 | 7741.14 | 284.00 | 134.73 | - | - |
| Piramal Fin | 2106.10 | 2085.40 | 2106.10 | 2112.90 | 2046.00 | 204.39 | 2220.00 | 1260.00 | - | - |
| Piramal Phr | 180.83 | 181.27 | 179.04 | 182.32 | 178.24 | 3895.35 | 215.04 | 132.30 | - | - |
| Pitti Engg [5] | 913.65 | 920.65 | 913.65 | 926.80 | 900.00 | 21.21 | 1069.85 | 677.20 | 36 | 917.85 |
| Pix Transm | 1790.00 | 1766.10 | 1782.00 | 1792.10 | 1750.40 | 11.27 | 1937.90 | 1220.10 | - | - |
| PLASTIBL [5] | 189.77 | 188.85 | 186.37 | 190.89 | 185.57 | 75.61 | 215.95 | 121.00 | 12 | 188.50 |
| PlatinumInd | 228.85 | 227.82 | 226.50 | 230.00 | 222.50 | 47.45 | 342.40 | 183.50 | - | - |
| PN Gadgil Jw | 650.60 | 647.00 | 650.65 | 654.20 | 630.35 | 392.45 | 736.40 | 503.00 | - | - |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Shipping Cor | 41.59 | 41.33 | 41.40 | 41.55 | 41.05 | 165.70 | 55.00 | 34.30 | - | - |
| Shivalik Bi | 753.15 | 755.70 | 740.00 | 780.00 | 735.10 | 329.45 | 814.00 | 368.60 | - | - |
| SHK | 140.58 | 140.65 | 140.00 | 142.00 | 137.11 | 217.04 | 275.20 | 111.70 | - | 140.10 |
| SHOPPER ST [5] | 380.85 | 377.75 | 377.00 | 380.10 | 363.20 | 62.56 | 566.70 | 267.00 | - | 377.55 |
| Shree Cement | 26825.00 | 26740.00 | 26575.00 | 27000.00 | 26425.00 | 13.41 | 32283.75 | 22575.00 | 56 | 26739.35 |
| ShreejiShipp | 616.60 | 625.80 | 615.00 | 627.30 | 608.25 | 494.58 | 629.00 | 222.00 | - | - |
| SHREEPUSHK | 390.40 | 386.85 | 388.65 | 390.00 | 381.75 | 33.70 | 476.60 | 273.40 | 28 | 387.55 |
| Shringar Hou | 220.38 | 219.66 | 219.50 | 220.70 | 215.06 | 396.14 | 266.50 | 166.00 | - | - |
| Shriram Fin | 1025.80 | 1005.10 | 1018.10 | 1051.00 | 992.90 | 11775.85 | 1108.00 | 566.50 | - | - |
| Shriram Pist | 4277.90 | 4159.90 | 4265.10 | 4270.00 | 4121.50 | 58.42 | 4522.80 | 2301.20 | - | - |
| Shriram Prop | 84.08 | 85.02 | 83.25 | 85.44 | 82.05 | 483.79 | 103.19 | 60.57 | - | - |
| ShyamMetalic | 1039.75 | 1027.45 | 1025.45 | 1033.75 | 1010.35 | 132.99 | 1090.00 | 746.00 | - | - |
| Siemens Ener | 3326.80 | 3240.20 | 3290.10 | 3301.00 | 3225.00 | 338.79 | 3968.00 | 2115.00 | - | - |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Urja Global [1] | 9.05 | 9.22 | 9.05 | 9.26 | 8.94 | 843.06 | 14.79 | 8.00 | - | 9.20 |
| USHA MART. [1] | 496.40 | 495.70 | 498.40 | 499.95 | 488.80 | 330.94 | 527.00 | 333.95 | 39 | 495.25 |
| UTI Asset | 904.05 | 881.40 | 904.50 | 906.95 | 876.00 | 1009.48 | 1494.80 | 876.00 | - | - |
| Utkarsh SFB | 14.46 | 14.45 | 14.40 | 14.53 | 14.15 | 3841.83 | 23.90 | 10.12 | - | - |
| UY Fincorp | 19.25 | 18.57 | 19.01 | 19.29 | 18.22 | 423.70 | 19.98 | 11.16 | - | - |
| **V** | | | | | | | | | | |
| V Guard Ind [1] | 294.40 | 290.80 | 294.00 | 294.00 | 288.80 | 251.91 | 412.85 | 289.05 | 47 | 291.00 |
| V2 Retail [1] | 220.21 | 219.29 | 218.00 | 221.94 | 216.09 | 459.52 | 259.45 | 157.19 | 54 | 219.05 |
| VADILAL IND | 6749.50 | 6710.50 | 6739.50 | 6774.00 | 6627.00 | 6.28 | 7000.00 | 3990.00 | 49 | 6692.35 |
| Vaibhav glbl [2] | 254.99 | 251.94 | 252.50 | 254.39 | 245.64 | 649.58 | 292.70 | 174.45 | 23 | 252.25 |
| Vakrangee [1] | 5.76 | 5.81 | 5.76 | 5.89 | 5.68 | 1065.10 | 10.22 | 4.64 | - | 5.80 |
| Vardhm Text [2] | 610.10 | 614.60 | 606.30 | 620.00 | 598.05 | 130.93 | 687.70 | 383.40 | 24 | 612.95 |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| HDFCAMC-HDFCNIF100 | 25.77 | | | 25.64 | 239.73 | | 29.00 | 22.00 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCNIFBAN | 58.33 | | | 58.45 | 266.47 | | 65.54 | 51.20 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCNIFIT | 30.48 | | | 30.80 | 2766.75 | | 42.30 | 27.32 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCNIFTY | 268.89 | | | 268.19 | 127.26 | | 301.88 | 247.56 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCPVTBAN | 27.83 | | | 27.86 | 741.55 | | 30.17 | 24.31 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCQUAL | 57.61 | | | 57.45 | 10.66 | | 61.87 | 51.91 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCSENSEX | 86.72 | | | 86.40 | 49.03 | | 98.48 | 80.90 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCSILVER | 210.98 | | | 210.79 | 2830.12 | | 359.00 | 105.65 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCSML250 | 178.09 | | | 177.58 | 1420.92 | | 184.13 | 142.70 | | - |
| HDFCAMC-HDFCVALUE | 125.07 | | | 124.90 | 1.04 | | 147.05 | 120.00 | | - |
| HSBCAMC - HSBCGOLD | 124.69 | | | 124.12 | 9.99 | | 146.40 | 119.10 | | - |
| ICICI PR NIF LW VL 30 ETF | 22.10 | | | 22.08 | 1781.26 | | 26.81 | 19.84 | | - |
| ICICIPRA010G | 262.78 | | | 262.25 | 0.80 | | 266.00 | 252.23 | | - |

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

# BSE Stocks

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Suraksha [2] | 263.70 | 252.45 |
| Suryoday SFB | 194.90 | 192.60 |
| Suven Pha [1] | 422.40 | 417.60 |
| SW-Solar [1] | 206.45 | 207.90 |
| Swiggy [1] | 261.60 | 251.40 |
| Sylph Tech [1] | 0.25 | 0.26 |
| Syncom For [1] | 13.13 | 13.10 |
| Syrma SGS | 1378.85 | 1294.15 |
| Tarc [2] | 130.90 | 131.20 |
| Tata Capital L | 341.30 | 341.45 |
| Tata Tech [2] | 696.30 | 711.00 |
| TataMot CV [2] | 408.00 | 406.20 |
| Tatva Chint | 1701.25 | 1726.45 |
| Taylormad Re | 68.54 | 63.31 |
| Techno Elec [2] | 996.10 | 993.60 |
| TechNVision | 4404.00 | 4995.90 |
| Tejas Netwrk | 497.40 | 496.20 |
| TennecoCle | 543.70 | 539.85 |
| TGV Sracc | 100.00 | 104.60 |
| Timex Group [1] | 574.25 | 579.00 |
| Tinna Rubber | 1080.60 | 1098.50 |
| Tips Films | 382.05 | 405.75 |
| Titan Int [1] | 1.03 | 1.04 |
| TMB | 799.60 | 802.90 |
| Transpek | 1020.45 | 1055.70 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Transrail Li [2] | 481.35 | 482.85 |
| Trualt Bioener | 432.60 | 429.40 |
| Tube Invt [1] | 2823.90 | 2766.90 |
| Turtlemint [1] | 127.20 | 130.15 |
| TVS Supply [1] | 132.30 | 133.25 |
| Ultracab (I) [2] | 7.14 | 6.98 |
| Unimech Aer [5] | 1215.90 | 1237.00 |
| Updater Svc | 208.15 | 201.80 |
| Urban Comp [1] | 130.25 | 129.80 |
| UTI Asset | 904.30 | 880.60 |
| Valiant Comm | 979.00 | 966.90 |
| Vedant Fash [1] | 402.20 | 403.40 |
| Vedanta Alu [1] | 435.05 | 435.65 |
| Vedanta Iron [1] | 31.10 | 30.36 |
| Vedanta Oil [1] | 32.79 | 34.17 |
| Vedanta Power | 34.72 | 35.02 |
| Vidya Wires [1] | 88.04 | 88.68 |
| Vijaya Diag [1] | 1320.95 | 1313.00 |
| Vikas Life [1] | 1.29 | 1.32 |
| Vikram Solar L | 183.95 | 182.80 |
| Vikran Eng [1] | 71.96 | 71.43 |
| Vintage Coff. | 156.25 | 156.40 |
| Virtuoso Op | 498.85 | 483.45 |
| VishalMega | 109.85 | 108.00 |
| Waaree Enr | 2711.65 | 2700.85 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Waaree Re [2] | 944.90 | 933.80 |
| Wakefit Inn [1] | 134.60 | 129.50 |
| Wardwiz.Inn [1] | 6.66 | 6.66 |
| Waterways Leis | 829.20 | 806.40 |
| Welsp SplSol [6] | 49.40 | 51.25 |
| Wework India M | 700.45 | 713.30 |
| WPIL [1] | 443.65 | 449.55 |
| Yatharth Hsp | 840.75 | 837.90 |
| Yatra Online [1] | 107.30 | 107.65 |
| Zaggle Pre [1] | 201.15 | 200.20 |
| ZF Steering | 667.00 | 689.80 |
| Group T | | |
| Biogrpaper [1] | 6.16 | 6.00 |
| Cian Agro In | 1497.00 | 1496.30 |
| Cropster Agr [1] | 7.26 | 6.90 |
| Empower Ind [1] | 2.35 | 2.37 |
| Hexagon Nu [1] | 64.26 | 65.50 |
| IdeaForge Te | 859.45 | 868.75 |
| Leading Lsg [1] | 1.17 | 1.17 |
| MTAR Tech | 5873.15 | 5850.20 |

# NSE Trade for Trade

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| BAAZAR STYLE | 274.70 | 280.40 |
| BhagyangrI [2] | 403.60 | 410.90 |
| BLISS GVS P [1] | 461.85 | 464.60 |
| DB Realty | 112.32 | 112.50 |
| DEE DEVELOPM | 647.85 | 653.45 |
| Empower Ind | 2.34 | 2.38 |
| Filatex Fash | 0.18 | 0.18 |
| Ganga Forg. | 1.75 | 1.67 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| HEXAGON NUT | 64.43 | 65.51 |
| IDEAFORGE TE | 861.05 | 870.65 |
| Indiabulls | 29.48 | 30.53 |
| INDOTECHTR | 3297.90 | 3418.00 |
| Kamadhenu [1] | 34.97 | 36.14 |
| KRN HEAT EXCH | 1229.10 | 1233.90 |
| MenonBeari [1] | 216.51 | 213.77 |
| MTAR TECHNOL | 5875.00 | 5805.00 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| QUALITY POWE | 1100.90 | 1105.40 |
| RamaSteel [1] | 4.28 | 4.26 |
| RIL COM V [5] | 0.83 | 0.82 |
| Sigma Advan | 499.80 | 523.00 |
| Sterlite Tec | 548.85 | 564.15 |
| Subex | 12.34 | 12.58 |
| Tirupati For | 77.48 | 73.61 |
| VenusRemedis | 1655.60 | 1649.00 |